

A woman with long brown hair is sitting on a bed, wearing a black lace bra and black underwear. She has her eyes closed and a serene expression. A man's arm is wrapped around her waist from behind. The background is dark and moody, with soft lighting on the woman's face and body.

The Wife I Didn't Know

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THE WIFE I DIDN'T KNOW

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Also by Kenny Wright

Also by Max Sebastian

FOREWORD

It's been over one year since the global pandemic began. One year since we've started wearing masks and staying inside more of the time, since "social distancing" entered the mainstream lexicon.

What follows is the story of a man who's stricken with COVID-19, loses his memory, and embarks on a journey of sexual self-discovery. But we want to acknowledge upfront the real and lasting damage that this disease has inflicted on so many. We are close to the end of this thing, but we're not at the actual end. Please stay safe. We're all in this together, and we're nearly there.

We also want to acknowledge all the great people who helped make this book a reality. Thanks to beta-readers Azure Granite, Duke Lattimore, and Anjali. Thanks to you, the readers, for supporting us by buying a copy of this book.

“The man with a clear conscience probably has a poor memory.”

—AUTHOR UNKNOWN

AWAKE

When they told me my wife would pick me up from the hospital, a part of me still expected to wait out by the curb for a mid-sized sedan to pull up in front of me, my wife at the wheel. I was still surprised to find a very expensive-looking black Mercedes limousine waiting for me outside of the post-intensive care recovery unit. And when the driver's door opened, a smart, uniformed chauffeur wearing a black mask over his mouth climbed out.

‘Good afternoon, Mr Sullivan,’ the chauffeur said through his mask as he circled the limo. It was still disconcerting, seeing that, even after the stream of doctors and nurses also never taking off their masks.

‘Uh... hey, how’s it going?’ I didn’t know the guy’s name. I probably should have.

‘Very good, sir. And may I say, you’re looking very well today?’

‘Thank you.’

The chauffeur opened the nearside rear door, and I was rather stunned to watch a tall, leggy brunette wearing a light, floaty summer dress, emerge from the vehicle like a movie star arriving at a premiere.

I probably should have remembered I was this wealthy.

I probably should have remembered I was married to a gorgeous woman like this.

But I didn't remember much of the past 20 years.

'Hey, honey,' said the brunette. My wife. I had to get used to thinking of her as being my wife. She smiled, beautifully, and gently put her hands on my shoulders, before sliding them around my neck as she leaned in to kiss my mouth.

My God. Was this some kind of lucid dream? So much of my life had felt that way these past few weeks. I blinked, but she was still there.

And she was just gorgeous. Intimidatingly so. I wanted to pull her close and kiss her again, but felt awkward. Was this real? If it was, why didn't I recognize this woman outside of the few video chats we'd had since I'd emerged from my coma.

'Hey,' she said softly, tilting her head just so. Some part, deep down in my subconscious mind, I recognized that gesture. I felt the weight of an entire world behind it. I felt the passion.

I pulled her to me, kissing her. Her luxurious perfume filled my chest like life. This time, the kiss felt right—familiar, yet not, the way an old scent sometimes stirred a memory you can't quite grasp.

She didn't pull away. She didn't break the illusion. She melted into my kiss, moaning quietly as I sucked on her lips, pressing her body against me. She must have felt how hard I was for her. That, too, seemed to surprise her. But that, too, she seemed to enjoy.

When I eventually broke off from our kiss, Dana looked somewhat astonished.

'Sorry...' I said as she stared at me in wide-eyed wonder. I cast my eyes down, dropping them into her cleavage—deep and barely contained by her summer dress—and felt my cheeks burn at that, too.

I fumbled on, stumbling on my words. 'I guess it's been a while since I had... you know... any kind of release. I feel like a goddamn teenager again.'

She smiled, and I caught her glance briefly downward, toward my crotch. ‘Do you remember me at all?’

I sighed, and flushed a little. ‘No,’ I said, and took a deep breath. No sense in lying. No sense starting this new relationship off on anything but the honest truth. ‘I’m sorry... I don’t remember you at all.’

She didn’t seem angry. She just nodded, pensively, and when an ambulance went by, seemed to be reminded that we had a car waiting to take us away, and we were in danger of getting in the way of important medical business here.

‘Come on, let’s go home,’ she said.

Memory loss is so weird. I knew I was 46 years old, I felt like I fully recognized my own body, and its current state of age and physical fitness. I wasn’t freaked out by the car we were sitting in on the way home, or the technology inside it—I didn’t feel impressed that Dana was sitting beside me in the back of the Mercedes clutching a top-of-the-range iPhone. And yet I couldn’t recall where I lived, I couldn’t remember my wife at all, and I couldn’t tell you anything at all about what had happened to me in the past two decades.

I remembered making my first million in the venture capital business, investing in a news-gathering software application that was subsequently bought by Google. I remembered the damp squib that the Millennium Bug had turned out to be. I remembered living in a little apartment in the Bernal Heights neighborhood of San Fran. I remembered my blonde girlfriend walking out on me because I spent too much of my time working, and too little of my time spending my bonuses on her.

But in the hospital, they’d told me I was now worth hundreds of millions. They’d told me I now lived in a large mansion in Pacific Heights. They’d told me I’d been married to a woman named Dana for the past 10 years.

And now, here I was sitting in the back of a chauffeur-driven limo beside her, my entire body fizzing from what felt both like a first kiss, and a familiar one.

‘Do you remember where we live?’

I shook my head. ‘I’m sorry.’

‘Don’t be sorry.’ She smiled, but raised an eyebrow. ‘Do you remember getting married?’

I sighed, feeling awful, and shook my head.

She nodded, pressing her lips together, accepting that this was just the way it was. I wasn’t to blame for forgetting. It was all the fault of COVID-19.

Then she gave me a little smirk. ‘Do you remember that Donald Trump is our *President*?’

I chuckled. ‘They told me at the hospital. Kind of crazy, huh?’

‘*Totally.*’

‘What do you remember about me?’

I winced. She saw it, and I felt the anguish that it caused. She took a deep breath and glanced away, out the window, as if pulling herself back together.

‘Do you remember anything *at all* about me?’

I gave her an apologetic, somewhat exasperated grin, ‘I don’t know how many times I can apologize...’

But she only laughed, and asked, ‘Are you even *attracted* to me?’

She was sitting there with one leg crossed over the other to flash me a breath-taking amount of thigh, wearing a dress that hardly covered anything at all.

‘Uh... couldn’t you tell back there?’

She smiled like the cat who got the cream, turned to me, and slid a hand cautiously along my thigh until it reached the bulge in my pants. She gazed

up into my eyes and gasped when her hand touched down on the monster lurking between my legs.

‘I told you, I’ve haven’t had any release for months...’ I explained, all red-faced.

But she didn’t seem to be in a mood to laugh at me, or tease me, for the fact that my erections had been almost uncontrollable since I’d emerged from my coma. She whispered, ‘You’re *kidding* me...’ and her hand started to explore the shape of my hardness, her eyelids going heavy.

Turning toward the front of the limo, she said, ‘Harry, take the long way home please.’ Then she pressed a button and the privacy screen slowly rose into place—and with it, my blood pressure. Again, I wondered if I was dreaming. This couldn’t be real, right?

She saw my expression, picking up on my thoughts like I’d said them aloud. ‘My God, you really don’t remember... anything.’

I shook my head.

She searched my face. I saw the empathy and sympathy. I saw how I could have fallen for this woman, how she could be my wife. ‘This must be pretty intense.’

‘Quite.’ I tried to relax, but it was difficult. It was all I could do to remember to breathe.

Her face was the perfect balance of delicate and strong, with high cheekbones that complimented her jawline, a high forehead, and dark, sculpted eyebrows against her lily white skin. But it was her eyes that made it feel like a weight was on my chest—soft brown eyes that looked sad and excited and confused all at the same time. She was just as lost, navigating my amnesia, as I was.

And then she was kissing me again, and I was kissing her back, my hands exploring her body as she continued to squeeze my cock through my pants. I could feel the heat of her body beneath her dress. I could feel the outline of her panties—her *thong* panties.

She broke the kiss long enough to pull her dress up over her head. I gasped at the sight. Dana blushed.

‘You’re *gorgeous*,’ I breathed, before I could stop myself.

Beneath the summer dress she wore a lacy bra the color of an effervescent rose wine that lifted and offered her exquisite breasts. Her body was toned, showing hints of muscle in her arms and her abs, and her thong dove between the ripe, muscled cheeks of her ass.

Helping me along, she began unbuckling my pants. I felt her need. ‘You’re not the only one who hasn’t had “anything” in months,’ she said. It was her turn to gasp as she freed my cock. I pushed my pants down around my knees as she wrapped her hand around the shaft and began to pump it. ‘Guess you really are still attracted to me.’

‘Of course I am—’ Before I could finish the statement, she swung her leg over me, straddling my lap. Pushing her thong to the side, she drew my cock against her pussy. She was so wet, so smooth, and when she sank onto me, it felt like coming home.

We groaned together, lost in that feeling of reunion. I kissed her neck, feeling her pulse racing along with mine. I kissed into the hollow behind her ear, feeling her dangling earrings tickle my cheek.

Dana slipped her hand beneath my shirt like she was desperate to feel my skin, her nails raking through my soft mat of chest hair. I grabbed her ass, squeezing her buttocks as I started driving up into her. I may have forgotten who this woman was, but I didn’t forget how to fuck her.

‘Oh, yes... yes, yes...’ she whispered, an edge to her voice.

I took a hand off her ass long enough to open the clasp of her bra and free her tits. They hung free, large and soft, capped by full nipples the same color as her rose-hued lingerie. They looked mouth-watering, and when I circled my lips around one, Dana went off.

“Ugh!” she cried, arching her back. She clutched the back of my neck to steady herself, the other hand slapping the roof of the limo with a hollow

thud. She squeezed my thighs with her knees, riding me harder and faster.

I didn't just sit there. Instinct took over. I clutched her ass cheeks harder, driving my thumbs into her hips as I augmented her undulations. Planting my feet firmly on the limo floor, I began thrusting up into her with each drive down.

She thrashed on me, jerking back and away. I drank in her near-naked body, all those pale curves, all mine, 'til death do us part. Her stomach rippled as she came, leaning back until she had to brace herself on the partition behind her, or fall off my lap.

I released her ass, my hands working on their own. I tweaked a nipple, knowing in my gut that's what she wanted. My other hand swept down her tummy, pulling the thong further to the side as I sought her clit. Her mound was bare, not a single curl of hair to decorate her alabaster skin. I didn't remember a thing about this woman—every discovery about this woman was new. Somehow, this felt different.

I brushed her clit with my thumb and felt the walls of her pussy shiver around my cock. It was all too much. Too overwhelming. I was back in the hospital, back in the woozy time just after my coma. I was fading again. Losing it.

"Ugh!" I grunted. Thrusting up, I rocked back, feeling months and months of tension release all at once. I was transported somewhere else. I was floating and free and delirious.

Only this time, when I finally managed to open my eyes, it wasn't to bright lights and the drop-ceiling tiles of a hospital room. The limo was still there. *My wife* was still there.

Everything was going to be alright.

And then I noticed that Dana wasn't wearing a wedding ring.

REBIRTH

They told me that I'd been asleep for one month, two days, and thirteen hours. They told me that my memory could eventually return, but they didn't really know. I could see it in the way the doctor focused on her charts rather than me, or how another kept explaining how many unknowns came with the disease.

'What do you remember?' a therapist asked, sitting on the opposite side of the room, armed in a mask and gloves and a tablet.

'I'm... my name is... Damien... Damien Sullivan?'

'That's correct. Yes.' The therapist scribbled something into her tablet. 'That's a good start. Do you know what year it is?'

I tried to remember, but time felt soft, slipping through my fingers every time I reached for it. 'I don't know.'

'That's okay. It's 2020.'

'Huh,' was all I could manage.

'What do you remember?' she probed.

'I... I work in finance... for a VC.' Private equity. I was a money man.

'Good.' She nodded, scribbling some more. 'Very good.'

I looked around. Nothing made sense. Beyond the woman in the mask and out the window stretched the ocean, sparkling and foreign.

'Why am I here? Why can't I remember anything?'

‘You got sick with COVID-19. Do you remember that?’

COVID-19?’

‘A novel coronavirus. There’s been a global pandemic.’

‘What?’ Things suddenly felt so overwhelming, like I’d been dunked beneath the waves and couldn’t manage to get my head up again.

She listed off the current events in a rote way. She’d done this before. She’d had to explain that the world was different than the one I went to sleep in. Over a hundred thousand dead in the US alone. The social distancing guidelines. New York City completely locked down.

‘There’s a quarantine here in the Bay Area. No one can leave their homes unless they’re deemed essential.’

I heard her, but I couldn’t understand her anymore. I was fading again. I wanted to close my eyes, but it scared me. If I did, would I wake again? Would I lose more chunks of memory?

‘You were brought here in March. You seemed to get better at first, but then you regressed. We put you on a ventilator, but the doctors still couldn’t get your blood-oxygen levels high enough—they had to put you into a coma. But I’m afraid... there must have been some damage.’

The amnesia. My brain was starved of oxygen, and twenty years of memories started dissolving away.

‘Damien?’ the therapist asked. ‘Mr. Sullivan?’

I was drifting again, darkness swimming around me. I was tired all of a sudden. So very, very tired.

‘Mr Sullivan, can you hear me?’

And then I slipped under once again.

THAT’S how it was in those first few days after the coma. Doctors and nurses and therapists would come and go, all wearing more protective gear

than normal. They didn't just ask questions to test my memory.

Donald Trump, that reality TV star, was now president—had been for the last three years. I didn't remember that. The last person I remember leading the country was George W. Bush. My memory of things was spotty. I remember 9/11, for example, and the beginnings of the war in Afghanistan, but not much else. The world had changed in the last twenty years.

So had my life. I'd somehow turned my first investment, back in my early twenties, into an investment empire. They called me an angel investor in the tech world. I had bank-rolled the dreams of so many.

Memory's a funny thing. What my brain chose to hold on to versus what I couldn't remember at all was seemingly random. I couldn't remember a single detail about my house, but that I was in my midlife. 46-years-old, was something that my brain accepted without question—the salt-and-pepper hair, the even grayer beard. What I didn't remember was the *feeling* of being old. When we did physical therapy, my body didn't bounce back from the weeks of atrophy the way I was expecting.

It was frustrating as hell, but wasn't going to stop me. I gritted my teeth, focusing on recovery. Focusing on getting back to who I was before all of this. I would survive. I would persevere. All it would take was one foot—and one memory—at a time.

And then one of the doctors came in on my fourth day awake, and said, 'I think you're doing really well, Mr. Sullivan.' He flipped through my charts. He asked me how I felt. And then he said, 'You feel like you're up to talking with your wife?'

Wife. I had a wife—a wife that I didn't remember. Not even a little. It was nearly as disconcerting as learning that there was a global pandemic that had infected millions. In many ways, it was even crazier because it was so personal. Who was she? How did we meet? Did we love each other?

I was so nervous the first time they brought the tablet to my hospital bed—the first time the new me ever laid eyes on Dana. My wife.

I was worried that I wouldn't feel *anything* when I saw her. I was wrong. Whatever spark drew me to her so many years ago was still there, fresh and strong and real. Her hair was back in a ponytail and she wore a blouse appropriate for a work call.

'You have a beard.' Her voice was gentle, nurturing, and just as unfamiliar as everything else.

I touched my face, feeling the scratch of my facial hair. 'This is new?' I asked.

I saw the shock register, tightening in the muscles across her face. It was one thing to hear that your husband has amnesia. Another to experience it. It was a lesson I learned every minute of my day. She snapped out of it quickly, although the smile that came next was forced. 'Yeah, you never liked...' She trailed off like a wave going out to sea. 'It looks good on you. You look distinguished.'

'Sounds like another way of saying I look okay for an old guy.'

I expected her to laugh, or at least smile. Instead, she just stared harder at me. Later, I'd learn that it was a joke I often made as I grew into my 40s—that it threw her off.

'What do you think? Should I keep it?'

'If you'd like.'

'But would *you*?'

Again, she stared at me like I was a complete stranger—the way I must have been staring at her. 'I'm going to withhold judgment until I see it in person.'

'Do you know when that will be?' I asked. 'They haven't told me much.' I glanced at the closed door to the hospital room. "'They're treating me like a child.'

She said, 'They just want to look out for you, that's all. They told me that you should be cleared in the next day or two.'

'And will you come and get me?'

There was thought behind her smile. There was... love? 'Yes. I think that will be nice.'

HOME

The house that the limo pulled up in front of was as out of a dream as the rest of my life. The Classical Revival home was nestled into the Pacific Heights neighborhood of San Francisco, which was already impressive. With its symmetrical design, the white columns of the entrance and the white, quoin blocks that framed the pastel blue of stucco—and why did I know all these terms?

‘This is our home?’ I asked Dana as Harry, the driver, opened the door for us. Every time I looked at her felt unreal. This was all happening. This was actually my life.

She paused, taking in the mansion that we lived in as though seeing it for the first time herself. ‘Yeah.’ She glanced at me and grinned at the awe in my face. ‘Hard to believe we could take something like this for granted, isn’t it?’ She took my arm in hers, and my whole body buzzed. ‘Come on, let me give you the tour.’

Everything about the house was like something featured in a television show. It was four stories and 11,000 square feet of luxury, and it was hard to connect the man I thought of myself as with this kind of opulence.

While the exterior was very classical in a traditional sense, the interior looked updated and modernized, from the sleek, modern kitchen to the state-of-the-art gym in the basement to the floor-to-ceiling glass showers

that, I'll confess, made me think about how much fun I must have with Dana in them. Everything worked well together, though. Nothing was out of place.

It's funny, though. After the wild sex we had in the limo over here, I felt shy around her. Even looking at that sex shower made me blush. Dana was eyeing the shower with some apprehension, too, and the semi-racy joke I almost said died away.

It was exhausting, just walking around our home. I felt dizzy enough that Dana noticed as we stepped out onto the top floor terrace. "Are you okay, honey?"

'Sorry, it's all just a lot.' The view off this terrace was breathtaking. All of San Francisco sloped away from us, a sea of homes and buildings right up to the ocean, where the sun was making its lazy descent.

'You should lie down. Get some rest. I'll fix us something to eat.'

'Yeah. I think that may be a good idea.' The weight of it all was suddenly there, climbing up my back and pressing on my shoulders. At the mention of bed, I couldn't get there fast enough.

'Come on. Let me show you the bedroom.'

I was out of it enough that I barely heard the innuendo, and reacted even less.

Ten minutes later, I was asleep.

WHEN I AWOKE, it was dark. For one disorienting moment, I thought that I was still in the hospital. The conspicuous lack of beeping machines allayed that fear, but I was still alone in bed.

The clock on the nightstand read 3:05 in the morning. I'd slept through dinner, and my stomach alerted me that it was, indeed, quite empty. The bed was an enormous thing—a California King—in the center of an enormous

bedroom. The curtains were mostly drawn, letting in just enough light to confirm that I was, indeed, alone in the bed. In fact, the other side—presumably *my wife's* side—didn't look slept in at all.

I wondered what she did, realizing that I had no idea. Did she even work? Was I the type of man who would have a trophy wife? What a weird thought to have. I didn't *think* so, but I also didn't think I'd own a house like this.

After staring at the ceiling for about ten minutes and realizing that I wasn't falling back to sleep, I dragged myself to the edge and stretched. I'd changed into pajamas at some point, a pair of loose, cotton pants and an equally soft t-shirt. Even these things managed to feel expensive.

I still felt weak, but hopefully that was because I was so hungry. I crossed the room towards a pair of double doors that I remembered led into the upper halls. Despite the age of the house, the hardwood floors didn't make a single creak. I tiptoed anyway, feeling like a burglar in a museum rather than a man walking about his own home.

The doors to the other bedrooms were all closed. Dana could be sleeping behind one of them. Or she could have some international job that kept her up at night and she was in one of the offices way below.

I should have paid better attention to her tour earlier. I made a note to go exploring tomorrow, in the daylight. My stomach grumbled, reminding me to head to the kitchen, which was down on the lower levels.

In the fridge, Dana had wrapped my dinner in foil—rice and chicken that I threw into the microwave to heat up. As the timer ticked, I looked around. We didn't have photos on the fridge. There weren't random papers along the counter. Everything was so neat, so organized. With the lockdown and COVID-19, I figured that must be Dana.

There was a kitchen table over by the windows, but I decided to take my plate and wander some. The next room over was a... dining room? It

certainly had a dining table, a sideboard, and an enormous hearth. Along the mantle were photos of... me and Dana.

Forgetting my food, I went to those. Maybe something there would stir something in my brain and help me unravel the past. There were wedding photos. Taking that down, I recognized a few of the people on my side of the wedding party—my brother, my parents, my friend from Uni, Russell... Duvall. The others, I didn't know. Funny, that. How people could be so close that I asked them to be groomsmen, and they were complete strangers now.

Of course I didn't recognize anyone on Dana's side. My bride, though, looked radiant in her white dress—a younger version of the woman who picked me up, her smile full of sunshine. The next photo was a portrait of just the two of us, still in our wedding fineries, the bouquet between us as we smiled into one another's eyes.

I didn't have a beard. I didn't even have gray in my hair. Yet still, I looked older than the man I thought of myself. I wasn't the baby-faced twenty-something. I'd filled out. I looked fit.

I touched my gut now. I was still in pretty good shape, although the atrophy from the coma had stolen some of that mass. Not bad for a forty... six-year-old.

The next photo must have been taken from our honeymoon. We looked the same as the wedding photos, not just younger, but full of an energy that had faded over time. The whitewashed buildings of Santorini dotted the background as Dana held a straw hat on her head and wind whipped her long-dark hair around her.

It looked like an amazing memory. I wished I could remember it.

None of the other photos did much for me, either, showing a slow progression to our present time. We were happy in all of them, but I could see the energy of those earlier years fade to something more comfortable.

By the time I was done looking at the photos and eating, I was tired again. I wandered back up through the dark house. If Dana was awake, she was quiet and hadn't left any lights on. It took me a couple tries—opening doors into an empty guest bedroom first, and an equally empty office second, but I found the bedroom where I'd awoken. Falling back asleep was much easier.

IN THE MORNING, I felt reinvigorated. Taking the stairs down to the main floor felt less like an exploration. I ran my hand along the smooth bannisters and managed to look around without my jaw going slack at all that I saw.

The stairs down to the main floor split, mid-flight. On the landing where they joined was a fresco of birds in flight. Of all the things, that stirred something. I paused, staring at it, as I had a vague memory of... someone talking to me about... a renovation. Or talking to Dana? It was gone as quickly as it was there.

Dana was sitting at the kitchen table, a cup of coffee and a tablet in front of her. I paused in the archway, once again stunned by this woman. While she wasn't made up as she had been in those wedding photos, she was, if anything, more stunning now.

It didn't hurt that she was dressed, ready for a workout. The tight, bright blue exercise tank hugged her upper body, and her hair was tied into a high, smart ponytail. Despite that, she still absently ran her fingers over an ear, as if tucking her hair into place. Watching her do it felt like *deja vu*. I knew she'd do it. I knew that mannerism. That felt like a small victory.

I entered the room, startling her. 'Oh, you're awake,' she said. 'Did you sleep well?'

'Like I was in a coma.' The joke didn't land. 'Too soon?'

She humored me with a smile. ‘I think, maybe, yeah.’ But that smile was real, and felt so good.

‘Do I drink coffee?’ I asked.

She covered her mouth as she laughed. ‘If you can’t remember that, then we really do have a problem.’ I noticed that a golden ring adorned the third finger of her left hand. Her wedding ring. Had I imagined that she’d not been wearing it the previous day?

She pointed over to a fancy looking appliance that sat on the counter. ‘Do you remember how to use a Keurig machine?’

‘No, but...’ I drifted over to it, and found that I knew exactly what to do—place a small, plastic cup in the top, place a mug beneath, and press a button. ‘It’s so weird,’ I said as the coffee hissed and brewed. ‘I feel like I’ve never seen this thing in my life, yet I don’t have to figure it out at all.’

‘Good user experience then?’

I shrugged. ‘Maybe. But it’s more like... like I’ve got a blindfold on, but can touch things. Smell things. I’ve still got the other senses. It’s just... different.’

Dana was regarding me thoughtfully, processing it all as much as I was. ‘The doctors said you could start to remember things. They said being home would help with that.’

My coffee ready, I sat down across from her. It made me feel giddy, this close to her. I looked around, pretending that my giddiness was due to this house. ‘This is all so crazy.’

I knew that she knew I wasn’t talking about just the house. This woman didn’t seem to miss much. She didn’t challenge, though. ‘I honestly can’t imagine. At least it’s a nice shock?’

I nodded. ‘Did we buy this place together?’

‘No. You owned it before we met. Honestly, I don’t think I’d buy something quite so...’

“Gaudy?”

Her laugh was warm and rich, although there seemed to be a melancholy to it. 'I would say big. It's a lot to keep up with, especially when we're not allowed to have housekeeping.'

'How... how did we meet?'

She stared at me, a mischievous smile forming across her face. 'We met at a sex party.'

My eyes grew huge. 'Really?!'

She laughed, and I realized she was messing with me. 'No, of course not.'

'That's not very nice, you know.'

She smirked. 'I'm sorry. I shouldn't mess with a man with amnesia.'

'Not what I meant.' I shook my head. 'Leading me to believe that we went to a sex party.'

Her laugh was real, and for a moment, I... felt something. Or remembered something. 'I am sorry to report that you and I have never attended a sex party.'

'Makes sense. Based on this place, I imagine it would be more of a sex gala.'

'No sex galas either. Now a sex soirée...'

I laughed right back. It felt good. It felt...right. I knew this woman, even if I couldn't remember her. We used to do this all the time.

'It's good to have you home,' Dana said, and I swore that there was more meaning to the statement than I understood. I was about to ask her about it when her phone buzzed. She read it quickly, then turned her phone over and set it face down on the table. 'Oh, shoot. I'm sorry, my class starts in a few.'

She stood, collecting her empty plate and her mug of coffee and setting it in the sink. I couldn't help checking her out as she did. Her blue workout top didn't quite cover her whole midriff, and her cropped black pants were skin tight on her toned ass and legs.

‘Class? Are you a... fitness instructor?’

She laughed. ‘CTO. But I’ll take the compliment.’

‘Same difference?’

She smirked. ‘There are bagels in the breadbasket. We’re almost out of fruit, but we should have the next delivery this afternoon. And in the pantry —’

‘Don’t worry about me. I can figure it out.’

She nodded. ‘Sorry, we can chat more after. Can’t be late for this.’

‘I thought we were on lockdown? Quarantine. Whatever.’

‘We are. CrossFit is now all live-streamed. We can do the recordings, but I always find it more motivating to do it with a group, even if it’s virtual.’

‘Makes sense.’ She looked apologetic for some reason before I shooed her away. ‘Go. Enjoy! Maybe we’ll bump into one another some other time.’

There was that smile again, loving yet tinged with sadness. ‘It *is* a big house.’

‘You’ll have to give me your number.’

‘I’ll consider it.’

And with that, she jogged out of the room, and I couldn’t stop looking at her ass.

WORKOUT

I tucked into a breakfast of bagels and a little cream cheese, which I had found along with a bowl full of delicious fully-prepared fruit in the enormous refrigerator. ‘Nearly out of fruit’, as Dana had described our situation, turned out to mean that we had enough strawberries, watermelon, cantaloupe, blueberries, peach, and apple to feed a small army. I guess I had to get used to being ultra-wealthy.

This kitchen was so expansive and so stylish, it could have featured in a movie. And they’d have been able to fit all the cameras and lighting equipment in here, without having to mock it all up in a studio. The island in the middle of the preparation area was about the square footage of my first apartment, when I’d still been working at the investment bank Chifford, Shore & Paice.

I couldn’t eat a huge amount, though. My appetite still wasn’t great. It was a shame—this was amazing food, after what I’d been having at the hospital.

Fed and watered, I drifted out of the kitchen, and found myself drawn to a thumping sound. Dana and her workout. CrossFit, whatever that was.

I wandered to the stairs, and then padded down to the basement, whereupon the sound became loud enough to recognize as actual music. I ventured toward the gym and poked my head around the door. The gym was

as generously proportioned as the rest of the house, with wooden floors and mirrored walls, and apparently every conceivable kind of exercise device known to man—and yet, the place didn't seem even slightly cluttered, there was enough floor space to hold a training session for a whole class, rather than just one.

And there was Dana, hanging from a bar that was raised about seven feet off the ground on a metal frame bolted to one of the walls. She looked gorgeous in her skin-tight workout gear. Just watching her gave me an adrenaline buzz, my inner voices chirping away excitedly—*seriously, this is my wife? I get to sleep with her?*

‘Work back, work back.’

There was a massive television set over on the wall opposite Dana, and on it there were images of other people who appeared to be doing the same thing as Dana—hanging from a raised bar, swinging their bodies back and forth to the beat of the music, at the apparent behest of a male instructor, whose picture took over the entire screen of the TV from time to time so he could bark out instructions.

‘Okay, track that energy up, everybody. Think *efficiency*. Okay... up... up...’

Dana, and the other women featured on the TV screen in front of her, started performing pull-ups. It was strenuous-looking work. So this was CrossFit, right? I thought I'd heard the term before, but I'd never seen it. Dana looked just stunning, her muscles taut and powerful as they worked these arduous-looking exercises. I watched her doing pull-ups, and then squat-thrusts on the floor, and then shortly after that she was lifting weights, the whole jerk and clean thing, like one of those beefy Olympic weightlifters.

Watching her was exhilarating. I'd been starved of not only physical contact with other people while in hospital, but also the sight of exposed female flesh, and now that I was recovering from the initial trauma of my

coma, I was getting hard-ons all the time, like I was hitting puberty again. Only right now, I was living with a goddess in human form, and she looked just incredible in her tight-fitting top and pants, all flushed and glistening with perspiration as she moved to the music and the bark of her instructor.

‘Three... two... one... *nice!*’

I did not feel tempted to take part in the class. I did stay and watch the end of it, though, right until the instructor ordered them all to get to their cool-down routine, and finally they all said farewell to him and logged off—each of their little windows on the large TV screen disappearing when they disconnected from the group video call session.

As Dana got into some yoga-like slow stretching that, I assumed, was her cool-down routine, I noticed that she did immediately not log off from the conference call. In fact, at the very end, there she was by herself, one-on-one with the instructor.

‘Good work out, Dana,’ he said. ‘As usual.’

‘Yeah,’ she said, breathing hard after her workout. ‘My hamstrings were feeling kinda tight today...’

I smiled, thinking back to how she’d jumped me in the limo. Was that the reason for her tight hamstrings? She hadn’t been used to fucking someone in a moving car.

But then the instructor said, ‘Sounds like you could do with someone coming over... to loosen them up a little...’

It struck me as a little forward, even a little flirty in tone.

I even felt a small hint of jealousy in my heart. Strange how connected to a woman you could feel, even after a single instance of making love. I supposed that even though I did only remember the one time making love with her, I had years of connection to her that I might still feel subconsciously, even if I couldn’t access the conscious memories. The guy did seem good-looking, objectively so. Dark-haired and square-jawed, like

Clark Kent minus the glasses. And the way he was standing in front of his camera, hands on hips, emphasized the bulge in his tight shorts.

Would Dana even go for an alpha jock like this guy? He was nothing like me.

But Dana said quietly to her instructor, ‘I’ll have to see if my *husband* feels up to giving me a little massage.’

And she instantly seemed to allay my fears. Her tone seemed to be admonishing him, while also reminding him that she was married, and her husband had returned from the hospital. I furrowed my brow. Had this instructor been coming onto her while I’d been comatose in hospital? Had he been harassing her?

‘Yes, of course.’ He moved on, suggesting that she try a light run around Alta Plaza Park to address her concerns about her hamstrings. ‘Hey, are you getting enough Omega-Three in your diet?’

I wondered if I ought to step out from my doorway, make my presence known. Maybe if she’d been sexually harassed in any way while I’d been in hospital, I could force it out into the open so we could take action. At the same time, I didn’t want her to think I’d been watching her work out. Even if she was my wife, I felt like a stalker. Perhaps I’d see if I could inquire about her workout instructor some other time, some other way. Subtly.

Well, anyway, I chickened out.

Instead, I watched Dana finish up and switch off the big TV, and worried about how I might make a sudden exit when she came this way—there was no way I could get back to the stairs without her seeing, when she did. It was too exposed. I was trying to come up with something to say if it looked obvious that I’d been hiding in the doorway, watching her workout, when she turned and strode off in the direction of the other door off the gym.

Towards that glass-walled shower that I’d seen yesterday—the one that got me blushing then. Now, my heart raced right along—especially as I

heard the shower start up.

I paused, peered into the room, and froze. There was Dana, back to me, peeling off her top, her sports bra, her lycra pants. My eyes widened, my jaw dropped.

I watched her divine form, glistening with sweat, step into the shower. I was fixated on her perfect peach of a behind as she tested the temperature of the water as I tried to come up with some excuse to wander into there and join her. Maybe I couldn't get any of the other showers to work in the house?

She stepped under the flow of the water, letting it soak her long, dark, sweat-dampened hair. I watched her rubbing the water all over her exquisite body, her movement slow and sensual—like she was in the early stages of something sexual. She sighed, and closed her eyes as one of her hands dipped down between her thighs, and I felt a hot flush of surprise and arousal sweep through my chest to realize that it was sexual, that she was beginning to touch herself in the shower.

Well, she had been self-isolating on her own in this enormous house for some weeks now. She'd said she was as horny as I was.

I gently stroked my hard cock through my pajama pants as I watched her stroking her pussy under the steaming flow of the water. Jesus, she was just stunning. I found myself wondering how often she did this, how many times during an average day. I found myself wondering if she'd gotten used to masturbating every time she took a shower.

A paranoid little part of me wondered if she might have been inspired to touch herself by the sight of her CrossFit instructor on that enormous TV screen for the past hour, prancing in front of his camera with a huge bulge in his tight shorts.

But, hey, she'd probably been told she couldn't work me too hard immediately after I was discharged from the hospital. I know she'd been fully briefed by the outpatient team on how to help take care of me during

my rehabilitation. She'd probably been told not to have sex with me too often, or too vigorously. She probably felt she still needed to touch herself to get through another day in lockdown.

My cock slipped through the fly hole in my pajamas, and I suddenly felt self-conscious and foolish.

And then Dana said, quite clearly, 'Hey, honey. Why don't you come join me?'

I blushed, even where I was hiding from her. Had she seen me? Was there a mirrored surface in the bathroom I hadn't factored into my concealment? But her invitation was enough for me to get through my embarrassment.

'You knew I was there?' I asked her, stepping forward, into the bathroom.

She grinned. 'That wall is semi-transparent.'

I glanced at the wall adjoining the gym, and sure enough it comprised glass bricks that let the light through from the other room to help brighten up this bathroom. She'd seen me watching her. I flushed again.

And then I realized that she'd seen me watching her, and had started masturbating anyway. How sexy was that?

She turned to face me, suds of soap tracing down her curves, through her cleavage and across her smooth cleft. She crooked a finger in my direction, and I obeyed. About halfway across the room, though, I decided to try to play it a little cool. After all, I was a big shot now, right?

I successfully peeled my t-shirt off and dropped it casually beside me. Catching my reflection in the mirror, I sized myself up. While I was nothing like the colossal form of her CrossFit instructor, I wasn't so bad. I didn't have a gut, for one, and while my arms could use some tone, it looked like I took advantage of this gym once upon a time.

When I went to step out of my pajama pants, though, I nearly lost my balance and fell on my face. So much for looking cool.

Dana covered her mouth to hide her laugh. My face lit up. I felt like I'd just tripped in front of the cheerleader.

'Still, um, getting used to walking,' I said, looking over my shoulder as I ran my hands through my hair. 'Coma legs.'

'Of course.' She enveloped me in her soapy arms, her body super-heated from the shower and the workout. I felt her hand slide across my erection as she said, 'Luckily it doesn't seem like you have much of a problem... getting back up.'

We stared at one another for about a split second before we both cracked up.

'I'm sorry, I couldn't help myself. I've been all by myself for so long.'

'I'm sorry about that.'

She tilted her head. 'You're sorry?'

'I never should have left you.'

She took a deep breath. The hand on my cock tugged at me gently as she reached her other up to touch my face. 'It's so weird,' she said quietly, almost to herself. 'You look just like my husband, but...'

'But?'

She cleared her throat and glanced away, embarrassed that she'd said it aloud. 'Nothing. This is good. You're here, and you're back.' She let her lust overtake whatever emotions she was feeling, and I wasn't going to belabor it.

She kissed me, a hard and demanding kiss like she was trying to swallow me whole. I went with it, caught in the vortex, letting my lust and my instinct guide me once again. I touched her everywhere, my own soapy hand caressing all the smooth parts of her beauty. I wanted to worship her. I wanted to prove to her that I would never leave.

'I need... I need you to fuck me,' she hissed as I touched her smooth sex. 'Are your coma legs going to be okay?'

‘Let’s find out.’ I kissed her again before turning her, pressing her against the glass wall of the shower. Beyond, I could see our reflection in the semi-fogged up mirrors above the sink, her tits compressed against the glass.

She reached behind her, lining me up. Thankfully, she was tall enough that I only needed to bend my knees a little, and I was inside of her with ease. ‘Yes!’ she groaned, splaying her fingers wide on the glass. “Yes, that’s.... Yes!’

The glass was steamed up enough that I could barely see myself in the reflection. With the beard and the hazy form, it was almost like I was someone else. Like Dana was fucking someone else.

It... did something to me. Like someone had kicked me in the gut or the head or the chest. Like a switch had been flipped. I grabbed Dana by the hips, held her fast, and started to fuck her hard. Her fingers slipped along the fogged up glass, squeaking as they created a hand-shaped window.

I reached around her, finding her clit again, working it hard as I thrust into her from behind. She reached behind her, urging me to fuck her faster with a hand on my hip as her head rolled along the glass. Her moans echoed through the shower, unmuted by the competing shower spray.

‘Yes! Fuck me! Give it to me. Give me that... give me that cock!’

Her words lit my world on fire, so naughty, so dirty, so confident. I felt the power transfer without being able to stop it. I wasn’t fucking her anymore, no matter who was behind her, no matter how out of breath I was. She was in control, I was there to serve her, and I couldn’t have imagined a more perfect world.

‘Are you ready?’ I asked.

‘Yes!’ she nearly screamed. ‘Yes, baby. Don’t... don’t hold back. Don’t ever... ngh... don’t you *ever* hold back from me... again!’

I erupted inside of her, obeying, filling her, proving to her that I was hers, and that I was back. I pressed close to her, my head against her back,

my breath coming in tight shudders as she fought the same way. We held each other there, long after I was spent and my cock softened.

I stumbled backwards, happy to see the built-in tile bench that ran along the back of the shower. My legs felt shaky, and I was suddenly dizzy from all the heat.

Dana moved under the shower again, grabbing her loofah and soaping her body from her second workout of the morning. She looked... satisfied, and I started to harden once again.

‘Really?’ she asked, delighted.

‘Don’t tell me that it wasn’t like this with me all the time.’ I was feeling less self-conscious now with my nudity.

She laughed. ‘It definitely was *not*.’ Then, realizing that the statement may have come off as too harsh, quickly added, ‘I don’t know what couple is after ten years of marriage.’

‘Side benefit of not remembering anything?’

‘Sure.’

‘So how *did* we meet?’

She took some shaving gel off a rack and applied the foam to her long legs. ‘It’s a bit scandalous,’ she said with an air of mystery.

‘More scandalous than a sex party?’

She chuckled. ‘We met because you gave VC money to a company I was working for at the time.’

‘Oh...’ The implication—that she’d possibly slept with me to get the investment money—both didn’t feel right, yet had my heart going. ‘Did we —’

‘Oh, no. It wasn’t like that.’ She switched legs, and from this angle, it gave me a clear view at her sex. ‘No, we didn’t start dating until after I left the company.’

‘I hope that was my idea.’

She laughed. 'It was both of ours. I'd say the attraction was pretty mutual, but we both knew how devastating it would be for both of our careers if we crossed that line.'

'I see.'

'Besides, we were both seeing people at the time. You really don't remember any of that?'

I pressed my lips into a thin line. 'I wish that I did. Sounds like a good time.'

'You'll get it back. The doctors said that it's not always permanent.' She grabbed the shaving gel again, quickly doing her underarms before moving on to her mound. I tried not to stare, but she caught me looking.

'I'm sorry, I just... you're so sexy, you know that?'

'The way you stare at me...'

'I'm sorry. Creepy, right?'

'No, not that. Not at all. I... I like it.' She touched up her pussy with a bit more care than she had her legs and underarms—like she wasn't as practiced. Standing to full height, she let the water wash away the shaving cream, leaving her body immaculately smooth.

It was inspiring enough to give me the strength to stand and cross back over to her, my cock jutting ahead of me like a flagpole.

'Round two?' I asked.

She just shook her head, as amazed as I felt. 'I'm not going to turn that down, but let's take advantage of the bench this time. You've already had enough of a workout.'

And, for the third time in the last twenty-four hours, I wondered when I'd wake from this dream.

A LOCKED DRAWER

I ended up taking a nap after all the shower sex. As good as it was and as virile as I was behaving, I really was a 46-year-old man who had spent the last month in a hospital bed. I was drained, and Dana understood.

Luckily, this time I didn't sleep through the rest of the day and into the night. It was early afternoon when I woke up.

I felt good, truly refreshed. Maybe it was something to do with all the sex. I hauled myself out of bed, and decided my best bet was probably to get dressed. It felt both liberating and daunting to be on my own here—albeit with Dana as my companion—rather than surrounded by constant medical supervision. I could do as I wanted, when I wanted. But I didn't really have any kind of schedule, and that made me feel somewhat lost. The structure of my days in the post-intensive care unit had been grueling, but at least I knew what was coming next, and how to prepare myself for it. Here at home, I didn't know where to go.

Was I supposed to be working?

I couldn't say where my business normally took place outside of the lockdown, let alone any of the actual business I'd been involved in over the past two decades. I'd been briefed on what my profession was—well, it

hadn't actually changed from when I was in my 20s, although I'd progressed in the field considerably.

I felt almost embarrassed about having to ask Dana what I was supposed to be doing with myself.

Anyway, one step at a time. For now, I hauled myself out of bed and went searching for clothes. I didn't need to go much further than the walk-in closet. It was stuffed with designer gear. What kind of clothes did I usually go for? I was inclined to put on a pair of jeans and a t-shirt, but I felt like that was the kind of thing I wore all the time in college, and in my early 20s. I was 46 now, a multi-millionaire living in a stupidly extravagant house in the middle of San Francisco.

The racks within my walk-in closet was lined with designer suits, amazingly shiny shoes, drawer upon drawer of silk ties of every shade imaginable. Wow. Was this me?

I found one little corner where there were a few pairs of Levi's. No t-shirts, though. I found a fairly comfortable, casual-looking button-down shirt, so I went with that. I felt like I was about to board a yacht for a sailing vacation in the Greek islands, but at least it was comfortable.

What hit me, as I sauntered back out into the bedroom, was that there were none of Dana's clothes here. Everything was mine.

Oh.

Curious, I poked around the bedroom—the drawers in the bedside tables, the cupboards in the marble-lined en suite bathroom. It was all my stuff in here, there was nothing I might suspect belonged to Dana. No women's toiletries in the bathroom, no walk-in closet stuffed full of women's designer clothes, no sign that Dana ever spent a night in this bedroom.

Did we sleep in separate bedrooms?

What the hell was that about?

At the back of the little drawer in one of the bedside tables, I found a cell phone. This was another one of those weird instances where I didn't recognize something, but I *knew* it. I knew this was a phone. I knew that when you raised it to your face, it would turn on.

This one, however, was dead, the batteries long gone. I pocketed it and wandered out of the bedroom.

I went downstairs, where there was another floor comprised mainly guest bedrooms, a room containing a pool table, and a book-lined study. Centered in that study was a dominating, mahogany desk covered in neat piles of paper. I was wondering whether this was where I worked when I was home, when I heard Dana's voice, fairly quiet, from somewhere behind me.

At the other end of the building, I found her, sitting behind a very different, more modern desk, within a bright room that was more of an office than a study, since it seemed so much more contemporary in style. Dana's office?

'No, if you do that, you'll never get them to click beyond the second page, and we desperately need them to—'

She was on the phone, but she'd noticed me come in. She swung around on her revolving office chair to face me, and smiled, the kind of questioning smile that asked how I was feeling without disturbing her phone call.

I smiled back at her, and held up the cell phone I'd found. Dana nodded, reaching into one of her lower drawers and fishing out a white phone charger. I took it from her, not wanting to disturb the call, and withdrew from her office. It sounded like she had plenty of work to catch up on, even though everybody was locked down at the moment.

I went back to my study to find some kind of outlet so that I could plug in my phone. That, too, I found easily, like my hands knew to find a socket in the desk itself.

When the phone booted up, buzzing and rattling on the desk, I realized I didn't know what I was looking for on it. Some sense of who I was, maybe?

This time when I lifted it to my face, it flashed on and I was suddenly face-to-face with a grid of square icons that I didn't recognize but knew what to do with. I could decipher it. I had a lot of unread messages from a lot of people who I didn't recognize other than one man—Russell Duvall. Same guy from the wedding photos. It was good enough to see a familiar name, only when I touched his name, I was startled to see the screen shift and it began to ring.

Panicked, I considered hitting the red “End Call” button when the ringing stopped and a photo of Russell's face filled the screen. ‘Hello? Sully? That really you?’

Awkwardly, I lifted the phone to my ear. ‘Hey, Russ. What's... what's up?’

‘Well I'll be! Fuck, man, I heard you were, like, in a coma.’

‘I was until last week.’

‘Jesus. How do you feel?’

‘Like I was in a coma.’ He chuckled at that. ‘Honestly, it feels good to be alive, you know?’

‘I hear that, man. I definitely hear that. That's really scary. George died, you know, of the disease.’

I didn't know George, and it was at that moment that I realized Russell had no idea that I'd lost my memory. A wave of shame and embarrassment washed over me. This was a guy I still remembered going to bars with and hitting on girls when we were young and stupid. Like the clothes in my closet, neither of us were those kids anymore.

‘Listen, I...’ I didn't want to tell him. Even in that moment, I knew how illogical that emotion was. What was I afraid of? But emotion and fear don't care much for logic. ‘I'm suffering from severe retrograde amnesia. Something that happened when I lost oxygen to my brain. Or maybe it was

the virus. They don't really know. But... I can't remember stuff. From before.'

Russell was silent for a long time, and in that silence, my heart and my embarrassment built until I was ready to just end the call. Then—

'I'm so sorry to hear that, man. Are... how...'

'Does that work? I can't remember anything from the last twenty or so years.'

'*Twenty years?! Like... like nothing?*'

'Some stuff. Random stuff. I don't remember George, for example. I don't remember my own wedding.' I hesitated to say that I didn't remember *Dana* at all. 'But every now and then, I... I don't know, I get the feeling like my memories are still there, just... just locked behind a glass door. Foggy, you know? Out of reach.'

'Is it... permanent?'

'Doctors don't know. You know how they are. They don't want to get my hopes up, and there's a lot of jargon to sift through. Short answer is maybe?'

'Well listen, man, if there's *anything* you need from me. Like, anything at all, I'll do what I can. If you want me to make some phone calls, I have some buddies at the Mayo Clinic. Maybe get some more help. Course, with the pandemic, it may need to wait a bit.'

'I've got time. Thanks, man. Hey, on the plus side, I woke up and discovered I have an amazingly hot wife.'

Russell hesitated before speaking, and when he did, his voice shifted away from the friendly, jovial one from before. 'Yeah, Dana is something.'

'What?' My blood thickened, drumming against my chest as I read into that cautionary tone.

'Just... be careful with her, okay?'

'Be careful? What does that mean?'

I heard his sign down the line, like he was sinking into a deep, plush chair. 'We can talk about this later. When you're better.'

I snorted. 'You can't say something like that and then not follow through. Tell me, Russ. Like I said, all I've got is time.'

He sighed, said, 'Maybe... you should just enjoy being in lockdown with a hot wife, huh?'

'Russ.'

Another pause. 'Look,' he said at last. 'A few months ago, before anyone really heard about the damn coronavirus, you had certain... concerns... about Dana.'

'Concerns?' I felt a jolt through my heart.

'You... really want to get into this now?'

'Russ. I'm a big boy now.'

'That's what I heard,' he joked. Then he hesitated, but finally sighed again, and said, 'Take a look in your top right drawer.'

I frowned, and glanced down. So Russ and I were close enough that he knew what was in my desk drawer? I pulled on the handle, but it didn't move. Locked? But there was no keyhole.

'It's locked,' I said.

'You see that black circle where there should be a keyhole?'

I did. 'Sure.'

'Touch it with the tip of your finger.'

I did as he asked, and there was a satisfying grind and click sound. The drawer now opened.

'Clever,' I said.

Inside, there were some papers, a fountain pen ascribed with the words 'Exeter College, Oxford University'. My alma mater. Russell's, too. That had been where we'd met.

There was also a gun in the drawer. Silver-plated, but still a gun.

'Russell, there's a fucking gun in the drawer.'

‘Yeah. Apparently it works, too. Don’t worry about that. There’s a manilla envelope...’

I lifted a few of the papers, and sure enough, here it was. I withdrew it from the drawer. The envelope was standard letter sized, blank. It was already open.

‘You found it?’

‘Uh-huh.’

I gulped. Did I really want to see what was in here? I took a deep breath, and then pulled a few black-and-white photos out from the envelope. My heart sank as I laid eyes on the woman in the photo—Dana. And to my surprise, I recognized the guy she was pictured with having lunch at some kind of restaurant. Her CrossFit instructor.

‘I had one of my guys tail her for a couple of days,’ Russell said. ‘I mean, you insisted.’

Dana looked good in the pictures. She was wearing similarly skin-tight workout gear, and I recognized flirty glances between the two of them in some of the pictures.

My manhood thickened.

But at the same time, it was only a meal. Two people sitting at a table faced by bowls of over-priced salad. I expected more intimate, more telling shots, but after a picture where the two of them were apparently leaving the restaurant after their lunch, there was nothing more.

‘This is it?’ I asked Russell.

‘Yeah,’ he said, sounding melancholy.

‘They were just having lunch together.’

‘Uh-huh.’

‘I mean, he’s her CrossFit trainer. She went to the gym, he trained her, they had lunch.’

‘That last picture...’

‘They’re leaving the restaurant. Sure. But it doesn’t show—’

‘Okay, maybe you didn’t leave the pictures in order...’ Russell seemed like he didn’t want to push this.

I flicked through the other pictures. There wasn’t anything more suspicious than flirtatious smiles and friendly laughter here. It still made my heart feel oddly squeezed to see them together, to feel the suspicions germinating within me. Why would Dana cheat on me?

‘There’s nothing here,’ I said. ‘Nothing particularly telling, anyway.’

Russell said nothing for a moment. Then he said, ‘Okay... I’m assuming you took it out, put it somewhere...’

‘What did it show, Russ?’

Another long pause. Then he said, ‘They kissed.’

‘They kissed. Like... tongues?’ I felt silly, but none of this was silly.

Russell sighed again. ‘No... well, it wasn’t entirely clear... I mean, you know how some people are. French people greet their mothers like that.’

‘Are we talking a kiss on the cheek? Lips? What?’

‘I don’t know... it could have been either.’

‘Russ.’

‘Hey, look, I’m sorry. Maybe it was nothing. My guy didn’t see much else, but you told me to call him off as soon as you got this. You had... suspicions, that’s all. It was probably nothing.’

‘Probably.’

‘And... I mean, how have things been between you and Dana since you got out of hospital?’

‘Great,’ I said. ‘Better than great. Really incredible.’ I didn’t want to get into the details, even with my best buddy, but my body was still singing sweet Alleluja after my shower with Dana, even having slept since then.

‘Well then,’ he said. ‘Maybe... it’s better to let sleeping dogs lie, right?’

‘Maybe.’

We were both silent for a moment. I had all kinds of pictures of Dana kissing her CrossFit trainer whirling around my head. Where was that

photo? There was nothing else in the drawer. Had it been perfectly innocent? Air kissing taken from an unfortunate angle? Or had it been passionate, but obscured? Was Russell trying to play it all down?

At last, I realized he was speaking, only I'd missed what he'd been saying.

'...of course, if we can get them down to two-fifty, there would be tax advantages to that we probably shouldn't ignore...'

I said, 'Russ, you think your guy might have another copy of that missing picture?'

He sighed. 'Uh... look, I can ask him. Probably. But look, you want to go there? I mean, you can't even remember *marrying* her, right? You guys were so great together before... well... before. And you said things have been going well since you got out of hospital?'

'Yeah, I did. Amazing.'

'So maybe we should just let it go, buddy. Maybe this is your second chance with Dana.'

'Second chance.'

'Look, give me a call, okay? Soon as this damn lockdown eases, we'll get together.'

'That would be good.'

'Anything you need, buddy. Call me, right? Anything.'

'Sure, thanks, Russ. Appreciate it.'

It felt good to have a friend on the other end of a phone line. But hanging up left me a distinctly empty feeling in my chest.

'Hey, how's it going?'

I nearly jumped out of my skin at the sound of her voice. Dana was standing in the doorway. How much had she heard? God, I felt stupid. But she didn't look concerned at what she might have overheard. She was smiling at me brightly. Maybe even a little seductively, as she leaned up against the doorway.

‘Good,’ I said. ‘I got that phone working.’

‘That was Russell you were talking with?’

‘Yeah. I guess I remember him—but from before. You know, college, and so on.’

Dana smiled. ‘He wanted to visit you in hospital, but you know... they didn’t even let me see you.’

I nodded. She didn’t seem worried about anything she’d overheard. I felt thankful.

‘What’s next?’ I asked her. My dick was still hard from... what... from when I’d found out she might have kissed her CrossFit trainer? Jesus, I’d been getting boners totally at random since I’d come out of the coma. But even in smart work clothes, Dana looked stunning, so my hard-on wasn’t going away just now.

Dana flashed me another dazzling smile. ‘We have to get going with your physical therapy,’ she said.

THERAPY

I followed her upstairs, trying hard not to stare at her ass in that tight skirt as we went, trying to will my erection to subside, though it seemed difficult to do while I had thoughts of her flirty lunch with her CrossFit trainer in mind.

Cheater.

I had so many questions—but they were questions I felt I couldn't risk asking her, not now. Not if it threatened the incredible sexual chemistry we had going just now.

Maybe our marriage had hit the rocks before my coma.

Maybe we slept in separate bedrooms.

Maybe we'd stopped having sex, and she had to look for intimacy elsewhere.

But right now, it felt like we were on honeymoon, and despite the fact that only I had lost my memory, Dana seemed as into this sexual renaissance as I was.

'So what are we supposed to be doing?' I asked her as I hurried to keep up with her long strides as we walked down the wide hallway. She had such long legs.

'I have to do conditioning work on your muscles,' she said. 'They did tell you we'd have to do that, didn't they?'

‘They said something about conditioning. I thought it meant I’d just hit the gym, you know, when I felt ready.’

She smiled, and gave a slight shake of her head. ‘No, we can’t wait on this, you’re supposed to keep it up, or it’ll be really difficult to regain your strength later.’

She led me into a room across the hall from the one I’d woken up in—my bedroom, I supposed that had been. This one seemed to be a bedroom, too, except that there was no bed in it. Instead, there was a massage table set up in the middle—quite a professional-looking one, too. I supposed that if we were going to get any kind of equipment in to help with my recovery, it was going to be the best available. We had the money.

‘Okay, so take your clothes off and lie down for me?’ She asked me, and I felt a little self-conscious about the fact that my cock was on the stiff side.

‘All of them?’

She grinned. ‘You’re embarrassed?’

‘I... just... they didn’t need me to take off all my clothes when they did this at the hospital,’ I said through flushed cheeks.

She turned to a large, long chest of drawers that had been converted into a kind of medical station, complete with a little white microwave that I assumed could be used for warming massage oil. But she grabbed a bottle of lotion, not oil.

‘Well, I think it’ll be more enjoyable if you just take your clothes off,’ she said, handing me a little white towel.

I smiled as I started removing my shirt. ‘Does that mean I get a happy ending?’

She smirked at that. ‘I do want to make you happy...’

I hesitated before removing my underpants—would she notice more if I kept them on, and hid my erection within them, or if I took them off and tried to turn away from her before she could see it?

I glanced up, and she was staring at me in such a way that I really had no option. I slid down my boxers, and my hard-on sprang free.

‘Looks like you’re at least a little happy already,’ she said, but when I looked sheepishly up into her eyes, she wasn’t laughing at me, she was gazing rather hungrily at my manhood.

‘So... how do we do this?’ I said, wrapping the little towel around my middle.

‘Lie down on your front, to begin with,’ she said.

I did so. She started by applying lotion over my legs, lightly sweeping her hands all over my muscles, explaining to me that she was warming up the tissue to begin with. Then, once things were a little warmed up, she started pushing into my muscles deeper, more intensely, working from the top of the thigh and the hamstring down to the calves and ankles with long, deep strokes.

‘You’re really good at this,’ I said. It felt monumentally good. Some of her pushing and poking felt a little tender, but mostly it felt incredibly relaxing. It aroused me, but it also threatened to lull me off to sleep.

‘When they said I’d have to do it—because of the lockdown, I watched a ton of videos on YouTube,’ she said.

‘YouTube?’

She laughed. ‘Right. I guess you won’t remember it if it wasn’t around before you were, what, 25, 26? YouTube is massive now. Like, billions of people use it to watch and post videos.’

‘What kind of videos?’

‘All kinds of videos. Well, clean ones. There are people who, like, make their own dirt-cheap TV shows—cooking, makeup, fashion, cars, stupid pranks, gardening, whatever—and just upload the videos to their channel, and they have millions of people watching them.’

‘Wow. And how does YouTube make money?’

‘Advertising. They even pay you a cut of the revenue if you upload a video, based on how many people view it. Some YouTubers make millions.’

God, I felt like I had so much to learn, just to become an ordinary member of society. How I was going to get back into the investment business was anyone’s guess.

But for now, I had Dana giving me a massage. It was heaven. After using lotion to warm me up, she used oil for the deeper work. Heated it up in the microwave so it wasn’t a shock when she touched me, and everything. It smelled of rich vanilla—glorious.

She did my legs, and then my back, and then tore off my towel and started working the oil into my buttocks.

‘They never did this in the hospital,’ I pointed out.

‘This is my reward,’ she joked. ‘The guys in the hospital got paid to do your therapy.’

She was basically fondling my butt. But it was still relaxing, I let her do as she pleased. The trouble was, then she told me to turn onto my back, and when I did that, I had no towel to conceal the fact that I was as erect as the Golden Gate Bridge.

The fact that I discovered that she’d taken off her blouse and her skirt, leaving her in just a white bra and thong panties.

‘I guess you’re enjoying yourself,’ she said, apparently unable to take her eyes off my flagpole.

‘What happened to your clothes?’ I asked her. ‘They didn’t strip off in the hospital.’

She laughed. ‘I should hope not. But I didn’t want to get oil on my work clothes. It is Gucci, darling.’

‘Sensible.’ I stroked her with my eyes as she reached out and stroked me with her hand. ‘Wouldn’t want to...’ I groaned. ‘...to get all dirty.’

‘No.’ She had long, slender fingers that looked good wrapped around my cock. ‘We certainly wouldn’t want that.’

‘Did you... did you learn this on YouTube, too?’

‘No.’ She added a second hand to the mix, twisting her fingers in opposite directions. It felt divine. ‘I learned this from other sources.’

Other sources. Like her CrossFit trainer. I nearly came at the forbidden thought. It shouldn’t have made me feel that way. I should have been sick with jealousy, and while the jealousy did twist in my gut, it only made the rest of it so much more intense.

‘The internet is a wild place now, Damien. It caters to all.’

Porn, then. Was Dana admitting that she watched porn? That didn’t... feel right. My brain didn’t... feel right. I gasped, rocking back, as a memory rose like a bubble to the surface of a placid pool. It rose, and popped.

‘Porn? You’re watching porn in here?!’ I was at my desk in my study. It was late. I had my pants around my thighs and my cock in my hand. On my computer, a blonde was going down on another blonde, their naked bodies stretched out on a crisp, white bed.

I looked up, Dana was frozen in the doorframe, her hand on the knob, her eyes wide with shock and rage and hurt. I felt the shame and the humiliation like a sack of rocks falling through my gut. I felt it then...

...and I felt it now, back in the moment with Dana over me, giving me a handjob. It’s disorienting. The woman from my flash memory was injured and distant. This woman stared down at me like she was going to eat me alive.

My cock had started to flag at that memory. Now, it leapt back to life and I was once more skirting the edge of an orgasm. Only thing that kept it at bay was the one from this morning, and even that wasn’t going to last.

‘Better be careful or you really will get dirty, honey,’ I groaned.

She released me, moving her glistening hands down my legs, returning to the physical therapy she was ostensibly administering. As she did so, she swung her body around, her thong-clad ass in my direction.

I reached out, tugging on the small scrap of cloth. It came away, sticking briefly to her wet lips. I pushed my hand into the gap between her thighs, aided by the oil and her excitement. She moaned as I pressed two fingers into her from behind, glancing at me over her shoulder.

‘My turn to make you happy,’ I said. It didn’t take much to coax her up onto the massage table, throwing her leg over my face. Up close, her pussy was so perfect, ripe and swollen and there to be worshipped.

Just as I lifted my head to taste her sex, I felt her mouth envelope mine. I moaned, my nose crashing against her slit as she caught me off guard. She giggled. ‘Why not make each other happy at the same time?’ she asked before taking even more of my shaft into her mouth.

How could I deny such a sweet request? Curling my hands around her ass, I pulled her hips down to mine as I worked her pussy in earnest, swirling my tongue across all that soft, smooth skin.

She tugged her bra off so that our naked bodies could slither and slide along one another as we sixty-nined. Those tits caressed me, soft pillows capped in hard knots. Her head continued to bounce along my length, taking me deeper and deeper. I felt myself graze the back of her throat. She pulled up for air, but before I could apologize, she grinded her hips into my face, smothering me between her thighs.

And then, with a great inhale, she dove back to my cock. I sank into her throat—just the tip before her lips touched down at my root. I was transported. I was in heaven.

I was suddenly suffocating!

I pushed her up, just enough to catch my breath, as she continued to work me with the back of my throat. I was close. So very, very close. But I wanted her to come at the same time. I wanted this orgasm to be mutual.

I focused on her clit, taking advantage of how exposed her button was. I may have forgotten what it was like to be married to this woman, but my body hadn’t forgotten what she liked. I must have been doing something

right, too, because as my balls began to tighten and my need for release became almost unbearable, she began grinding her hips on me faster.

Once again, I faced asphyxiation, but if this was how I'd die, it could be much worse. She tore her mouth away from my cock with a loud, "Oh my —" Cut off only by an even louder moan. "Yes, honey. Yes right... right... *there!*" The last word was a growl, a demand, an order.

I flicked my tongue along her slit, as told, until my tongue started to cramp. Until I couldn't take much longer. Then, and only then, did she take me into her mouth one last time, deep throating me, sucking hard until my whole body seized and I erupted into her waiting mouth.

She swallowed it all as she came all over my face. There was no gagging. No running to the bathroom. She drank my spunk before sliding off the table and rounding on me with a smile.

'That ought to be enough muscle conditioning for one day.' She gathered her things, checked her Apple Watch, and said, 'Oh, and now I need to run. Have a Zoom call in ten.' She blew me a kiss, and strutted naked out of the room.

THE BOX

We had dinner together upstairs, out on the terrace on the very top floor of the house. The view over the city and the bay was superb, you could even see Alcatraz, although the Golden Gate Bridge was obscured by houses. I provided the wine—a quick tour of our wine cellar was somewhat jaw-dropping—and Dana provided the food, in this case a delivery from a very fine Chinese restaurant, and even a set of candles.

It was quite romantic, as the sun dipped down toward the western horizon. I thought, perhaps, we could hang out there all evening, catching up, enjoying each other's company, perhaps even enlightening me about my forgotten past, and whatever had been wrong with our marriage.

Separate bedrooms?

Arguments about late night porn?

A friend of a friend taking pictures of Dana while she had an intimate lunch with another man?

None of it felt right, considering the heat of the passion between us since I'd emerged from hospital. I needed answers. Dana was mine, and I wanted her with my whole being, but I felt that if we'd had major cracks in our relationship prior to my coma, there was a danger those cracks could open up again if I wasn't careful.

But as we came to the end of our food, Dana glanced at her watch, and hissed. ‘I forgot, I have a conference call at eight. Damn it.’

‘A conference call?’ I felt disappointed. She seemed a hard-working woman, despite the fact that the economy was locked down at the moment, and we were apparently rather comfortable financially.

She sighed. ‘We’re talking to a company in Tokyo about taking the app into the Japanese market.’

‘Oh, right.’ I felt I ought to know which app we were talking about, but I didn’t ask.

‘It won’t be more than an hour or two,’ she said, picking herself up.

I started feeling butterflies, a giddy feeling deep inside. My raging hormones were taking her statement to mean that after an hour or two, she’d come back to me, and then what would we do with ourselves, late at night during lockdown?

I wondered how long I’d have this new relationship energy. Whether at some point my body would remember I was 46 years old and go back to not having erections every five minutes.

Whether, at some point, it would no longer seem so incredible that I was able, occasionally, to make love to a goddess like Dana Sullivan. It had happened before, apparently. Could it happen again, now that I’d had my eyes re-opened concerning the beauty who was my wife?

‘It’s okay,’ I said, casually. ‘We have all the time in the world, right?’

‘Right,’ she smiled, and I saw her eyes roaming my body. The way she looked at me made me feel like a Titan. But I knew it was partly the result of the lockdown, partly the fact that she was starved of all other male contact, all other male physical attention. If she had been permitted to see her CrossFit guy, would she be as interested in sex with me right now? I wasn’t sure. But I had to believe she’d seen the opportunity to reconnect with her husband, to patch up her marriage, because of the state of my mind after I returned from hospital.

I watched her walk inside, toward the elevator, swaying her behind like a catwalk model. She had to know I was watching her. She was a fox.

But now I had an hour or two to kill.

I could have stayed out there on the terrace, enjoying the view and the rest of the wine and killed the time on my iPhone. I did pull it out and started scrolling through the news.

Fauci Warns US is 'going in the wrong direction' and could see 100,000 coronavirus cases a day.

Fighting Over Masks In Public Is the New American Pastime.

Police Are Clearing Seattle's Protest 'Autonomous Zone'.

Drug Overdoses Are Soaring During the Pandemic.

That was all it took to put it away. Too much bad news, when I had a wealth of more interesting stuff inside.

I went down the stairs, rather than taking the elevator. I could have dumped myself down in the extensive TV room, where there was a television as large as a cinema screen, and Dana had said I could watch almost any movie or TV program ever made, at the touch of a few buttons. 'Streaming', she called it. But that felt rather overwhelming to me, too.

So I wandered through the house.

I wasn't in any kind of rush, since my main aim was really to waste a bit of time before I could see Dana again. I guess I was trying to jog my memory a little.

At the other end of the building, I found a bedroom that was conspicuously feminine in its decor and soft furnishings—and, as I walked inside, I saw that there was actually clutter in here, female clutter. Perfume bottles and makeup strewn across the dressing table. Jewelry—expensive-looking, too—literally dumped everywhere. A box of tissues, a stack of well-thumbed romance novels and a battered alarm clock on one of the bedside tables, water bottle and sleep mask on the other.

There were feminine toiletries galore in the en suite bathroom, and when I looked for the walk-in closet in the most logical place, I found it was stocked full of stylish feminine clothing—it was like Saks Fifth Avenue crammed into one room.

So, separate bedrooms, then. This was Dana's.

I opened a few drawers—feeling a touch guilty for snooping, and yet I felt justified, because there seemed to be plenty of things that Dana was not telling me.

She had a lot of very expensive-looking underwear. Seriously sexy stuff.

In one of her bedside tables, I found a bottom drawer containing some leather items that a quick glance made me almost believe might be horse-riding equipment. On closer examination, these were not items for controlling a horse, however. About the most innocent thing I picked out of there was a studded dog collar—and we definitely didn't have a dog. There were also two sets of leather things that I thought might be handcuffs, except that they appeared to be made for someone with one normal-sized wrist and one giant wrist. It took me a few minutes of thinking time to work out that, perhaps, they were designed to cuff her wrists to her thighs. My manhood thickened up rapidly, imagining Dana with her wrists cuffed to her thighs.

Were the two of us into this kind of kinky sex?

Or was this something she'd enjoyed with her CrossFit trainer?

My heart spun with a confused mix of excitement and horror.

What was this, a ball gag? Something that looked like a fine silver necklace, but which was connected to things I could only guess were nipple clamps.

And here was a leash. Again: no dog in this household.

Did she have a secret kinky side she'd kept hidden from her husband? I felt a little frightened of it, and yet at the same time it turned me on like crazy. I liked thinking that she had a secret kinky side. Hidden layers of

pure raunch. Sure, it was a shame if she felt forced to pursue such interests with external contractors.

But wasn't this all an opportunity for me to reconnect with her on various levels, and re-inject serious spice into our marriage?

I put the stuff back. Ducked down, glanced under the bed. There was something under there, toward the headboard where it was almost hidden by the shadows. A box. I fished it out of there. It was a little black lock box. Big enough to contain papers, or enough money to pay off a kidnapper. Locked, of course. But that only added to its intrigue.

What would she keep locked up in a little secret box under the bed, if she kept her kinky sex gear in an unlocked drawer, and her expensive jewelry completely out in the open?

Secret, secret. She has so many secrets.

It happened again, just as before, my memory returning like an unannounced—yet not entirely unwelcome—guest. This one was better than the last. This one came from the beginning of things, before we were Damien and Dana.

'WE SHOULDN'T BE DOING THIS,' she whispered, but didn't push me away as I pushed her into the empty catering closet.

'We shouldn't, no.' The door clicked behind us, shutting us in the dark. 'But doesn't that just make it more exciting?'

I traced my hands over her body, feeling the satin of the floor-length evening gown that I'd been admiring all evening long. Black and suitable for the gala we were both at, a dress like that was unforgiving on a woman, and Dana had a body to pull it off.

I pulled her into a kiss, one hand on the nape of her neck, the other pulling her hips against me—against the erection I'd been nursing all night

long.

She resisted... for about half-a-second. That was the practical Dana, the one that calculated what this would do to us if we were discovered. Then the mutual attraction that both of us had been suppressing for the past six months took over. She found my cock as I finally got to touch her ass.

Beneath the satin, she wore nothing. I gasped. It spurred me on.

We kissed deeper into the room, groping in the dark, until we came up against a prep table. My eyes adjusted to the dark just enough to see the whites of her eyes flashing up at me. 'I'm going to fuck you,' I said.

She shuddered. She was a good girl. She prided herself on being all business, on gaining success through merit and hard work, not her femininity. And she didn't sneak out of parties to have casual sex.

I saw all those considerations tumble through her in the dark, and it made this moment so much sexier. It made the moment when she nodded almost orgasmic.

I didn't wait for her to change her mind. I kissed her again before turning her, before hiking up her long, satin gown. Her legs were as toned as the rest of her body suggested—runner's legs, dancer's legs—made even sexier by the tall heels she wore.

And there was her ass, a work of art, plush and round and toned. Bending her over the prep table, I released my cock, rolled on a condom, and entered her from behind. She was so wet. So ready for this.

I covered her mouth as I fucked her doggy-style, stifling her moans. We hadn't even locked the fucking door, I realized, and the risk of being caught only added to the excitement. She clutched the edge of the table, holding on as I rode her in the dark as a party carried on just down the hall.

It didn't last more than a few minutes. It was too wild, too out-of-control for this to be more than what it was. At the time, that's all I thought our relationship would be. I was the investor. She was the recipient. After that night, we would go our separate ways.

“Mmm... ugh!” She barked a loud gasp before I could silence her. My hackles went up. The tension rose through me, triggered me. I thrust forward, burying ball deep in her sex as I exploded hard enough that she could feel it through the latex.

In the come down, in the dark, we reveled in one another’s heavy breathing.

‘This cannot happen again,’ she said as we straightened up. I pulled the condom off and dropped it into a wastebasket. ‘You can’t tell anyone about this.’

‘I won’t if you won’t.’

‘I won’t,’ she reassured.

And she didn’t. Not even to me, years later, when I’d lost my memory. What other secrets had she kept?

I BLINKED, and the memory is gone, but not forgotten. I was shaking. I was once again in Dana’s bedroom, holding a black box that held more secrets.

What was in the box? I toyed with the lock. It didn’t seem like the most secure thing. Perhaps all it would need to open was a small screwdriver. I was already thinking about YouTube and videos on picking locks when I heard a noise—Dana’s voice.

She was coming. I glanced around. From the sound of it, she was out in the hallway. She’d see me if I left the room, and my mind was too cluttered with secrets and half-secrets and the hint of potential secrets to uncover in order to come up with any kind of a credible excuse for being in her bedroom. The only alternative was to hide.

I thought about the walk-in closet. The en suite bathroom. Both were cavernous. Both seemed like places she could need access to if she was headed this way.

‘...I can’t believe you went to the beach in the middle of lockdown...’

No time to think. I was on the floor by the bed. I noticed that there was room under the bed for a person to just about squeeze in. Grabbing the box, I crawled under just as I heard the door open.

‘Uh-huh, uh-huh...’

From under the bed, I watched as Dana entered the room. All I could see were her feet in a pair of strappy Jimmy Choo shoes. I hugged the floor tight and watched her walk toward me.

Did she know I was here? Had I left telltale signs that I’d been looking through her stuff?

She seemed to pause right next to the bed.

‘Seriously?’

I tried to keep the sound of my breathing to a complete minimum.

She sat on the bed, right above me.

‘...well, *yeah*, I slept with him. And you would have too, if you’d been on your own as long as I have, with nothing but Pornhub and a vibrator for company...’

CALL TO A FRIEND

‘**Y**ou would not believe how hot it was.’
From the tone and content of her call, I figured out pretty quickly that she was talking to a close friend, but I couldn’t hear who she was talking to.

‘...Oh my God, he’s like, super fit...’

As I lay there listening to her, my first thought was that she was talking about sleeping with her CrossFit guy before I’d returned from the hospital. I simmered in my own mixed feelings—that sharpness of jealousy blended with the sweet warmth of uncut sexual arousal—and wondered if Dana had broken lockdown rules in order to fuck him.

‘...well, maybe not completely *fit*, but he lost a lot of weight in the hospital, and I’m supposed to help him work on getting his strength back...’

It was a bit of a surprise to hear that she was talking about me. A disappointment, actually, at first.

‘No, no. I told you they thought he had some memory loss, right? Well... yeah... it’s like he can’t remember anything. Not from the last decade, maybe the last 20 years.’

But then, I started to think maybe overhearing her talking to her best friend would let me know what she was really thinking about me. About us. This could be useful.

‘...I swear, it’s like he’s a different person. More like he was when we were dating...’

I wasn’t sure I liked the man that I was before eI caught the coronavirus.

‘No, it’s not even like he was when we were *dating*. He’s... softer, now. And, like, *so* much more attentive. I mean, he’s so *nice*.’

Well, that had to be a good thing, right? At least I’d come out of the hospital a better man, and not the other way around.

But then she said, ‘To be honest, I’d say... he’s not really my type...’

I felt a jolt of pain and shock tear through my heart.

‘...but God, it’s so nice... being with him... and, you know, yeah, falling in love with him all over again... and making love to him... I know, he’s not exactly been much of an alpha, but...’

I heard Dana giggle, and though she’d taken the edge of my pain and embarrassment by stating that she liked being with me—and, yeah, hearing that she might be falling in love with me again warmed me up considerably, though it was sad to think she might have fallen out of love with me in the first place—I was horrified to think she was laughing with her friend about how I made love to her.

‘...no, seriously. It’s totally different. And, yeah, I love it. I mean, it’s just so unexpected. Probably helps that I’m horny as hell, like, all the time. You know we did it in the car on the way back from the hospital?’

I relaxed a little more. She wasn’t laughing at me, perhaps. She was just surprised by the change in me. And though I wasn’t, apparently, her ‘type’, at least she seemed to be suggesting she enjoyed being with me—and she enjoyed fucking me.

I thought about her CrossFit guy. My manhood stiffened up fully as I lay on it. Was he her type? Presumably he was more of an alpha.

‘Oh God, you know he made me come with his mouth?’

My ears pricked up.

‘I swear. It never happened before... no, really. It was the most incredible god damn thing,’ Dana cackled, but it didn’t feel like she was making fun of me, so I remained calm. ‘I swear, if I hadn’t had his beautiful cock in my mouth at the time, I might have believed I had a woman underneath me.’

Dana... had a same-sex experience?

She laughed. ‘Okay, so maybe it turns out he is my type after all. Jesus. I want more of that.’

I couldn’t help but think how it had been. How hot to be wedged between her thighs, lapping at her exquisite pussy. My memory of it was even hotter now that I had confirmation she had enjoyed it so much as well.

I was salivating, thinking about it.

I was kind of humping the floor, too, but I had to stop that or else I’d end up coming in my pants.

‘...I don’t know about that. I mean, I’m not sure he’d even let me. And you know I have a weakness for... yeah, I should. But it’s hard to, you know? I mean, it’s different.’

I drifted in and out of her conversation with her friend, but a lot of it was her friend doing the talking, and Dana only making interested noises, and some of it when Dana was talking I had no idea what she was talking about because I had none of the context.

But it did answer a few questions, and it did pose a few new questions.

It definitely felt better to know that our relationship was nicely on the way to a repair, that she did love me, that she did enjoy intimacy with me. More than enjoyed, in fact. That was a bit of a buzz to know.

Had there been any insight into whether or not she’d had an affair before I’d gone into hospital? Well, maybe not, but it certainly hadn’t ruled one out. I felt strangely hopeful about that. God, I was a freak. Had my coma messed me up? It did feel, strangely, as though I preferred the thought that she had had an affair before my illness, to the thought that she hadn’t.

Probably because the thought of her not having an affair while she'd been married to Ebenezer Scrooge was rather sad. I loved her, dearly, and I preferred the thought that she'd been happy all the time we'd been married, even if I'd been a dick in recent years.

Anyway. Her call was over, and I started thinking she'd probably want to go downstairs and look for me, particularly if her friend had gotten her thinking about sex again. So how could I escape this bedroom and make it seem like I'd been in another part of the house all this time?

I waited a few moments, expecting her to head back out of the bedroom. I was biding my time until I felt safe enough to emerge, and then scurry whichever way she hadn't gone—either downstairs, if she went back up to the roof terrace to see if I was still up there, or upstairs to the roof terrace if she went downstairs, figuring I was watching TV down there. I could tailor my cover story to match.

But then, as I waited there under the bed, something fell on the floor out in front of me. A Gucci skirt.

Then a blouse joined the skirt there on the carpet.

A bra.

Her panties.

Wow, were they wet? I could see the dampness in the material. Her phone call with her friend—talking about having sex with me—had gotten her all horny again. Well, that brought me back up to full hardness again.

But now I saw her pad across the carpet toward the bathroom, and though I could only see her below the knees from my angle, when she was in the bathroom, I heard the sound of a shower starting up. She was going to take a shower before coming to find me?

The bathroom door closed. My heart rate quickened.

Now was the time I could get out of here, slither out from under the bed, make a run for the door. Get down to the TV room and act as though I'd been there all along.

But something gave me pause. While I was plucking up the courage to flee, my foot hit the little black box hidden by the headboard. I caught my breath. Dana's secret box.

I glanced out from the bed, my eyes taking in the sight of Dana's clothes abandoned on the floor. Was she completely naked, there in the bathroom? If she was, and now that I heard the sound of the shower flow change, proving that someone had stepped under the flow of the water, I figured that was confirmation enough... she couldn't possibly have her keys in there with her, could she?

I scurried out from under the bed, feeling guilty, feeling terrified that she could just step out of the bathroom at any time, without warning. Perhaps she'd forgotten to take her towel in there. Or she needed a new razor to shave her incredibly smooth pussy.

I did a cursive search of the premises, and saw that she'd left her phone on the bed. But where were her keys? Did people keep sets of keys about their person these days? Where would Dana put hers?

One more slight pause to check she was still in the shower, the water tumbling all over her gorgeous body. Check. I started a frantic search—starting with the clothing she'd only just taken off, which offered no pockets, and so no keys, and leading me around the bedroom once more.

Damn it. Such a good idea, too.

I tried to imagine myself in her place. If I tended to wear clothing that didn't include pockets, where would I keep my keys? Then I figured that actually, what with the lockdown, Dana didn't have to leave the house very often. From what I'd been told by the outpatient team before I'd come home, the lockdown meant you weren't really supposed to leave the house except to get essential supplies or go for some daily exercise in a park or somewhere near your home. Dana had been getting food and supplies delivered—but did she leave the house to exercise?

I slipped into the walk-in closet, and looked for her workout clothes, her sportswear. Here it was—she had plenty, a whole rail of skin-tight tops and shorts, a whole drawer of sports bras and thongs. Brands I didn't recognize—Lululemon, Alo Yoga, Athleta. And then there were the shoes, a whole rack of futuristic-looking trainers in bright colors and various states of wear.

In the drawer, I found a belt which, from its size, I had to assume she wore around her waist while she went running. The belt had a little pouch in it—and in that, a small set of keys. Alleluja. Actually, there were only two little keys, and a number of key fob things I assumed would open doors electronically somehow. But one of the keys looked like the type you might open a fairly simple lock box with.

I moved quickly. Silently. Slipping out of the walk-in closet, listening for the reassuring sound of the shower still flowing over Dana's delicious frame.

I dived under the bed once again. Pulled out the box. Tried the key.

The box opened.

And I heard Dana turn off the shower.

Jesus.

I had to get out of there. Now.

BLAST FROM THE PAST

I was caught in a dilemma. I didn't have time to do anything. Dana would be out of the bathroom in a moment. The shower was off. But I desperately needed to know what was in that box.

In that moment, I fully comprehended why curiosity had the power to kill the cat.

I probably should have just dropped everything and run. I could come back in here some other time, when Dana was busy working, on a conference call or whatever, and finish up prying into her secrets. But I wanted to know, and I was paranoid she'd realize that I'd been invading her privacy.

I glanced inside the box.

And felt instantly disappointed. It was full of papers—computer print-outs, actually. Emails, judging by the headers.

Where were the fake passports and ID cards for her other, secret identities? The stacks of foreign currencies in case her cover was blown and she had to leave the country? Where were the SD cards on which I might find camcorder footage of Dana engaged in really desperately filthy adulterous sex with her CrossFit trainer, or any number of other awful alpha jocks? The stack of sexploitation DVDs that featured Dana as a college girl stripping and fucking on camera for tuition fees?

But I didn't have time to sit there and be disappointed.

I did, however, have a rather wonderful brainwave.

Quickly, quietly, I pulled my iPhone out of my pocket, and tapped on the camera app. Within a couple of seconds, I'd snapped photographs of some of the emails—there was a stack of them, but my curiosity only needed a representative sample to start working out why these emails were kept in a little secret lock-box under Dana's bed.

Then I rapidly replaced the emails in the lockbox, locked it, shoved it back under the bed in near enough the place I'd found it—and then I rushed into Dana's walk-in closet to replace her keys in her running pouch.

After that, I made for the door, pushing myself so hard as I ran across the open expanse of Dana's enormous bedroom that my leg muscles hurt.

I paused outside her bedroom doorway, gasping for breath while trying not to make a sound—no easy feat in itself—while listening to determine whether she'd come out of the bathroom yet, and whether she'd seen my escape. Moments passed. My breathing became a little easier. Then, finally, I heard the bathroom door opening, and the sound of Dana humming a cheerful little tune as she emerged into the bedroom—apparently none the wiser that I had ever been there.

Phew. I wasn't cut out for this cloak and dagger stuff.

I slunk away down the hallway, down the stairs, down to the TV room where I could find a movie on Netflix that didn't make me feel like I had no idea what was going on in the world. *Groundhog Day*. Here we go.

But my curiosity wasn't going to allow me to just lounge around watching Bill Murray's character running into Ned Ryerson over and over again. I had a limited time before Dana showed up, and I wanted to know what was in those secret emails of hers. I pulled out my iPhone and tapped on the first picture I'd taken.

It was amazing how easy the technology was to use despite not remembering how to use it. A couple taps and I was zoomed in so I could

read the email perfectly.

...God, you're a hot bitch. If I was there right now, I'd bend you over this table, pull down your tight jeans and spank that gorgeous heinie of yours until your cheeks were glowing red and that delightful little pussy of yours was so damn wet I could slide a baseball bat in there...

Jesus. Just glancing at a paragraph, and I was rock hard. Who was this email from? I peered at the top of the paper. It said it was from a John Riley. The email address was a Stanford one, as was Dana's. Didn't these guys know how risky it was sending explicit emails to each other over a college email system?

The 'sent' date made me do a double-take. Tuesday, October 29, 2002.

This email had been sent nearly 18 years ago. Dana had been, what, 20, 21? Clearly, she'd been in college. She'd saved all these emails since then?

Here, at the beginning of this email, it said:

Dana,

I know it's been hard, but you know you can't go against your parents' wishes. And even though we've only been able to communicate via email in the past eight weeks or so, I can tell how much you've progressed during your time in Rome already. The increase in your self-confidence has been inspiring to see, and I've no doubt this whole year abroad will put you in such a strong position for the future.

I've been missing you, too, you know I have. But I know you'll be back here in the States in less than two months, for Christmas, and then we'll be able to see each other again...

So she'd spent a year in Rome while she'd been studying at Stanford. That didn't seem surprising to me, as though I kind of knew that already. But who was this she'd been corresponding with during that time? Her

college lover? His tone of voice seemed too mature for a college boy, though.

I scanned through some of the rest of that email, and saw a reference to an assignment he'd set the Freshman class—this guy was a professor? Scandalous.

I flicked to the next photo, showing another of the emails Dana had treasured since October 2002, and I could tell why she'd kept it secret:

I cannot wait to see you again. You'll come into my office, just like the first time, wearing a long black coat and black boots. You'll have your collar. 'I need guidance from you, Professor,' you'll say, and we'll both know what you want. To be dominated.

Pulling open your coat, you'll show off that stunning body in just a lacy black bra and panties. Just like when we first met. Just like when you leaned over my desk and presented me with a god damn ball gag.

God, what a great fuck that was. It will be again. I'll push your chest flat against my desk. I'll spank you until your cheeks turn pink. I'll make you hold that pose as I pace the room, so exposed, so vulnerable.

I'll yank those panties down. I'll eat you. Force my tongue into you. Poor little college girl, tired of all the boring little Freshman guys around you. Nobody ever made you come like that before, and now you crave it.

But I won't let you come. No, not yet. That tight little cunt of your comes on my dick, and my dick alone. We'll fuck so hard the desk scraps across the floor, just like the first time.

Then, and only then, will you get to come.

That's what you get to look forward to when you come back from Rome...

Wow. I know this was such a long time ago, but Jesus. I recalled other women I'd been in long-term relationships with—even ones I'd been in short-term relationships with—and I remember not wanting to know anything at all about their previous lovers. But here I was, reading in detail about how one of Dana's past lovers had been with her—had fucked her—and I wasn't feeling jealousy at all. Just very, very turned on.

Maybe it was because it was all so long ago. And yet, she'd kept these emails all this time. I remember the paper hadn't been crisp and pristine—they had been well-read, over and over again. Dana repeatedly came back to these in the years since they'd been sent. They must have turned her on as much as they turned me on.

There were more photos, but before I could swipe to them, Dana padded into the room, bare-foot and wearing an elegant, silken pajama set. Despite what I'd just read, and despite all of the crazy sex that we had just had, this semi-conservative look suited her. It felt right. While everything was so foggy, this was in character.

'There you are. Those things are pretty addictive, aren't they?' she said, seeing me on the phone. I quickly darkened it before she could see what I was reading. She leaned down to kiss me on the side of the cheek. Her hair was still damp from the shower. 'I thought you'd have passed out by now.'

'I guess I'm getting my strength back.' I felt tense, and had to force myself to relax. Why had she taken a third shower of the day? While my mind raced to all kinds of reasons, I decided to just ask it. 'Are you always this... hygienic?'

'Hm?'

'Just... you smell like you just took a shower is all. Maybe things have changed in the last two decades...' I heard how this came off, sounding accusatory. I winced and tried to change tact. 'Should I be taking more showers?'

She laughed, but I swear she was hiding something. ‘Well, you’re responsible for the second shower, you know.’ She plopped down beside me on the couch. At least she wasn’t running. ‘And I like taking a shower before bed. Helps me sleep.’

That made sense. Still, I couldn’t help thinking that there was something else. I let it go. I had so many other things on my mind.

‘We... we weren’t in a good place before... before I got sick. Were we?’

I got the feeling that she was expecting this topic to come up, just not so soon. She didn’t lie, though, for which I was grateful. ‘No. No, we weren’t.’ She offered a wan smile. ‘You remembering again?’

I shook my head. ‘No, just things I’ve noticed.’ Here, I saw her tense. There was no mistake. I could practically see her running a catalog of things in her mind—what did I know, what could I have seen? I wanted to put her mind at ease. ‘My room, for one thing. None of your things are in there.’

She frowned. ‘Because you snore?’

‘Is that what you told the old me?’

‘It is.’

‘And the old me didn’t challenge that?’

She started to say something, caught herself, then looked away.

‘What?’ I took her hand. ‘Tell me. I’m listening.’

When she looked up at me, her expression was one of incredulous curiosity. Like she’d just learned that the earth was round. Like how I’d felt every waking minute since opening my eyes a week ago.

‘The old you barely cared.’

‘That can’t be true.’ But deep down, I knew that it was. Another memory formed, this one more a feeling than an event. Me, Damien Sullivan, working on my computer as Dana told me something that I only half listened to, only half-cared about. ‘I don’t understand. How could I...?’

She shrugged. ‘It happens. There’s a reason you’re so successful. I knew it coming into the marriage. I just thought that one of us could change.’

‘They say that no one really changes unless you go through some major life event.’ I smiled at her. ‘Can you think of one like that?’

It was meant to be a light joke to clear the air

‘It’s so strange,’ she was saying, drawing me out of the memory. ‘I can’t get over it. You look like you, but...’ She shook her head. ‘But you’re not you.’

‘I know how hard this must be for you—’

‘For me? It’s nothing compared to what you must be going through. I just can’t imagine.’

I had such an outpouring of love for this woman. How could I have taken her for granted? If she did cheat, I was beginning to understand why.

And there it was again—the fluttering, the thickening of my blood, the tingling in my balls and at the base of my scalp. *If she did cheat...* It left me breathless.

‘I think I’m ready to go to bed,’ I said, standing at last. ‘Any chance I could tempt you to join me? I promise I’ll try not to snore.’

Dana laughed, giddy and youthful and refreshing. It was how she laughed when we’d first met, I knew. How I’d made her laugh before we were an item, when we were flirting, when we were tempted to do something against the rules.

She said, ‘I suppose I’m willing to give you a second chance...’

And that night, remarkably, we made love again. Third time in one day. Not bad for a man of 46.

THE NEXT DAY, I slept in. This time, however, when I looked to Dana’s side of the bed, I was happy to see it rumpled. She’d been there. She’d stayed.

We'd slept together, not just *slept* together. I was happy enough that I almost turned over and went back to sleep. Almost. Instead, I remembered the last images I'd taken from that black box.

When I did, I was wide awake with my heart pounding and my gut tightening in anticipation. Could anything really top what I'd already read? I grabbed my phone from the nightstand, unlocked it like I'd been doing it for years—and to be fair, I actually *had* been doing it for years, and started reading.

Dana, you naughty little tease!

That photo makes me want to do very naughty things to you. Only one more month until you're back and I can promise you, I'll have you on your knees, just like that, naked and with your arms bound behind your back. I will use your slut mouth. I will fuck your slut throat. And you will come without me touching you once.

I think, my pet, that you are ready for a new first, and your next lesson in submission will begin today. You are no longer allowed to come by any means—not alone, not with others. No more orgasms until it's by my hand. What you will be doing is playing with yourself. Every night before you go to sleep. I want you edged. I want you on edge.

And Dana... I will know if you disobey me. And if you disobey me, these lessons will end.

Your Dom, JR

There was only one other letter that I'd managed to take a photo of, although there were dozens more locked away. This one was short, sweet, and left me dizzy with arousal and amazement.

Instructions for your return:

I want you wearing your lowest hip-hugging jeans.

I want you wearing your smallest g-string with the straps showing above the jeans

I want you to wear your most padded of Miracle bras.

I want you wearing your tightest top, short enough to show off all that skin above your waist. Short enough to show off the g-string.

I want all the men to want to fuck you.

I want the stewardesses not to be able to take their eyes off your cleavage.

I want you to find a salon there in Rome and wax yourself into a narrow little landing strip.

Lastly, but certainly not least, I want you to wear your butt plug the whole flight home.

I want you ready.

I want you prepared.

Because when I see you next, the first place you will feel my cock is in the beautiful, round, delicious ass of yours.

And we have only just begun.

Getting out of bed felt like waking from my coma all over again—waking to a strange, new world to me. Everything was sort of familiar, yet nothing made sense. Dana, for example. I didn't *remember* her, but I did *know* her. The amnesia was blocking the memories, but they were still there. I could almost feel them.

But I was pretty sure that the Dana from these letters wasn't the Dana that the old me knew. The one that paced her office with a hands-free headset as she spoke business on a conference call, or had meetings with clients in Tokyo to get into new markets—that's the Dana that felt like the one I married. She was all business, strong and independent and in command of her world.

These letters, though, and all the toys hidden away with her things, spoke of a different side of her. A side that I didn't think I could fulfill—either the old me, and certainly not the new one. Was that what I was afraid of before? Is that what I'd discovered in those last few weeks before the coronavirus changed everything?

If so, I wasn't afraid now. No. As I climbed from the bed, my legs shaking now not from being weak, but from the current of excitement and desire surging through me, I wasn't afraid at all. I took a deep breath, ready for a new and crazy day.

HISTORY

I wandered down, feeling nicely rested, satisfied with life. The knowledge that Dana had slept with me through the night was strangely validating. Like, somehow, it promised we could do this, we could rebuild our marriage, we could clean our slate and forget about past problems.

When I reached the first floor, I heard a familiar rhythmic thumping sound from the basement, and knew that Dana was likely in the middle of another CrossFit class. I felt a flicker of arousal between my legs as I thought of her working up a sweat in her tight, revealing workout clothes.

I felt an even stronger flicker of arousal as I thought about her doing it in front of that well-hung CrossFit trainer.

Had she really had an affair with him before lockdown?

I didn't really have definitive proof. I knew I'd had suspicions before contracting COVID. I had photographs of Dana enjoying a relaxed lunch with Mr CrossFit at some restaurant—but if there had been a picture of her properly kissing him, then it hadn't been in the pile I'd found in my desk.

I suppose if I'd been a normal husband, I'd have gone straight down to the basement to switch off that enormous TV and demand that Dana find a different streaming CrossFit class with a different instructor. Probably one who didn't flaunt his bulge at all the women taking the class.

But I didn't. I felt relaxed about it. I felt gently thrilled by it.

I liked feeling that I could leave her to enjoy her time with him, while I went into the kitchen to find a light breakfast in order to placate my growling stomach.

I supposed that as far as I was concerned, we were starting afresh after my coma, from a clean slate. I wasn't the same man I had been before. She'd probably had every reason to cheat on the man I'd been then. I had taken her for granted, I had been inattentive, I had been hooked on work and convenient pornography. If she could forgive me for being an icy Scrooge, then I could forgive her past transgressions.

It didn't even feel like she'd cheated on me.

We'd turned a new leaf.

At the same time, she was still seeing her CrossFit trainer—although she couldn't see him physically because of the pandemic—she was still taking his classes. Wouldn't she stop all that, if she was trying to actively move on from how things had been before my coma?

But I found I didn't necessarily want her to move on from everything. I thought about those letters from her college professor. The fact that she'd kept them, treasured them so many years. She needed that kind of sex, she needed to submit to a powerful male—she was a strong, independently-minded and very successful woman who needed some kind of submissive release every now and then. But I felt certain I couldn't provide that. I felt confident, in fact—judging by the way she'd kept those letters close by her all these years—that I'd never been able to do that for her.

I couldn't see myself spanking her.

I couldn't see myself gagging her, tying her up, slamming my dick inside her hard enough to move the furniture to which she clung.

I couldn't even really see myself ordering her to use a butt plug so that she'd be ready for me to force my cock into her ass.

It was strangely sexy to think of someone else doing it for her, though, if she really wanted it. If she needed it. It was sexy to think of her as having a dark side, sexually. Sexy to think of her having secrets.

After my breakfast, I felt like a little fresh air, to clear my head and try to break the feeling of being confined—a feeling I probably shouldn't have had, given the extraordinary proportions of this magnificently decadent house, but which I was feeling all the same.

Dana's CrossFit class was still in full flow. I felt vaguely tempted to go watch her, to ogle her from behind the doorway. I didn't want to interrupt her, though—and there was plenty of time for me to see her in, and out, of tight clothing when she was done. One thing my recovery had made me certain of, was that there was plenty of time for things. I didn't have to rush. I wasn't a workaholic anymore—I'd forgotten almost everything about my business—but the trappings of my success meant at least I didn't have to worry about money.

Clutching a cup of coffee from the Keurig machine, I slipped out of the grand front door, and was hit by the outside air. Fresh, maybe even with a hint of the ocean. I gazed out from the lavish white circular portico, with its Italianesque round white columns, just stunned that this was my home. The front garden wasn't much to speak of—a mass of vegetation that probably could have used a little attention from a gardener—but this was incredible real estate, stupendous architecture, and as I glanced up and down the street, which rose steeply to my right, and fell just as steeply down to my left toward the blue water of San Francisco Bay. Beyond the bay, I guessed, in this direction, that would be Oakland. I could tell this must have been a highly sought-after neighborhood.

Hmm. Maybe later I'd look to see if we had any hedge trimmers or something like that. Have a go at hacking back some of that overgrown tangle.

There was no traffic at all. I couldn't even hear any traffic noise from nearby. Lockdown, huh? Everybody was staying home. No wonder I could smell the ocean—air pollution levels around here must have dropped precipitously.

Clutching my coffee, I wandered out onto the street, to get a better feel for my neighborhood. The house was at the corner of the block, and the street running down its side offered me a view northwards, though from the street I couldn't quite see Alcatraz or the Golden Gate Bridge. I wandered downhill under leafy sycamore trees, just marveling at the size of the house I apparently owned. How much had it to be worth, in the middle of San Francisco? Millions, certainly, with views like these. All the houses around it were pretty substantial, too.

'Hey!'

At the sound of the voice, I paused at a round arched doorway at the rear of the house that must have led into the paved courtyard at the back of the property.

'Sullivan!'

I turned. And looked up. I spotted an older man—in his sixties, I would have said—standing at the open second-floor window of another imposing Classical Revival home overlooking Scott Street. He was smiling, and waved as though he knew me well. I had no idea who he was, but I supposed he was a neighbor, and he was as housebound as I was. As an older man, I knew for a fact that he was more at risk from the pandemic. I might not have known much about the past twenty years, but I knew COVID.

I waved back, mirroring his friendly smile, hoping that this is how he would expect me to behave, even if I remembered who he was. He put a hand beside his mouth as though it would amplify his voice, and bellowed: 'Good to see you back, buddy!'

‘Thanks!’ I called back, feeling slightly awkward not to be able to use his name. I distracted him from it by turning the spotlight back on him: ‘You’re looking well?’

He laughed. ‘I’ve been self-isolating for years!’

Well. He brayed down something about passing on his best wishes to my lovely wife, and I gave him another polite wave and then turned into the doorway back into my property, praying that it would open, although I didn’t have keys with me. No luck. I made it look as though I was checking that the doorway was sufficiently secure, and then trudged on around the block—glancing up to see that my neighbor had disappeared from his window.

The other side of our block comprised smaller houses, but I was fairly certain they were probably still worth a packet. I toddled on, then turned back up toward Pacific, where the houses grew in size again, though none of them seemed quite as large, or classically elegant, as my own pile.

As I approached, the front door opened and there was Dana, still in her workout gear, much to my delight, and apparently still out of breath.

‘There you are!’ she said, and I felt quietly reassured by her apparent concern for my whereabouts.

‘I felt like a walk,’ I said, innocently.

‘You weren’t in your bedroom—I went looking for you,’ she smiled, and put a hand on her hip with a touch of sass. ‘And here you are.’

I chuckled. I guess I had just walked all the way around the block dressed in my pajamas and a bathrobe. I probably looked like I’d escaped from an asylum.

‘Here I am,’ I said, marveling at her beauty as I climbed the steps back up to the portico.

Her skin was still slightly shiny from sweat—from her workout, and no doubt from her search of the house. I approached her, just stunned by the sight of her, by the fact that this was the woman to whom I was married. I

leaned in for a kiss, and she seemed a touch reluctant—I could tell it was because she had not yet showered. But when my lips touched against hers, and I moaned at the softness and the warmth of her mouth, she melted into me.

I was rock hard again before our kiss was even half completed.

‘Come on, we should go inside,’ she said, when we eventually released each other from our embrace.

I glanced around, to see if any other neighbors were at their windows, perhaps watching us make a spectacle of ourselves on our doorstep. There was nobody I could see.

‘You’re done with your fitness class?’ I asked her.

‘Uh-huh,’ she grinned, clutching my hand as we went back inside. ‘I thought you might like to join me in the shower again.’

‘Sounds good.’

‘You have a Zoom call—a conference call—with your doctor at three, but before then, maybe we’ll have time to look at some photos, try and work on your memory?’

I smiled. My hardness throbbed from the promise of a shower with her.

This was a hell of a way to recover from amnesia.

SHOWERED, dressed, and pleasantly satisfied from a gentle, tender lovemaking that wasn’t overly demanding for either of us—just nice, after her strenuous workout, and the surprising amount of fatigue I had after my walk around the block in a neighborhood of steep slopes—we found ourselves in the cozy TV room, where Dana wanted to take me through some photographs we’d curated.

The pictures were apparently stored on her phone—but with a few taps on the screen, she was able to display them on the giant TV screen on the

wall.

Here was the industry gala where we'd first met. Where Dana, apparently, had seduced me the night after I'd put on a seminar about tech start-ups who wanted to attract interest from the venture capital community. Well, that connected with one of my resurfaced memories—except that as Dana told it, she had been the one pushing me into the empty catering closet desperate for sex, and I had been the one worried that someone would think I was exploiting a young woman looking for a toe into Silicon Valley success, telling her that this could not happen again, that she couldn't tell anyone about our little tryst.

'People found out we were seeing each other though?' I asked her.

'Of course,' she smiled. 'Our wedding was mentioned in the Chronicle's society pages.'

Most of the photographs she showed me did not come with memory snatches attached, however. And yet, it was me in many of the pictures, so it all came across as true and verifiable. It was reassuring, to be able to fill in the gaps, though there were progressively fewer and fewer pictures featuring the two of us together—and, as things went on fewer pictures featuring either one of us smiling or looking in any way happy—although it was quite clear as we moved from apartment to house to mansion that our individual careers were doing explosively well.

Towards the end, she was showing me pictures of industry events we attended together, where we looked like a staged couple. Garden parties. Award shows. We looked like a philandering politician and the wife who had to stand by him to protect his career and their lifestyle. But you could tell there was no real intimacy between us.

'I'm so sorry,' I said, as her documentary of our lives together came to an end. 'I am so, so sorry.'

She looked at me, and nodded. 'It wasn't just your fault,' she said, quietly. 'We both let things... get out of control.'

She leaned in, and we kissed again. It was so sweet, so warm, so loving. How could I have ever grown apart from her?

‘This is our second chance,’ she said, earnestly, and I felt like the luckiest man alive. ‘This is our opportunity to have the marriage we really want.’

I nodded. Kissed her again. It felt like heaven.

And yet, under the surface, I had simmering concerns. What if she realized, once all this settled down, that I still wasn’t the dominant, alpha lover that she craved? That I couldn’t ever match that professor of hers for pure, raw, even brutal power sex?

And what if I couldn’t let go of this strange attraction to the idea of her fulfilling her need for submission with another man?

THE REST of the day seemed to fall into a kind of routine that was comforting. I had a conference call with my doctor, to talk about how I was doing, how I was feeling, and how I could optimize my continuing recovery.

I enjoyed another sensual massage from Dana, and we even managed to just about keep it in the realms of physical therapy, rather than letting it veer into foreplay and outright sex.

‘If we just have sex every time I’m supposed to be working on your muscle tone, we’ll end up just having sex, and we’ll forget about the part that you really need,’ she pointed out when I was disappointed that she declined to attend to another of my monumental erections.

‘Maybe the sex is the part I really need,’ I said. ‘I mean... sex helps you with muscle tone, doesn’t it?’

She giggled. ‘I have strict instructions from your doctor on what you need.’

‘And he didn’t mention sex?’ I said in a tone of mock exasperation.

‘He told me to go easy on you when it came to sex.’

I shook my head. ‘I need to get another doctor.’

DANA STILL HAD her work calls to tend to, but I found myself drawn to the TV while she was busy, so that I could plough through the countless movies and TV shows I had no memory of ever watching—and hopefully pick up on the culture and societal context that was missing from my memory.

Flicking through the streaming services, initially I was drawn to TV shows more than movies, because it seemed more like I was connecting with real life. Having said that, though, I was watching *Lost* and *Breaking Bad* and *The Sopranos*, so it wasn’t as though it was strictly real life.

And then it was late, really late. Dana had let me get on with my TV viewing alone—but now I wandered upstairs to see if she was still taking business calls.

Was this how it had been with us before? Giving up evening time together to spend time on business? I felt an urge to remind her that things between us had cooled when we had allowed ourselves to spend too much time apart, too much time working.

But she wasn’t in her office.

Now it was my turn to search the house for her.

Eventually, I found her in my bedroom. She was sitting on the edge of my bed, wearing black thigh-high stockings and a black bra and panties that seemed to be made of leather, and in fact comprised a series of inter-linked leather straps. She was also wearing black velvet gloves that ran up to her elbows.

She looked stunning, of course. But also kind of kinky. What did she have in mind?

She smiled brightly as I entered and saw her. How long had she been sitting there waiting for me? She seemed calm, seemed as though she'd been there a while. Was this some kind of submission thing?

'Hey, there you are,' I said.

'I was waiting for you,' she said, smiling sweetly.

'How long have you been waiting? You should have texted me or something.'

Her laugh came a beat too late. I'd said the wrong thing. But I also didn't know what the right thing was here. She said, 'Not too long.'

She was sitting very stiffly, her legs crossed and her gloved hands in her lap. 'That's quite an outfit you're, um, wearing.' *Outfit? That didn't sound very tough.* 'I mean, you look amazing.'

And she smelled divine—a different perfume this time. Date perfume. She reached up, tugging at the bottom of my t-shirt.

'Thank you.' She scanned my chest once my shirt was gone, admiring me? Judging me? When she glanced up, I saw a level of submission in her that I hadn't seen since... well, since ever. It was the kind of look that I imagined she gave her prof. 'I have a present for you.'

She handed me something black. I glanced down, and unfurled it. It was made from cotton and adorned with leather straps. A blindfold.

'What's this?' I asked, stupidly.

'It's simple,' she said, turning away from me now, and pulling her hair back, almost into a ponytail, so that I could put the blindfold on her. 'You put it on me, and then... you're allowed to do whatever you want with me.'

SETBACK

My heart started thumping loudly.

My cock strained to escape my pants.

I could tell what she wanted. She wanted me to prove that I'd changed completely—that I could be the dominant male she needed to complete her perfect life. But though I wanted to give her what she needed, desperately, I still didn't feel remotely qualified. I didn't want to spank her. I didn't want to force my hard cock into her throat. I didn't want to stuff it deep into her ass.

I wanted to worship her divine body.

I wanted to caress her smooth skin.

I wanted to kiss her tenderly, and fondle her gorgeous breasts, and slip my tongue into her exquisite pussy. I wanted to make her come with my mouth and then slide my hardness inside her until we were ready for a final orgasm together, before slipping off to sleep in each other's arms.

I hesitated once I had the blindfold in place. I think she must have sensed my trepidation, because she said, 'Don't worry, honey. Just do as you want with me. Use me as you want most. Whatever you want—I'm yours.'

I touched her, I stroked her, I manhandled her. I took in the extraordinary beauty of her body and indulged in the softness of her skin. I

gazed at her, I breathed her in, I tasted her. The blindfold did seem to help lower my inhibitions—but I didn't turn into the ruthless alpha male I think she was hoping for. It just made me want to take my time and really explore her. Kissing her all over, sampling every inch of her body, taking in her scent and her softness and every nuance of her flavor.

I had her go down on all fours, and it was almost as though I was giving her therapy on her muscles—kneading her, touching her, massaging her. Eventually moving down to pay gentle attention to her leather-clad sex.

She moaned as I explored her, and when I let her breasts free of their confinement, they were stiff as bullets.

But this was a slow, tender, gentle assault on her person, and seemed to take her by surprise.

Nevertheless, when I came to peel off her panties, and run my tongue over her pussy, she was already wet, and sounded as though she was appreciating what I was doing. And when I started sucking on her pussy lips, and flicking my tongue around her clit, she certainly seemed far from disappointed.

She arched her back, and raised her hips, pushing her butt back toward me like she needed more of that.

I slid a finger inside her while I sucked on her clit, and she giggled, and moaned, which I took to be a good sign.

Then she said, 'Use me, honey, do what you want to me...'

She was smiling, clutching the pillow as though imagining that her wrists were bound. I could tell from her tone she wanted to be treated more roughly, taken harder, but she was reluctant to be too explicit in her demands—she didn't want to offend me.

'Mmm...' I moaned, sucking on her pussy more forcefully, eating her like I was a starving man on a deserted island who had just discovered a ripe cantaloupe.

‘You can... spank me... if you like, honey...’ she said, and I could tell she felt awkward saying it, it sounded odd, her telling me.

I didn’t want to spank her. I didn’t even really know how.

If she wanted me to use her as I wanted to use her, then surely I shouldn’t have to do things I wasn’t comfortable doing? But I could sense, now, that this wasn’t really about her letting me do what I wanted to do. I wanted to worship her divine form like the goddess she was. She wanted me to take away her control and put my own needs first, and in dominating her to somehow degrade her, to go against her usual status as a strong, independent woman.

I stood, I rested one knee on the bed beside her, I stroked her beautifully round behind with one hand, warming up my palm, trying to prepare myself to do what she wanted.

I pulled my hand back, and then slapped her cheek—quite hard, as it turned out. There was a sharp crack sound, and my hand hurt as I struck her, and she let out a plaintive yelp that didn’t sound good.

‘God, I’m so sorry...’ I said, horrified at what I’d done.

‘No... it’s... it’s okay,’ she said through gritted teeth. Her behind was already flushing, her cheek gaining a rosy-red handprint where I’d touched her. ‘Maybe... try... a little softer at first...’

Jesus. I was completely flying blind here. I tried to remember how the professor had explained it in his letter. I stroked her a little more, gearing myself up for a lighter start to her spanking. I swatted at her, once, twice, three times. She moaned quietly, but I didn’t feel her heart was really in it—she was faking, to try and encourage me.

I patted her a few times more, and didn’t seem to be getting any results. I put a little more into it, and my hand, once again, cracked against her ass and made her yelp and inhale a sharp breath through her teeth.

This was not good.

She sensed my hesitation again. She said, ‘Do you... want to fuck me, honey?’

I touched her pussy, slid a finger back inside her. She wasn’t as wet as I remember from previous encounters since my coma. And I was soft as ripe Camembert.

‘I...’ I said, weakly, ‘I’m sorry...’

She said, ‘You can fuck me in the ass, if you want...’

Jesus. Had I ever fucked anyone in the ass? I felt like it wasn’t my kind of thing, that it had never been my kind of thing—hey, was this a memory coming back to me? I almost smiled ironically.

But I sensed maybe it was her kind of thing. She wiggled her gorgeous tushy at me, and I felt certain that if she liked rough sex, if she liked a man to be all alpha about this, and take what he wanted from her, then she might well like anal sex.

I could only apologize.

God. Apologies were not sexy during lovemaking.

Now I couldn’t even get it up. I had this incredible beauty on all fours in front of me, wearing thigh-high stockings and a blindfold, begging me to fuck her, and I couldn’t even get hard all of a sudden. Was this the true reality for me? Was this how I was once the shock of leaving hospital and finding out I was married to a beautiful woman wore off?

Did I need Viagra just to get hard long enough to come when I made love to her?

Damn it. I was attracted to her, I just... didn’t seem to be in the mood anymore. I felt like an idiot. Who fails at spanking a woman when she asks for it? She had to take me for a total loser.

She turned to me, lifted one side of her blindfold slightly, so that she could see my expression.

She smiled, kindly, but I think the horrified, embarrassed expression on my face made her feel similarly horrified and embarrassed. She’d revealed

herself to me, she'd opened up and confessed to wanting to be spanked—to be taken anally—and to be dominated by a man who should want to do things just for himself. And I probably looked as though I thought she was a freak for wanting that.

‘I’m sorry...’ I said, trying to soften her shame. ‘I just... I don’t... it’s not my kind of thing...’

I regretted the words the instant they came out of my mouth. I knew I should have said something like, I don’t have any experience of doing this kind of thing, or even just, I don’t know how to do this. Something that told her I was willing to try to learn, if she would give me time to watch the appropriate videos on YouTube, or if YouTube was more of a family-friendly affair, then maybe wherever people went to find pornography these days on the Internet.

But here she’d made herself vulnerable to me for the first time, and I’d told her that I had no interest in this kind of thing, and immediately I knew how she’d take it—as disapproval, as something to be ashamed of.

She was nice, she didn’t get angry, or anything. But I could tell she was disappointed, and that almost seemed to hurt as much as if she’d been angry with me.

She knelt up, turned to me, said, ‘You want me to try... and get you back in the mood?’

‘Sure,’ I said.

She patted the bed, and I lay where she wanted me. She pulled off the rest of my clothes, and there was my feeble, soft dick, looking pathetic. I tried stroking it a little as she kissed her way up my leg. Her blindfold was back in place, I wasn’t even sure if she’d seen I was so soft.

When she got to my cock, and slipped it inside her mouth, she was skillful at hiding her surprise—but I could tell. She moaned and sucked on me, as though she enjoyed just having my cock in her mouth, never mind that it was soft.

What was wrong with me?

The shame was powerful. Awful.

Better not to have sex at all than to have to face this.

Had this been the kind of thing that had killed off our intimacy prior to my coma? When I'd come out, all the excitement and new relationship energy had made me hard as a rock, but this was perhaps more the reality I should have expected when things started settling, and perhaps when more of my memory returned.

She worked on my cock, pumping it, sucking on it, and it became a little thicker. Not thick enough to get inside her, though. I felt any kind of arousal being blocked by remembering my attempts to spank her.

I tried to think of something else. I thought about watching her in her CrossFit training. I thought about making love to her in the shower after it. It wasn't helping much. I thought about the letters I'd found in the lockbox under her bed. I pictured her professor bending her over his desk, spanking her successfully. Driving his big cock into her pussy, into her ass, as she came so hard under him that it sounded like she was a wounded animal. That did it.

I could sense relief from her as she continued to work my cock.

I thought of those photographs of Dana having lunch with her CrossFit instructor, and imagined if there had been more photographs, perhaps taken somewhere else, an alleyway behind the restaurant. Dana leaning against a wall as CrossFit guy shoved down his pants and slid his hard cock inside her, right there where anyone might wander along and catch them. Now I was getting harder.

Dana pulled up from my cock, smiling, wiping her mouth on her forearm.

She kissed me, and I smelled my own cock on her lips, but at least she was smiling again.

‘You ready to fuck me?’ she asked, crawling down the mattress where she had the space to go on all fours again. I took her lead and knelt up behind her, grabbed one of her buttocks and guided my cock to her pussy.

I felt a lot of pressure on my shoulders now, too much pressure. I had to stay hard, I had to be able to fuck her well. Or else things could spiral.

I imagined her professor was doing this, sliding his cock into her. It was enough to get me inside her. To start fucking her.

God, she looked just breathtaking. Those stockings. Her stunning body. How could I be having trouble staying hard? I just couldn’t shake the memory of her expression when she had looked back at me after my failed attempts at spanking her. The embarrassment. The disappointment.

I started thrusting into her, just about hard enough to do it now. She moaned, but it seemed fake, like she wasn’t even trying to fake it well.

I was working hard, sweating like crazy, but my manhood was not doing its fair share.

She turned over, lay onto her back.

Wow, she looked just sensational. That pussy, completely shaven, so smooth. Her toned physique, her flat stomach, her gorgeous breasts. Other men would kill to be in my place. Her CrossFit guy probably spent every night imagining that he was right here where I was now.

‘Fuck me, honey, fuck me,’ she said quietly, like she didn’t want to push me too hard.

I thought of my buddy Russell instructing his associate to follow my wife, to take pictures of her, to see if she met any other men, if she did anything with them. I thought of Dana needing sex with other men because her husband couldn’t perform, and it started getting my blood pumping again. I felt a little tickle of jealousy at the thought of her attending a CrossFit session at a nearby gym, how she’d lusted after the alpha male leading the class, at how he flaunted his big, stupid package at all the women in the room as he demonstrated certain routines.

I imagined her going up to him after the class, asking some trivial questions about the workout, flirting with him, drawing his interest.

I pictured her asking him out for a coffee after the session.

Asking if he'd drive her home.

Taking her inside the house, giving him the tour of this incredible building. Inviting him into her bedroom.

Thinking, my beautiful wife cheated on me in this very house. Maybe, at least once, on this very bed.

Now I was hard as a rock. I took hold of Dana's thighs and pushed into her again and again—she moaned, apparently not faking this time, apparently delighted I was fully hard again.

But then a sudden orgasm exploded within my loins, and I couldn't stop it. I jerked a couple of times, and my cock spasmed inside her tight pussy. And then I was spurting my hot cream into her, and she was moaning as though enjoying the experience, while not quite entirely hiding her disappointment that I'd not even made her come.

'Mmm... that was nice,' she said, removing her blindfold, not even having to recover her breath.

'I'm sorry,' I said, flushing.

'It's okay,' she smiled, with genuine affection. She laughed, 'You're just out of the hospital. We can't expect constant miracles.'

I nodded. We snuggled up against each other, and that was nice.

I wondered if I could sustain this marriage, this love for her, without being able to really satisfy her sexually. I felt afraid, for the first time since I'd emerged from my coma. I wasn't worried about whether I'd survive the virus, I was worried whether our marriage would survive the loss of my sex drive.

I remembered her words from before: this is our second chance, this is our opportunity to have the marriage we really want. Was I blowing our second chance?

Maybe it was just the lingering weakness in my body following my coma. But I found myself slipping toward sleep praying that Dana would, somehow, find a way to cheat on me again. To find satisfaction with CrossFit guy, or whoever else, so that she could remain married to me, so that she could continue to love me, so that I wouldn't lose her.

SHAME

That night, I had my first dreams of work—or at least some impression of working, if not about the actual mechanisms. Mostly, things came in fragments, like pieces of a puzzle without the box cover to guide me.

Birch Tree Investors. That's the name of my company. I was still an active part of it, although I couldn't give details on a single company in our current investment portfolio. I remembered listening to pitches, the long hours pouring over business plans and looking at power points and reading all the market analysis. I remembered loving all of it.

And I remembered how even then, even the 'Scrooge-version' of me, knew that I was losing Dana. Some of those photos she'd shared yesterday must have helped. Something stirred in the back of my psyche.

I dreamt of the day that Dana moved out of the bedroom. It was more of a feeling than a crisp memory, though, and that feeling? Sadness, helplessness, and then... indifference? I don't remember yelling. I don't remember a fight. She just did it, saying it was because of my snoring when we both knew that it was a lie. And then she was gone.

When I woke up the next morning, I was alone in the bed, although there were signs that she'd slept there at least some of the night. Were we

headed back to the way things were? What happened to this being our new beginning?

‘No. No, not this time,’ I said aloud. My face burned with humiliation at my failure to react when she’d shown the courage to be so vulnerable. Had she tried before? I couldn’t remember. History wasn’t going to repeat itself.

I actually got showered today before heading downstairs. I ignored my closet of suits and slacks and polos in favor of a pair of jeans and a workout t-shirt. I was going to need to order a new wardrobe. None of it felt right anymore.

Dana was in her office on the second floor when I went looking for her. She was on a call, headset on and dressed like she’d gone into the office downtown rather than the one at home—a white, short-sleeved dress that flowed over her body before ending abruptly, high on her thighs. The white ankle boots with their four-inch heels made me wonder if maybe she *was* planning on heading into the real office.

But no, this was Dana. That much I knew, even if I couldn’t quite remember it. She dressed for business to get into the mentality.

Had this woman been sitting, so vulnerable, on my bed last night? Had this woman told me that I could do *anything* with her—no, not with her, *to her*—and all that I’d mustered was to go down on her?

‘You can fuck me in the ass, if you want.’

And I hadn’t wanted it. But she had.

The wave of shame was back, hitting me just as she spotted me at the door. I wanted to crawl into a hole and hide forever. Maybe that’s what I’d done before.

If Dana was embarrassed, though, she didn’t show it. She smiled at me as our eyes met, and I didn’t see any of the embarrassment or judgment that I was feeling. Had last night happened at all? Or was my brain still that messed up?

‘The Japanese are on board. We just need to send them an S.O.W. that doesn’t scare them off.’ She spoke with authority and confidence, still looking at me, and for a second I thought she was talking to me. Then her focus shifted away from me, and I remembered the headset and the call. ‘And it needs to be thorough...’

I pointed at the door and mimed closing it. She shook her head. *No, don’t worry about closing that door*, she seemed to suggest. Like we had no secrets here. Like everything was all out in the open.

It all made me feel even worse. Here was this woman at the top of her game, a C-suite success in a world dominated by men. Last night, she’d shown a side of herself that I knew was not easy to show, and I’d failed her.

And yet I’d also learned another thing about myself. While I had failed her, I wanted other men to succeed. What the hell was that all about?

‘HEY, SULLY. HOW’RE YOU FEELING?’ It was good to hear Russell’s familiar voice. Better, I realized that while I still couldn’t remember any details from those gap years, the feelings and emotions were starting to slowly take some shape again.

‘When I suspected Dana of cheating, how did I react?’

‘Whoa. Not even a hello? What happened?’

I considered telling him about last night... for about half a second. When my face filled with heat, I quickly abandoned that ill-conceived plan. ‘Nothing really.’

‘Things still hot and heavy with you and Dana?’

‘Oh, yeah. They’re great.’ If he’d asked that question 12 hours ago, it would have been the truth, and even now, it was only kind of a lie. ‘I’m just... trying to work a few things out.’

‘You remembering things?’

‘Some. Bits and pieces. It’s more confusing than helpful, honestly.’

‘Sure.’

I was in my office again, my door shut. That felt... familiar. And fitting. ‘So when I got the photos of Dana and her CrossFit guy, how did I react?’

‘You were angry, of course. Felt betrayed. But you also... I don’t know. This is going to sound cold, but you kind of approached it like a bad investment. You started to think about how best to divest yourself of the situation.’

‘I was going to get a divorce?’

‘You never said as much, but yeah. That’s how it was shaping up.’

‘What did you tell me? What advice did you give?’

Russ took his time before answering, and my insides tightened. ‘I told you to go to see someone. A therapist. To try to fix it first.’

‘And how did I react to that?’

Another long pause. ‘You told me to go fuck myself.’

‘I did?’

‘You were in a state. That was our last conversation before you got sick.’ He sounded torn up. Last night was my shame. This was Russell’s.

I said, ‘I’m sorry. That’s not the way you want to remember the last conversation with a friend.’

Again, he didn’t respond immediately. The man was struggling with his own demons. ‘You know, Sully, I’ve known you for over twenty years, so please don’t take this the wrong way...’

‘Okay...’

‘I don’t think you’ve ever worried about how I felt.’

‘What’s that mean?’

‘Just... you’re very good at your job. You’re very analytical. Very logical. It’s what makes you and Dana such a great team, actually. The two of you are the smartest, most intellectual people I know. But let’s just say that no one was going to dub you Most Empathetic.’

‘Can I ask you one other thing?’

‘You can ask me as many things as you want. I’m here for you, even if the former you told me to go fuck myself.’ At least there was still some humor left in him.

‘Did I ever love Dana?’

‘Oh, I don’t think you ever stopped loving her. I think that’s why you got so angry. At her. At me. At yourself. And one other thing—call this one a freebie. She never stopped loving you, either. Even with the evidence at hand. Even as you two grew distant. I think it’s just that the both of you kind of sized up the future and started—’

‘To divest from one another,’ I finished. ‘Thanks, Russ.’

‘No problem. And hey! You hear? Apparently we go into phase one next week.’

‘Phase one? What is that?’

‘Not sure! Some things start to open up? We all close our eyes and start pretending things are normal?’

‘Nothing’s normal, Russ.’

‘That’s the truth.’

DANA AVOIDED ME THAT DAY. Or at least that’s how I interpreted it. She worked through the entire day, coming out to apologize that she couldn’t help with the muscle therapy. I told her that it was fine. That she could have the day off. I saw, though, behind those eyes that she was thinking about last night and my failure to step it up.

I decided to fix dinner for us. YouTube, it turned out, was an amazing resource, and while I only burned the casserole a little, it didn’t turn out half bad. I set the table in the dining room, got out candles, and worked up the

courage to talk about last night. Talk. Somehow, that's what I figured was missing from our previous life.

I texted Dana that dinner was ready, but she didn't come right away, and after about thirty minutes, I went looking for her.

A part of me dreaded what I'd find. A part of me shrank at the thought of finding her on the phone with her CrossFit trainer, telling him how much she missed him, and how pathetic her husband was last night. Another part of me, however, grew hard at the thought. My heart was in my throat by the time I arrived at her office, which was now closed despite the light on behind it.

The old me had been upset at Dana's affair. The old me had been resigned to a failed marriage. The old me had definitely *not* been turned on by any of this. So why was I now? What the hell was wrong with me?

The door opened abruptly before I even knocked, and there stood Dana, looking so surprised to see me right in front of the door as I had of her. She yelped in surprise. '*Damien!*'

'Sorry, I...' All the things that I wanted to say, all the confessions and thoughts, fled. 'I made dinner.'

She smiled. 'Good. I'm famished.' Stretching, she added, 'Long day. I'm so sorry I missed you most of the day.'

'It's okay. You're not my nurse, and you've had your own routine for the past month. I... I don't want to get in the way of that.'

She looked at me the way I feel like Russ must have thought about me. Like, *Who are you?* She didn't say that, however. She just smiled sweetly as we went down to eat.

That night, very conspicuously, we didn't talk about the evening before. We didn't talk about the blindfold. We didn't talk about her kinky fantasies, or my failure to rise to them. It did, however, hang between us, spoiling the new relationship energy of the past couple days.

We still made love that night. She still slept in my bed. But she didn't offer herself to me the way she had before. She hadn't told me that I could do anything that I wanted to her, because she now knew that my version of anything didn't even scratch the surface of hers.

Or so she thought.

HER SECRET STASH

The rest of the week and through the next weekend was much the same. Dana worked a lot more, and while she still made time to help me with my physical therapy and do CrossFit in the morning, I saw her less than those first few days.

The sex also suffered, too. How quickly had we fallen back into the old routine. I was still living the dream. Every time that I saw Dana, I had to pinch myself. The more we'd talk, the more she spoke so passionately about the politics of the moment, of social justice in tech, of how to get more women into her world, the more she felt out of my league. I tried to match wits, but the amnesia made it hard. I didn't understand current events. The world had moved on, and I was still fumbling to catch up.

That was frustrating, too, I'll admit. Despite the snippets and fragments, my memories weren't returning. When I asked the doctors about this on a call, I could see in their eyes that they weren't sure that my memories would ever return. That maybe all of this was permanent.

There were days that I felt trapped in my body, failed by it, failed by everything. It didn't help that we could barely leave our home. I could take a stroll around the block, but was otherwise tethered there, just as I was tethered to my broken mind.

I threw myself into understanding Dana. Whatever had happened before, whatever had gone on with this CrossFit guy—or was still going on, I thought with nervous excitement—at least that was something that I could control.

His name was Jackson Ross. I looked him up. The internet, turned out, was a wonderful treasure trove of information. Jackson Ross, certified CrossFit trainer, lived in the Bay Area. He was certainly in good shape. His Instagram feed—because that was a thing I now understood—was filled with photos of himself without a shirt, his thick arms and even thicker chest like something out of *Men's Health*.

He had some fitness advice YouTube channel that I watched a few clips of. He had this confident, bro-like way of talking that made me wonder why Dana would be attracted to him. She just seemed better than that. Or something. I knew it was judgmental, but I found it hard to believe that this man could challenge her at all—at least mentally.

Physically, on the other hand, I got. Physically, this man was a specimen, and while I harbored no attraction to other men, the thought of him walking into a room with a blindfolded Dana always provided an instant erection.

One morning, after coming downstairs to hear the driving beat of a CrossFit session in progress, curiosity got the best of me. It was wrong. I certainly shouldn't have been doing it. But that made this idea all the more delicious.

I headed for Dana's office, knowing that I had some more time. Her class didn't end for another good twenty minutes, and after that, she always took a shower. She didn't even know I was awake yet.

I scampered upstairs. I could wander the high-ceilinged chambers of this house any time I wanted. No, I craved discovery. I craved knowledge to fill in the gaping void that was my memory of the past two decades. I was aroused by the possibility of uncovering more of Dana's secrets, too.

I went straight to her office on the second floor. The first thing that struck me was that it was very tidy, very clean. And completely and utterly free of any paperwork, of any kind.

I sat in Dana's chair. The room smelled of her. It triggered another hard-on, of course, just the smell of her. For a moment or two, I just sat and enjoyed the feeling of desire blooming inside me. But then I smiled, judging myself faintly ridiculous—I could have been down in the basement right now, watching Dana stretch and twist and pump in tight clothing, before joining her in the shower, rather than just sitting here breathing in lingering remnants of her perfume.

I stood up, fished around the shelves, which were fairly minimalist in their contents, but held a few books on technical-sounding subjects I had no clue about—'JavaScript & JQuery', whatever that was. Web Usability. The Phoenix Project. Emotional Design. ReWork. The Lean Startup. I wasn't interested.

There were no secret drawers containing more bondage gear, scarier looking butt plugs.

There weren't even any filing cabinets stuffed full of files containing in-depth accounts of our life together, and her secret dealings and feelings.

Searching around, it struck me that in this paper-free office, everything had to be on that computer. That leviathan, yet impossibly-thin screen in the middle of her minimalist desk, bearing the increasingly familiar black Apple logo, accompanied by a tiny little white keyboard and mouse that didn't even seem to be physically connected to the computer.

Everything was on there.

I sat in her chair again, staring at the enormous screen. All screens seemed enormous these days.

From the bowels of the mansion, I heard the thumping music stop. Was she done? I waited. If her CrossFit class was over, I didn't want to be

starting to look at her computer. I assumed she'd take a shower, but I didn't know how long she'd take.

Then, more thumping music started again.

I turned back to the computer, and touched the sleek, white mouse. The monitor sprang to life, the display crisp, the colors bright.

Like so many other things, I understood the OS without knowing why. Dana had a lot of windows open featuring all kinds of information and software packages. I noticed that I hadn't needed a password to access her computer.

I glanced around at some of the open windows on her desktop. Various documents featuring information that seemed very mundane, business stuff. But here, buried at the back, was what I assumed was an Internet browser—Firefox—displaying a black-colored website that featured lots of little rectangular images of very naughty people apparently doing very naughty things.

The logo in the top left corner labelled the website 'Pornhub'.

Wow.

This was how you accessed Internet pornography these days? It was just jaw-dropping. I scrolled down and there were hundreds of options, maybe thousands. It was like Netflix, but filthy. Here was a 'Recommended For You' section of videos.

Submissive Slut Will Do Everything She's Told

Gorgeous Teen Turned Submissive By Possessive Ex

Blindfolded Slut Fucked in the Mouth

Young Submissive Sluts Love Cum

How did they know to recommend this kind of pornography for Dana? Was it like Netflix, where your personal choices informed the algorithm?

God, I was hard, supposing that Dana watched pornography. That this was the kind of pornography she might choose. It was rather startling, and I had to admit it wasn't the kind of porn I would have chosen to watch myself

—submissive slut loves when daddy spansks and fingers her ass, I mean, Jesus—but it was hot, hot, hot, picturing Dana pleasuring herself watching it.

I saw the word ‘History’ in the menu. I couldn’t help myself. I clicked. A full menu dropped down listing all the sites that Dana had accessed recently.

Most of it was email, or Google Searches for various business topics. But there were lots of entries from Pornhub.

I flushed, and my heart burned as I saw the dates in the history menu—it appeared she’d been accessing pornography ever since that disastrous night I’d failed to be the alpha male she’d craved. It gave me the impression that she had a seriously high libido.

Somehow, that added to her attraction, even though I felt I might not be enough for her libido.

My hard-on throbbed. These were videos she’d actually watched. Videos she’d actually chosen, and clicked on, and sat down to watch.

Cute Little Submissive Gets a Hard Spanking

Messy Break Up Leads To Rough Fuck

Husband finds his friend fucking my face and spansks me

Gorgeous Korean Amateur Enjoys First Anal Pounding

Cheating Wife Fucked By Huge Cock on Business Trip

BDSM slut chained to a wall and made to come

Husband watches his young wife fucked in the ass and pussy

Goodness. She had quite a porn habit. Had she been watching these here in her office? It was quite something to behold—particularly in that one of the few memories I’d recovered of being married to Dana had been of her getting upset that I’d watched porn.

I could understand that she might have gotten into the habit while she’d been alone in this enormous house the whole time I’d been in hospital. But

she'd gone back to her viewing habits while I'd been back, unable to give her the strong hand she apparently desired in the bedroom.

Scanning through some of the titles of videos she'd enjoyed, in amongst the submissive sluts and anal whores in handcuffs, I noticed quite a few references to cheating wives and even husbands discovering them.

Had this been a particular fantasy of Dana's recently, or even before my coma? Cheating wives. Cuckolded husbands.

I clicked on 'Husband watches his young wife fucked in the ass and pussy' and watched a scene in which a 30-something man returned to a small apartment to discover his wife on all fours, naked from the waist down other than a barely-there miniskirt, sucking on the cock of a dominant-looking man sitting on one of their dining chairs. And the man just stood there in the doorway, watching his wife sucking his other man. He even took out his cock and started masturbating while watching them. The alpha male sat there and told the man his wife was 'busy just now' and just went on enjoying her blowjob.

And then the guy ushered her up to her feet and bent her over the table to fuck her from behind—with the husband still just watching and beating his meat.

Jesus. I was hard as a rock watching this. Was this one of Dana's fantasies?

To my surprise, as I watched, I fantasized about being the husband, of standing there watching as Dana was pounded in front of me. Then, toward the end of the clip, the alpha male left the scene, and the husband moved in—going down on her, briefly, from behind, before sliding his own cock into her.

I nearly came just from watching the clip.

I had to stop myself. Force myself to close the window and calm down. And when I did, I realized that the music down in the basement had stopped again.

Damn it. How long ago had she ended her workout?

I tried to make sure the computer desktop seemed to be as I had found it, and then that the office similarly appeared undisturbed. Then, I ran out of there like a man possessed.

I bombed into my own office on the opposite side of the floor just as Dana began to make her way up the stairs. She was dressed, as usual, in a business suit that was sexy in a corporate way—tall heels, hair up, most likely stockings beneath.

Standing in the middle of my office, I knew she'd see me. I knew that she'd realize that I'd just entered. I turned, went to the filing cabinet to my left, and opened it, pretending like I was looking for something.

I pulled out some files just as she breezed by the door. 'Good workout?' I asked, looking over my shoulder.

'I'm going to be sore after that one.'

My heart was beating so fast in my ears that I barely heard her.

'Filing paperwork?' she asked skeptically.

'Just... um... you know. Trying to figure out where things are.'

'You should probably check your computer then,' she said, pointing at my desk. 'Those are all old.'

'I figured that I'd start at the beginning. Doctor says to try to remember things chronologically.'

'Ah.' I couldn't tell if she believed me or not. Either way, she moved on. 'Hey, do you mind if my friend, Sarah, comes over later today for a socially-distanced drink on the patio?'

'No, of course not. I think that sounds great.' I would have answered the exact same way no matter what she'd asked me. I was still sweating from nearly getting caught, not to mention what I'd seen on Dana's computer. 'Seeing a friend in person!'

'I know. It's so strange. And don't worry, honey, I'll be safe. We'll stay outside.'

‘Of course.’

She left me after that. I looked at the filing cabinet. What an idiot I was. I couldn’t have been more obvious. Who the hell even uses these things anymore? What was even in here?

I looked at the envelope in my hands — a manilla file that bulged out a little at the bottom, as if there were more things in there than just papers. Turning it over, I saw that it was addressed to a law office. A divorce attorney.

My heart was suddenly back in my throat again, my body a bonfire.

It was sealed, like I had been intending to send it. I tore it open, floated over to the desk, and dumped out its contents. Along with some papers, a cover letter, and a USB drive, was a crisp, glossy 8x10 photo.

The missing photo.

Dana was standing close to Jackson Ross. He had a hand on the small of her back, holding her close. Her hand clutched the back of his neck. And they were, without a doubt, kissing the way only lovers do.

The world dropped out from under me.

FLASH DRIVE

I wanted to look at the rest of this packet. I wanted to load that little thumb drive right away. This time, unlike before, prudence won out. I needed to wait. I didn't want to be caught again.

I ended up trying our gym in the basement, and I found that if I let my mind wander, my body knew exactly what to do—I had a sequence as I moved through the weights and the exercises. I pushed myself, zoning out, exerting myself until my muscles screamed and I was panting hard.

It was true. It was true! She was seeing another man. At the very least, she'd kissed him. Any anger I felt was ghostly and ephemeral, the way I imagined a man who'd lost a limb felt. It was there because it had always been there, but it wasn't real. It wasn't actually how I felt.

No, I wasn't actually angry. I wasn't actually jealous. Even the betrayal was exhilarating. She'd done this behind the old me's back.

Maybe that was why this was easier to deal with. That was not me. Not anymore. I wasn't the man I've been learning about. This time it would be different.

And yet I'd grown soft when she wanted me to be her alpha, and hard when I thought of her finding someone else to be her alpha. Is this the end for us? Did I want a divorce? A separation? A true, new beginning? I didn't think so. I still wanted to be a part of this. Like the husband in that video

she'd watched last night. I wanted to be there for her when she'd been bad. I wanted to take her when she'd been naughty. I wanted to be her cuckold.

I took a shower the gym bathroom, where I'd pressed her against the glass wall. I could still be that guy. Just not the one spanking her. Just not the one dominating her.

I jacked off in the shower, but somehow managed to stop myself from coming. I needed to have that libido. I wanted to save it for what I knew was going to be an exciting time as I explored the rest of the envelope.

I toweled off before realizing that I didn't actually have a fresh set of clothes down here. I went poking around the bathroom down here, which was organized like a spa—the towels were all rolled and stacked, bath salts were presented in cork-stoppered vials, expensive candles that didn't look burned. The bathmats were even built of bamboo slats and smelled wonderful.

Along the top shelf was what looked like a robe. I stretched to pull it down, and when I did, a hat tumbled down, glancing off my shoulder. Strange. I picked it up. It was black, with the word "ROGUE" in capital letters across the front panel. Some brand I'd never heard of. It also didn't look like the kind of hat that Dana would wear—a broad brimmed straw hat, maybe, but not a baseball one like this.

I drew it to my nose. It didn't smell like her, either. It smelled like a man's hair product. Thinking about my wardrobe upstairs, I also couldn't imagine this was mine.

My blood pressure spiked. I tried putting the hat on. It didn't fit. It was too large. It *wasn't* mine.

I took a steadying breath. He was here. Jackson Ross was *here*. In my house. In the gym bathroom. I glanced at the shower, thinking again about how I'd fucked my wife in there. Had Jackson Ross done the same?

My cock was stiff, looking obscene in the mirror as I stretched up to place the hat back on the high shelf where it must have been forgotten. I

pulled the robe on, did my best to subside my raging arousal, and headed for the stairs.

‘Have a good workout?’ Dana asked as I passed her office.

I nearly jumped out of my skin. ‘Yes. Great.’

‘It’s nice to see that you’ve got strength to do that. Don’t push yourself though.’

‘Yeah. Don’t think you have to worry.’

She’d already refocused on her computer. I moved on, the conversation done. I hoped that she didn’t see the bulge in the front of my robe.

By the time I was alone, I’d forgotten about the hat. I had more. So much more.

I WAITED UNTIL AFTER LUNCH, when I was sure that Dana was on a call. I listened from just outside her office, made sure that it sounded like something that wasn’t going to be quick, and slipped into my own office. I shut and locked the door, fished out the Manila envelope, and carefully pulled out its contents.

On top, again, was the photo of Dana and her CrossFit instructor embracing. It was just as visceral as before, like touching a live wire. My body began to shake as I turned to see what else was in here.

The other papers were not photos, but what looked like lists—no, they were receipts. Lunches out. Purchases made.

The USB flash drive—of course I didn’t know what to call it at the time—was the last thing in there. It was a silver plastic thing the size of a pack of gum, and intuitively I knew that it would slot into my computer.

On the drive was a single file—an MP3. Just an audio file, and not even a very large one at that. While that was disappointing on one level, the promise of whatever was on that file was like rocket fuel. I slipped a pair of

headphones on, made sure that the sound was piped through them, and hit play.

‘MY, my, Mrs. Sullivan, my collared little slut. Very nice. *Very* nice.’

‘There is very little that’s nice about me.’ Yes, that was Dana’s voice, but also not. This one was huskier, sultrier. ‘I’ve been bad.’

‘Call me Sir.’

‘Yes, Sir.’

‘Tell me, slut. How have you been bad?’

‘When my husband told me that he had a trip to Seattle, I couldn’t wait for him to leave, Sir.’

‘My, my, that does sound bad.’ I could hear his footsteps cross the room.

‘Tell me, Mrs. Sullivan. Why couldn’t you wait for him to leave?’

‘Because I needed to get fucked, Sir.’

‘Can’t you just get that from your husband?’

‘I needed to get fucked by a *man*. Sir.’

‘And what is a man to you, Dana?’

‘Someone who isn’t afraid of taking what he wants.’

‘Mmm, okay. Go on.’ She whimpered at whatever he was doing. ‘What else?’

‘Someone who is dominant—ahaa!’ She gasped sharply, but didn’t let it stop her. ‘Someone who takes *con—TROL!*’

Something clicked into place. Something metallic. I thought of the toys in her room. The handcuffs.

He said, ‘Someone who punishes?’ There’s a slap. Dana hissed.

‘Yes...’ she said.

‘Get on your knees.’ I heard the clatter of his belt. ‘Unzip it with your teeth.’

Jesus. I heard the rasp of the belt, slower than if he were pulling it down himself.

‘Take it out. With your teeth... that’s it... that’s a naughty little slut... now right now, this *man* would like to experience one of Dana Sullivan’s famous, no-hands blowjobs.’

Her “famous, no-hands blowjobs”? Spoken like a man who had them before, and, with a his recorded groan, was getting one again. ‘Yes, look at you. So obedient. So submissive.’

The sound of the blowjob was wet and demanding, a continual gurgling that made me both uncomfortable and excited to hear. He was using her. He fucking her face. Every now and then, a slap rang out—sometimes the loud slap of his hand on her, sometimes the more muted smack of his cock against her cheek.

‘That’s it, slut. Take my cock. Suck it. Choke on it.’

Glug, glug, glug came the dampened sounds of his cock in her throat.

‘That’s it, Dana. That’s it. Take it. Look at me. Look up here as you take my nice, big cock in your throat.’

She gasped as he must have pulled back, her breathing hard. He barely let her recover before he was back at it.

‘I love the lingerie. Did you buy these for me?’

There was a muffled answer.

‘What’s that? I’m sorry, I missed it. Did you buy this strappy thing just for me?’

Dana slurped off of him. ‘Yes,’ she answered gruffly. ‘Does it please you, Sir?’

‘It’s very sexy. I love the garter straps and the stockings.’ The sucking sounds continued. ‘I love that it doesn’t come with panties, either.’

‘I shaved for you, Sir’

‘I see. Has your husband said anything yet? Asked you what happened to your bush?’

‘He hasn’t even seen it.’

‘He hasn’t seen you naked in the last three fucking months? Jesus.’

‘Oh, it’s been longer than that.’

‘That’s just crazy. I wonder if he realizes that he’s married to someone who will do *anything* she’s told. You will do anything you’re told, right, Mrs. Sullivan?’

‘Mmmhmm...’ came her choked response.

‘I had a feeling about you when you first joined my class,’ he went on. ‘You knew how to follow instructions, right from the beginning. Now get up.’

There were more slaps. More gasps and groans. Her heels scraped across the ground. ‘Bend over.’

‘I’m going to fall,’ she said, afraid.

‘Do it.’

She cried out, but not because she was falling. She cried out in pleasure. The mics picked up the wet sounds of licking. Was he going down on her?

‘You can reach your ass in those cuffs. I want you to spread your cheeks. Do it.’

She must have. She groaned even louder as he must have been eating her from behind. He sucked on her, releasing her in loud, slurping sounds. ‘Does your husband know how hard you come when someone uses you?’

‘N... no.’

‘Does he know how much you like your ass getting licked?’

‘AH! Ah—no!’

‘Has he ever fucked your ass?’

‘N... n... never.’

‘Insane.’ There’s another slap. ‘How could this ass not tempt him?’ Another slap. ‘I knew I had to have it...’ Slap! ‘The first time I ever saw it.’

Dana whimpered.

‘What’s that?’ he asked.

‘Please...’

‘Please what?’

‘Stop... stop teasing. Sir.’ She sounded so small.

Spank. ‘And what is it that you want me to do, Mrs. Sullivan?’

‘I want... I want your cock.’

‘Where?’

‘Any... anywhere. Please. Sir.’

‘And if I just came all over that pretty face of yours, you would be okay with that?’

I heard her hesitate, but she gave the expected answer. ‘Yes, Sir.’

‘Don’t worry. That may be where things end, but not the complete journey.’

They were shifting again. Climbing onto the bed. Arranging themselves. The handcuffs sounded like they came off. Dana gasped. There were more slaps, more spanks. He was really using her, manhandling her. Is this what she really wanted?

‘Yes!’ she gasped as he finally entered her. ‘Ohhh, yes, that feels so... fuck!’

‘So what? Feels so what, slut?’

‘So good. So...’ She could barely speak. ‘So fucking big.’

‘You love a big cock, don’t you?’

‘I do...’

‘You crave a big cock.’

‘Mmmm, yes...’

The sound of fucking was unmistakable. The wet slap of skin on skin just wasn’t from Jackson’s hand. His grunts mingled with my wife’s heavy cries, her groans and moans and unintelligible curses.

Was he even fucking her with a condom on? I didn’t hear the sound of a wrapper being opened. I didn’t hear any protection.

‘We’re going to have so much fun while your husband is gone.’ He never paused in his thrusting. ‘I cannot wait to fuck your ass...’ Slap! ‘...in the middle of your husband’s fucking bed.’

Dana was screaming now.

I was practically screaming. My cock raged. How was I so turned on? This should have been humiliating to me—*was* humiliating—and yet all I could do was sputter and jerk myself.

I didn’t even realize that the recording had come to an end. I kept listening, waiting for more, until it looped back to the beginning. I moaned. No! I *wanted* to hear more. I needed it. Like Dana, I craved it.

I unplugged the USB drive. I was sweating. I could feel the heat between my skin and clothing, like I’d just jogged a mile. My heart was beating so fast. My cock was so hard. I stumbled around the desk and out the door. I needed to find Dana. I needed to *fuck* her. I couldn’t explain the urge. I didn’t bother trying.

My legs felt wooden as I opened the door and practically fell out into the hall. Dana wasn’t in her office anymore. I checked her room. Not there, either, although my eyes moved to the drawers where I knew her toys were. How many of them had they used after this was recorded? I looked up, towards my bedroom. Had they really done it there, too?

Downstairs, I heard the voices, the far-off laughter. She wasn’t alone. Someone else was here.

My heart seized. Was it Jackson? Had she decided to invite him here? No, that was a female voice. A woman’s laugh.

It wasn’t until I was at the French doors that lead to the courtyard at the back of the house that I remembered Dana saying that she was meeting up with one of her friends. Someone named Sarah.

They were laughing and giggling when I went out there, but stopped as they saw me approach.

‘Hey,’ Dana said, with a calm smile as I emerged from the back door.
‘This is Sarah, my best friend. Do you remember her?’

The blonde regarded me over her glass of her wine, sizing me up and dismissing me all in the same, kohl-eyed glance. She knew. She knew about Dana’s affair. I didn’t know how I knew, but... I was certain.

It took my breath away.

‘Hey, Damien, how’s it going?’

SARAH MALLORY

Attractive, but not a patch on Dana, Sarah was dressed fairly casually in a bright white linen shirt and pale blue jeans—nothing too showy, but I sensed all her clothes were designer, and probably not cheap. She had a silver necklace on around her neck, which, again, appeared uncomplicated but in a faintly contrived manner—like her clothing, it hinted at luxury, and status.

Even before I opened my mouth to greet her, I sensed a slight awkwardness between us, though it was more from her direction, since I didn't really know her. She smiled at me, but somehow it didn't quite seem entirely genuine. I caught the sense that she didn't really believe I could actually have amnesia, that I had really lost my memories of the past couple of decades.

'Hey,' I said, holding out my hand in greeting, before the two women giggled and offered me disapproving noises—nah-ah!

'We're still supposed to be social distancing,' Dana explained.

'It's so lame,' Sarah complained.

'But necessary,' Dana gently chided her friend, and Sarah nodded, as though she'd had to be reminded that I had actually caught COVID, and it had been life-changing.

‘You are the only person I know who’s had it,’ Sarah told me. ‘I’m sorry it hit you so hard.’

She seemed sincere. I shrugged, what-are-you-gonna-do? And took the third glass that had been sitting on the large table that stood between Dana and Sarah, furniture that was apparently helping them to maintain social distancing rules. Well, at least they’d brought me a glass out here.

Dana said, ‘Sarah and I have been friends since high school.’

‘Wow,’ I tilted my glass toward her as though offering a toast.

Sarah grinned. ‘Have you really lost all your memories?’ she asked. Dana gave her a sharp look, as though they’d agreed on giving me an easy time of it, and not prying into my amnesia issues. Sarah smirked back at Dana as though to say, *what, are you kidding? He has amnesia! Of course I’m not going to keep quiet about it!*

I said, calmly, ‘Most of them. At least from the last twenty years or so.’

‘So... was it a shock when you woke up and found out you weren’t actually the 25-year-old stud you thought you were?’

Dana gave her another sharp look. I wondered if they’d discussed my failures as a lover. The look Sarah gave back to Dana hinted strongly that they had.

I tried not to blush, though I felt a burst of shame. I said, ‘No, I did feel like I was 46 when I woke up. I wasn’t really surprised when I looked in the mirror for the first time. It’s just... I can’t recall any details from the past twenty years or so. You know—people, places, things I did.’

‘You remember getting married?’

‘Not really.’

‘Ouch.’

‘I showed him the pictures,’ Dana pointed out. ‘We’re working on it. He occasionally gets a few little memories back again.’

‘Oh yeah? Like what?’

I shrugged again. I didn't want to tell her I remembered being confronted by an upset wife regarding my porn usage.

Then my phone started vibrating in my pocket. I pulled it out, seeing an unfamiliar face on the screen along with a name—Bill Ruskin.

I touched the green phone symbol to accept the call—I had no idea who Bill Ruskin was, but I needed an excuse to escape the awkwardness of this conversation with Sarah Mallory.

‘Sully!’ Bill Ruskin sounded thrilled to talk to me.

‘Hey... uh.. Bill,’ I said.

I glanced over at Dana, and then Sarah, and silently mouthed ‘sorry’ at them, before indicating that I had to take this call, and I’d go back into the house to take it. The women seemed vaguely pleased that I was being taken away from them. They had the look of fully-armed gossips waiting for the chance to unload all their juiciest tidbits on each other.

‘Little birdie told me you’d been sprung from the hospital,’ Bill Ruskin was saying as I slipped back inside the house, feeling mighty relieved to avoid being the third wheel in Dana’s first face-to-face with her best friend in many weeks. ‘And here you are!’

Bill Ruskin had an English accent. I should probably have been comfortable with it, considering the fact that I’d been born and brought up in England, before fellow Oxford graduate Russell Duvall had enticed me to the bright lights, big city of the United States, where we’d both cut our teeth on Wall Street. But all my years in America had knocked the sharp edges off my accent—whereas Bill Ruskin’s accent seemed like it could cut glass.

‘Well, I’m still technically in recovery,’ I told him.

‘Of course, old man. Of course. So how long might that take?’

‘I don’t know... the doctors think I’ll need a few weeks...’

‘Right, right, right. Well, one has to do these things properly...’

Keeping the phone clamped to my ear, I wandered into the kitchen, looking for something to nibble on. There was nothing much in the fridge to speak of, but nosing around the kitchen, I stumbled into a little room that was packed with supplies. Cans, bottles, packets of all kinds of things, from pasta to toilet paper. It looked like Dana and I would be able to survive the apocalypse with all this.

I didn't really want to talk to Bill Ruskin, now that I was done with him as an excuse to get away from Dana and Sarah's post-lockdown reunion. I suppose we were getting into post-lockdown?

I said, 'Look, I'm sorry, Bill...' intending on mentioning how tired I was a lot of the time since my little sojourn in intensive care.

But he seemed to take it as me brushing him off, and rapidly got to the point of his call: 'No problem, old man, no problem. I just wanted to send over the latest numbers we had, to give you the update first hand. I mean, you know, if all goes well...'

I'd figured he was talking about something to do with work. I really didn't feel ready to get into all that. I said, 'Hey, look, just send them over, and I'll take a look. I'll get back to you as soon as I can.'

A white lie. Actually, probably not even particularly white. But it was enough to get him off the phone.

I laid eyes on an expensive-looking box of macaroons that I thought might be able to fill the current hole in my belly—and then I heard Sarah's voice—hushed, like she was talking to Dana to minimize the chance that I might overhear, wherever I was, and yet really quite clear. It made me think that she was a little two-faced. And yet, didn't everybody gossip about other people behind their backs?

When I focused enough to hear what she was saying however, I relaxed a little.

She said. 'He is looking good, actually.'

‘He is, isn’t he? I honestly think it’s the rest more than anything, the time away from work.’

‘He’s looking a little more toned...’

‘I’m fairly sure he found my browser history the other day,’ Dana said. I felt my chest fill with the hot lead of shame from what she was saying. So she did know I’d taken a little look in her office. I felt so embarrassed.

I heard Sarah gasp melodramatically. ‘Seriously?’

‘Uh-huh. And I hadn’t cleared it for quite a while.’

Sarah cackled. ‘What do you think he saw on there?’

‘Oh... I don’t know... probably something like "hot brunette tied up and spanked".’

“‘Before getting pounded by a huge cock”,’ Sarah added, before the two of them collapsed into giggles again.

Then Sarah joked, ‘Jesus, you should see my browser history. If your hubby stumbled on that, he’d probably want to join a monastery.’

‘I don’t know. You always liked the submissive guys. Probably wouldn’t be as much a shock to him as what he saw on my computer.’

‘You should try it,’ Sarah said. ‘Treat him a little mean. Maybe you’ll like it. Maybe he’ll like it. Tell him to lie on the floor and walk all over him.’

‘Why would I want a husband I can walk all over?’

‘Seriously?’ Sarah laughed. ‘He’ll make you come and you don’t even have to worry about making him come.’

‘I like making him come.’

‘Treat ‘em mean, keep ‘em keen. God. You don’t know how lucky you are, Missy. If I was married to a guy like that, I’d chain him to the bed, throw away the key—and then spend the whole day riding his face.’

I actually liked that idea.

I guess I was more submissive than I realized. At least since I’d returned from my coma.

I missed something that Dana had said. But then Sarah asked her, ‘So what happened? The first time he got out of hospital, you couldn’t stop telling me how incredible he was. And he was so goddamn hard the whole time...’

‘I don’t know. I guess I pushed him too hard. When I told him he could do whatever he wanted to me... and... I asked him to spank me... he just flopped.’

‘Admit it, you were hoping he’d suddenly transformed into Professor Sex.’

Dana laughed, but said, ‘I didn’t quite expect that much from him. But... I don’t know... something... Instead it got all awkward and weird.’

Sarah said, seriously, ‘You should just tell him everything. Tell him you need a rock-hard stud occasionally...’

‘Occasionally?’

The two of them giggled some more. Sarah said, ‘Okay... all the time. You need a big, muscle-bound idiot to ram his huge cock into you until you can’t walk for a week. And nothing else will do.’

‘But I do love him.’

‘Of course you do. Why else are you still with him after all this time?’

Listening to them, I sighed. Sarah didn’t seem particularly fond of me, from her tone. Except for the fact that I was a man, and she was somewhat desperate because she’d been on her own in the lockdown for so long. I guess if you thought about it, I was sexually more her type than Dana’s. But she sounded as though she’d been lobbying Dana to leave me for years.

‘He is different now,’ Dana argued, and her openness to my transformation was reassuring. ‘I don’t know. If I had to choose between him and someone like Jackson Ross, I’d choose Damien in a heartbeat.’

‘You’d choose this Damien. But how much longer until he regains his memory...?’

‘The doctors say it’s unlikely he’ll fully—’

‘Or when he rediscovers his passion for investment fucking banking, and then you find yourself an afterthought all over again—just part of the furniture.’

‘He hasn’t shown much interest in going back to work yet.’

‘Give him time,’ Sarah said dryly. There was a pause. I got the sense that Dana wasn’t entirely happy that Sarah was making assumptions that things would just go back to being the way they had been before. Sarah sighed, but then pointed out: ‘Look. You know he’s never going to satisfy you. Not the way you need.’

‘I can satisfy myself,’ Dana insisted.

Sarah cackled. ‘You’re going to rely on Pornhub the rest of your life?’

‘I like having sex with him,’ Dana said. ‘Things have changed. The way he looks at me now. Like he worships me. I mean, sure, he doesn’t have the biggest cock in the world...’

I felt my guts wrenched out at that one.

Did I have a small cock? I’d always assumed it was kind of average. It was a little shocking to hear Dana disparage it. Actually, as I let the shock sink in, it seemed almost as disturbing to me that I would feel so hurt by the idea that they would think I had a small cock. Did it really matter? Was I such a narcissist as to worry about how big my cock was compared to other men?

But Dana hadn’t said it to be hurtful to me. In actual fact, she was saying nice things about me.

‘...it’s more sensual... you know, slow and sweet... he makes me feel loved. He makes me feel gorgeous...’

‘You are gorgeous.’

‘It’s not something I’ve... felt before. Well, not since...’

‘Professor Sex.’

‘Well, yes, but...’

‘But Professor Sex had a wife, right? And when it came down to it, his choice was his wife and his career, or you...’

‘That doesn’t matter anymore. Point is, I’m happy with Damien. I like sleeping with him, I do. It’s just... different.’

‘Different? Is that what you call sex when you don’t come?’

‘He can make me come. I told you.’

Well, that was good news. I’d been wondering if she’d been faking it since I came out of the hospital.

‘Not like Jackson Fucking Ross can make you come. Or any of the others.’

Others? Now that was a surprise. She’d had affairs with other men before her CrossFit instructor? My heart burned. And yet, my hard cock throbbed. It might be difficult for me to hear this, but it was still a thrill, strangely.

‘The others were all fucking sociopaths,’ Dana said.

‘Sociopaths with big fucking dicks.’

‘A big dick isn’t everything, you know.’

Both of them were laughing at that. It felt a little cruel to me, and yet oddly, I felt a curious new lightness of heart. I realized I liked the idea that Dana would need a seriously big cock. That even if she loved me, and she loved sleeping with me, she might always have that craving for a well-hung stud.

‘No, seriously,’ Dana said when the giggling had subsided. ‘I mean, you know, when I’m with him...’

‘I know, I know, he makes you come with his mouth,’ Sarah said, like she was bored of hearing about it from Dana. I smiled. I liked that it was impressive for Dana. ‘But he doesn’t make you come with his dick. He doesn’t tie you up and spank you until you squirt all over the fucking room. He doesn’t fuck you in the ass until you can’t fucking breathe. I know what you need.’

Hmm.

Dana said, 'I can help him, when we're together. I can make myself come when I need to.'

'You need a man with a capital M. Damien is not that guy. He never was.'

'No man with a capital M would ever love me the way he does.'

'Well, no, goes with the territory, huh. I mean, Professor Riley—'

'John made a choice, and I was not his choice.'

'But he was obsessed with you—'

'Obsession is not the same as love. Not real love.'

I smiled. To hell with having a big dick or not. I liked being in love with Dana, I liked that she wanted to love me, that she could choose my love. That she would argue for being with me.

'Maybe if he loves you, and you're honest with him, he'll see he can't give you everything you need.'

'There's no way he'd want another man laying a finger on me.'

I felt my stomach churning—thinking, you know, I might be okay with another man laying a finger on me. Would she think me pathetic because of that?

'How do you know if you don't ask him?'

There was a silence. Suddenly, I was on Sarah's side. Jesus, what if Dana did ask me for permission to sleep with someone else on the side. The very thought made me fizz all over, the butterflies flutter in my stomach like there was a storm coming.

'I couldn't see anyone else anyway at the moment,' Dana said eventually. 'We are supposed to be social distancing, you know.'

'But the lockdown's going to be over soon. And then you can sneak Jackson Ross into your bed again, right?'

'Jesus, Sarah, keep your voice down,' Dana hissed, getting a little paranoid that I might overhear.

‘I mean, I remember the way it used to be. Separate bedrooms, right? Hubby’s conked out after a late one at the office, and naughty Dana runs down to the backdoor to let her hunky CrossFit instructor into the building.’

‘Sarah. I’m not doing that anymore.’

‘Not the only backdoor you were letting him in, either,’ Sarah giggled. ‘Or that Russell guy—you snuck him into your bedroom a couple of times, right?’

I gasped. Russell? My best friend Russell Duvall?

‘That was way too risky,’ Dana said, and I felt an odd mixture of shock, betrayal and unbelievable arousal. ‘And Russell realized that, too, pretty quickly.’

Sarah laughed. ‘Not before he made you twist and shout with that big ol’ donkey dick of his.’

‘Look,’ Dana said, suddenly speaking so quietly, certain I had to be on my way back from speaking with Bill Ruskin. ‘The point is, I love him, and I want to make this work.’

‘And *my point* is, you’re going to get three weeks down the road, and you’ll start feeling a big part of your life is now missing.’

‘I can adapt,’ Dana insisted. ‘You said yourself... maybe I need to try out the whole submissive husband thing.’

‘What, tell him to lick your pussy while you watch real men on Pornhub?’ Sarah giggled. I didn’t actually object to the idea of going down on my beautiful wife while she watched pornography. ‘You’ll still feel like you’re missing something.’

‘Maybe,’ Dana said.

Then Sarah said, ‘Hey, look. If he’s anything like the submissive guys I’ve been with... he might be open to... you know... sharing.’

‘Sharing?’

‘Well, isn’t that how you like the husbands in porn?’ Sarah asked her. ‘Watching their cheating wives getting pounded?’

DANA ON TOP

After that, I had to get out of there. I'd been too long already. I wandered back to the courtyard, joined the two of them again for a while, exchanging small talk.

I sat through about half an hour of the two of them talking about their hair—how difficult it was doing without a stylist during lockdown, and how they had both been coping recently—before I started pretending to be tired, and begged their leave to retire for the evening.

I got the impression they were quietly delighted that I was going to leave them to gossip between themselves, though the fact that I could blame my need to escape on the post-viral fatigue was a face-saving move on all sides.

I don't know—I felt oddly excited that Dana would spend a little more time talking in private with Sarah. I mean, if Sarah was going to persuade Dana that it might be a good idea to come clean about wanting to have an affair, that might be a good thing. Considering that I could no longer deny the fact that thinking about her being unfaithful turned me on considerably.

Anyway. I was glad to get out of there. Even if I wasn't as tired as I made out, it was somewhat draining to be in their company.

I chilled out in the TV room re-watching *The Matrix*, which I'd always loved, and now it seemed I had two sequels to watch that I had no memory

of seeing.

Later, much later, I headed upstairs to bed.

The thing was, was I supposed to sleep in my room, or Dana's? I wanted to spend the night with her once she was done with Sarah. But going into her bedroom uninvited seemed a little impolite, even if we were married. I just wasn't sure how to deal with this separate bedrooms thing.

I ended up not really making a decision at all. I went into my office, and dumped myself in the chair behind my desk. I figured maybe I could even wait until Dana and Sarah called it a night, and see which bedroom Dana decided to spend the night in. Then I could emerge from my office and join her, and make it clear I wanted to end the whole separated bedrooms, thing.

I guess Bill Ruskin had gotten me thinking about work. I'd felt like an idiot talking to him without knowing a thing about him, his company, or even my company. Unlike Dana's office, in my office there was plenty of paper around. Reports, files, books. Filing cabinets. My computer was almost buried under everything.

There was a printer behind me, which seemed to have a few reports sitting in the tray that I assumed must have been among the more recent things that had come in before my hospitalization. I picked them up. The top one was about Palantir, a data analytics company based in Palo Alto. There was one about Samsung, which at least I recognized as a company. The third one was more of a memo about a company called GAM Investments. I remembered that one, vaguely.

I glanced at the Samsung report, but it was nothing but analysts' thoughts ahead of a first quarter results update. The Korean company was already finding its results hit by the global pandemic, with sales down in key markets like China. Looking ahead, expectations were that COVID would further impact on performance, but nobody knew how long the virus would remain active. Samsung was investing in something called 5G

infrastructure, which was a complete mystery. All of this was, and all of it made me feel completely out of my depth.

I read more of the report, though it didn't seem particularly thrilling to me. Would I have printed this report if I hadn't intended to read it? I glanced at the other reports from my printer. I looked at various papers scattered across my desk.

Could it be possible I had lost interest in the investment business because of my coma?

I sat in the chair and sighed. What would happen if I couldn't do the work anymore? What kind of financial position were we in if I could no longer earn the kind of big bucks needed for a lifestyle like this, for a ridiculously large mansion in the middle of San Francisco?

It scared me.

It made me feel like I was going to become a laughing stock. A nobody.

And then out of the corner of my eye, I noticed the door opening. I turned, and saw Dana stepping into the room—wearing only black, lacy lingerie—bra, panties, stockings and garter belt, along with a pair of black, high-heeled shoes.

She looked absolutely devastating.

'Wow,' I said, as she approached me.

She smiled. 'You like it?'

'Oh yes,' I said. 'You look incredible.'

She stepped toward me, and I was just riveted. She made me forget, instantly, about my career concerns. I gazed at the way that lingerie clung to her perfect body, and the way the luxurious lace was just about sheer enough to hint at the delights it covered, at the way her stockings and garter belt gave absolutely no doubt whatsoever that this gorgeous woman had dressed up for sex.

'I thought you might be settling down in bed,' she said, brushing a strand of her dark brown hair behind her ear.

‘I... thought you and Sarah would want to spend a bit more time together...’ I could smell her perfume now, and it made me tremble a little.

She smiled. ‘She had to get back home,’ she said. ‘But we’ll do it again soon, I’m sure.’ Then she looked down at me, disapprovingly. ‘You know you’re not supposed to be going back to work yet?’

I gazed up at her, nervous, but turned on.

I guess I was a little frightened that she would discover me—that she would be able to tell I wasn’t going to be able to work the same way I had before my coma. She would know I was going to turn into a failure, that I wouldn’t be able to support this lavish lifestyle of ours anymore.

I was also nervous that she was about to demand the kind of sex I could not give her. Dressed up like this, she looked stern and unbelievably gorgeous, but it reminded me of how she’d looked when she’d asked me to spank her. When she’d said I could fuck her in the ass. Was I en route to further embarrassment here?

‘I just thought...’ I said, but I didn’t even know what I thought. I didn’t want to tell her I was thinking she’d want to leave me when she realized I wasn’t the successful businessman she’d married.

She took the papers from my hand and gazed down at it with a dark frown on her face.

Then she looked at me, and tore the papers into quarters.

‘You don’t need any of this,’ she said.

I looked shocked, and worried that the papers she was destroying might turn out to be important.

‘You’re not supposed to get involved in work for another three weeks,’ she said sternly.

‘No, I know,’ I said, worried that Dana was actually angry with me. The outpatient team had told me not to go back to work for a month. They’d said the potential stress could disrupt my recovery. ‘I won’t... I’ll stop,’ I said.

Dana glanced around the room, as though she rarely ever went in there. Then she turned, and slowly paced a circuit of the room, before stopping to perch on the large, green leather armchair over by the fireplace.

‘Maybe we should lock this place,’ she said. ‘And I should keep the key away from you.’

‘Maybe,’ I said, agreeably, trying to avoid her anger by giving in to whatever she wanted as soon as she stated it.

‘I shouldn’t have let you talk to that guy—what was his name? Bill?’

‘No, I should have just hung up on him,’ I said.

‘Maybe you should let me have your phone, so we can make sure you don’t get drawn into anything.’

I was a little shocked at that, and it showed on my face.

She responded to it by saying firmly, ‘I’m not going to let you ruin your recovery, my darling.’ Then she added, ‘Come over here.’

I went to her, of course. She was making it clear she wasn’t going to take any shit from me. And fair enough—if she had to take care of me, and I was setting back my recovery by doing stupid things like working when I was supposed to be resting, then it would make her life harder. But she was also pulling me away from the office chair, which took a commanding position in this room. She was taking away my sense of power from sitting behind that desk.

When I approached her, she sat back in the armchair, lifted her feet up onto its edge, and parted her legs to expose her lace-covered sex to me.

‘This is the only work you should be doing for the next few weeks,’ she said, running two fingers down between her legs.

‘Yes, honey.’ Trembling all over—nervous, excited, and penitent.

She lifted one of her high-heeled shoes. ‘Kiss it,’ she said.

I furrowed my brow, but my head was so addled I didn’t quite understand what she was doing. I just knew that I had to do whatever she

said to try to avoid her anger. I took hold of her shoe, and planted a little kiss above her toes on the shiny black leather.

‘You can take off your clothes, too,’ she said.

She kept her foot in place, and so I continued to kiss it while pulling off my shirt. But then as I pulled off my shirt, she suddenly sat forward, on the edge of the chair, and reached for my belt.

‘I’ll help you...’ she said, pulling off my belt.

‘Thank you.’

‘Now, you’re going to do everything I say, right?’

I tried to hide my tremors. I was so turned on—and yet, so afraid she was about to tell me to spank her again, and then I’d get a disappointed wife all over again, only this time she’d be angry, too.

‘Uh... yes, honey, of course,’ I said.

‘Take these off,’ she said, sitting back in the armchair again, once my belt was gone.

I pulled my pants down, and saw that she’d slipped off her panties, before settling back in the armchair again, stroking her pussy while she watched me pull off my undershorts.

‘Get down on your knees.’

I did as she told me. I could smell her arousal in the air.

‘All the way down,’ she told me, and I wasn’t quite sure what she meant—I was kneeling already. I ducked my head lower, and she nodded, but appeared to be waiting for more. Did she want me to bow to her?

I bowed lower.

And lower.

Now she put a hand firmly on my head, and pulled me down onto her exquisite pussy.

Wow. I drew in a deep chestful of her spicy scent, the smell of a wicked woman who I now knew had cheated on me repeatedly during our marriage. God, I couldn’t get enough. I kissed her, long and slow, just beside her sex,

as though to tease her now that she had me right here, wedged between her thighs.

I stroked her pussy lips with my nose, feeling the intense heat from her body, the slickness of her arousal already seeping from her slit, her juices already making the air around her cunt humid.

She moaned as my tongue first touched, gently, between her pussy lips and then coursed its way up through her slippery folds to her sensitive little button. She started gently rocking her hips as I sucked on her pussy, as I lapped at her wetness like an animal.

‘That’s better...’ she sighed, gripping my hair with one hand, making it clear I was doing this because she wanted me to, even if I happened to enjoy it.

‘I think...’ she said, ‘Every time you get the urge... to start working... you’re going to tell me.’

‘Yes, honey,’ I agreed in between kisses around her clit.

‘Oh... yes... and if you feel the urge... to start work again... I will put you to work instead...’

I moaned by way of agreeing to her demand.

She said, ‘You like that? Cleaning up my dirty little pussy?’

Oh God. She said that, and I thought of all the men who had fucked this very pussy during the time we’d been married. How many had there been? Jackson Ross, obviously. But Sarah had said Dana had fucked ‘others’, too. And Dana had confirmed it.

I said, ‘Yes, honey, I love it,’ and ate her for all I was worth.

After a while, she pushed me up, telling me, ‘Don’t over do it, my darling. The doctors told you to take it easy this next month.’

I knelt there, gazing at the pussy she was taking away from me. My hand fell to my crotch, but she flicked my hand away again with her foot, asking me, ‘Did I say you could touch your cock?’

I kept my hands, my arms, well away. She started toying with my hardness with her feet. With those high-heeled shoes at first, and then she kicked them off, and used her stocking-clad feet to stroke my raging hard-on.

‘Are you going to let me do whatever I want with this cock?’ She asked me. It struck me as something of a turnaround from the time she’d told me to do whatever I wanted to her.

‘Yes, honey. Of course.’

‘I was talking to Sarah about you,’ she said, as though she needed to. ‘She said maybe I’ve been treating you too soft all these years.’

I was a little surprised by this. Remembering what I’d heard of her conversation with Sarah. Sarah pointing out that Dana needed ‘a man with a capital M’. And Dana hadn’t corrected her. So what was Dana saying now? From the way the two of them had talked, Sarah was the one that went more for the submissive man. And this wasn’t Sarah dressed up pretending to be Dana.

‘You should try it,’ Sarah had told Dana. ‘Treat him a little mean. Maybe you’ll like it. Maybe he’ll like it.’

And now Dana was on her feet, telling me to lie down on the green leather couch opposite her armchair, that I needed to ‘take it easy’.

And when I did lie on the couch, she climbed onto me, straddling me, clambering up my body.

She knelt over my head, her stocking-clad thighs right there either side of my face, her rosy-red pussy with its prominent lips, just perfect for sucking on.

‘You have to take it easy, honey,’ she said, ‘let me do the work.’

Then she touched her pussy down against my mouth, giving me some time to enjoy it, appreciate the joy of being so intimate with her, to savor the taste of her delicious, soaking-wet sex —

Her adulterous sex.

Lapping at her some more, thinking she was joking when she'd said she was going to 'do the work'.

She hadn't been joking.

As I licked her, she started moving her hips, gyrating over me, taking charge of the contact between her dripping-wet pussy and my mouth. She positioned herself so that she was kneeling directly over my head, her body vertical, and then she started to thrust—slowly, gently at first, but as I held out my tongue and got used to her motion and her touch, her thrusting accelerated, and she was pushing herself down on me more forcefully.

I enjoyed it—at first, she had to slap my hand away from my cock, telling me I wasn't allowed to touch it while she rode my mouth—but it got to the point where I felt I was only just coping, only just holding on as she used my face for her own pleasure.

And yet, the way she sounded while she was using me like that seemed like ample reward for any hardship I faced between her thighs. She moaned like she was completely surprised how much pleasure I could give her like this. She gasped as though she was genuinely astonished that she could be made to feel this way by a man happy to be under her, subjugated by her.

She cried out, 'Oh my God...' as though I was rocking her world, when she'd already ruled out ever enjoying a significant orgasm from a husband like me.

When she was done, and she lifted herself off me, my face was soaking with her juices, my hair wet with my own perspiration—it had been hot and humid between her thighs, and now she dismounted it felt like stepping from the tropics into an air-conditioned building. But she had a genuine, beaming smile stretched across her pretty face, and it made me feel like I'd won the lottery.

'Maybe Sarah was right,' she said, recovering her breath.

She pulled me to her, and kissed my mouth, and I was surprised that she didn't object to kissing me considering that I was slick with her own

wetness.

‘You want to use your cock?’

‘Yes, honey.’

She grinned. ‘You want to use your cock to make me come?’

‘More than anything.’

‘Go to your room.’

I did as I was told. She followed me through to my bedroom, then told me to lay down on the bed. I did so, lying on my back, propped up on my elbows to watch her stand there at the end of the bed looking ravishing in her lingerie—minus her panties—gazing at me as though she was assessing a race horse before the Kentucky Derby. I felt exposed to her, my legs parted, my cock only half-stiff now that nerves were coming back to bite.

What was she planning on doing? What if I failed her again? What if she climbed on me and order me to fuck her, and I couldn’t get hard at the key moment?

She was staring at my cock, and I was getting worried I’d get trapped in a sexual vicious circle.

‘You don’t remember how it was between us before your coma,’ she said.

‘No,’ I said, as honestly as I could.

Her eyes rose up my body, eventually connecting with mine. She said, ‘After we were married a year or two, you were getting really successful at Platinum Mark. I mean, you came home with a \$100m bonus one Christmas.’

I raised my eyebrows at that one. But she didn’t seem impressed.

‘And you got more and more hooked. And you spent less and less time at home.’ She folded her arms. ‘Less and less time at home with me at least.’

‘I’m sorry,’ I said, and I was being sincere. I think she could see that. ‘I wish I could turn back time... and change things.’

She nodded. 'I'm not saying it was all your fault,' she said, climbing onto the bed, kneeling between my parted thighs. She put her hands gently either side of my cock, stroking me there, and conceded, 'I guess I saw you bury yourself in the work, and that gave me permission to do likewise.'

She smiled, and looked into my eyes as she pushed forward and leaned over my lap, running her soft hands up my chest. 'You know,' she said, 'it was a common occurrence in the evening for you to be shut in your office, and me to be shut in mine—both of us working.'

'Really?' I said.

'We'd come home from work, and just do more work,' she said, and seemed to experiment by gently sweeping a hand slowly over my half-hard cock. 'And then, we went to bed in separate bedrooms so that neither one of us would disturb the other if we wanted to work later into the night.'

She stroked my thighs. I wondered if this was her feeling fully confessional. If she was thinking about confessing all her sins.

I cheated on you before your coma. Over and over again.

I even cheated with your best friend.

'We don't have to be like that,' I said. 'I'm... I'm different now.'

She nodded, but it was more like she was confirming that I was correct in my analysis, rather than being pleased that I was offering to change, to commit to paying attention to her now that we had this second chance.

She put her hand on my thickening cock, and started rolling it around—she wasn't really holding it, she wasn't stroking it, she was just shepherding it around in a circle,

She said, firmly, 'We're not going to be like that.' Like it was already decided. I was a little startled that she would be so certain about that, but at the same time I was delighted that she would. I was ecstatic that she was talking about paying attention to our relationship so that it wouldn't ever descend into separation again.

I was delighted that she loved me enough, she wanted me enough to commit to me, to our sex, even if it took work.

‘No, we’re not,’ I said, sounding as certain as she did.

‘You’re not going to over-work ever again,’ she said, before conceding, ‘I’m not going to over-work either. But the important thing is, you’re not.’

‘I promise,’ I said, and meant it.

Deep down, I was thinking, what would she say if she discovered I couldn’t work at all. Or at least, not in the investment business. I’d lost the stomach for it.

She smiled, and knelt up before reaching behind her back to unfasten her bra. ‘You have to mean it,’ she said, cupping her breasts without, yet, letting her bra fall away, as though holding out on me until I satisfied her that I would never again pay more attention to work than I did to her.

‘I mean it,’ I said earnestly.

She brushed the straps of her bra off her shoulders, and slowly revealed her magnificent breasts. Her nipples were wonderfully stiff. Then she swept her hair back over her shoulders, out of the way, and leaned down again to resume fondling my thickening cock.

‘You know, it got so bad between us, my friends told me I should leave you,’ she said. I felt my stomach tying itself into knots to hear her say that. ‘They said, get a divorce. Stop kidding yourself things would ever change.’

‘Well, they have changed,’ I insisted.

She smiled, and ducked down so that her pretty face was inches away from my obscenely exposed cock. She blew on it, and it bobbed as if in response, continuing to thicken up.

‘I do love you,’ she said. ‘I always did.’

I just listened to her. Was she going to confess to her affairs? She almost seemed to be in that kind of mood. Let’s come clean about everything, we’re starting afresh anyway.

‘That’s why I stayed with you. Of course I did.’ She curled her fingers around my stiff shaft, and started playing with it, stroking it, squeezing it. ‘I was reading all kinds of articles and books... how to make your sexless marriage hot again... I went to see a therapist...’

‘Did you talk to me about it?’ I asked, feeling a little stupid, even though it was hardly my fault I couldn’t remember.

‘You weren’t interested,’ she said. I felt my heart being crushed. My cock softened—and Dana noticed it.

She said, ‘You know, some of my friends told me I should cheat on you.’

I gasped when she said that, and hearing me, her eyes switched from my cock to my face, and I registered surprise in her expression. Her hand had stopped moving on my cock.

I realized that it was suddenly hard as a marble column. She couldn’t have failed to notice that.

The way she was looking at me, I thought she was just about to reveal that she had done as her friends had advised. A number of times.

‘I don’t know...’ she said, beating about the bush. ‘Maybe if you hadn’t suddenly gotten sick... ended up in the hospital... I might have been tempted...’

She wasn’t quite lying to me—maybe she would have been tempted if I hadn’t gotten sick. That was a strong likelihood, since she had been tempted anyway, and I knew for a fact she had actually gone through with it—with more than one man. But this didn’t feel like she was deceiving me to cover up her transgressions.

She was testing me.

I sighed as she slowly pumped my rock-hard cock, and said, ‘I guess... that would have been understandable...’

She ducked down, and licked the base of my cock, my balls, slowly, gently, like some kind of reward for not getting angry or jealous about the

idea that she might have cheated on me if I'd continued being a cold, heartless a-hole.

She laughed, 'You know, Sarah told me I should just walk into your office one night and order you to lick my pussy. And if you said 'no', I should find another man to fuck.'

My cock throbbed in her hands. She had to be noticing it. She kissed its tip, and gazed up at me, assessing me, examining me.

'Sarah always liked telling men what to do,' she said, kneeling up in front of me, one hand sliding down between her legs to begin stroking herself while I watched. 'I guess I see what she sees in it...'

My God, what a vision.

'I guess I should have tried it on you,' she smiled, reaching down to grasp my flagpole again. 'Maybe it would have worked.'

'Maybe...' I breathed.

'You know, I had a boyfriend in college who liked me to dominate him,' she said, licking my cock again.

'Yeah?' I asked her, not needing to hide my fascination.

She smiled, 'Of course, he had a very small dick... so I guess he needed to please me in other ways...'

She took the entire tip of my cock in her mouth, and I moaned as I felt it engulfed by her heat.

'Yours isn't as small as his was,' she said, when she came up for air.

'You think mine's small?' I asked her.

She grinned, accepting that her words had sounded unflattering. 'I'm not saying that at all... I love your cock... I love sucking it...'

Oh Jesus. She was good at that, too.

'But you prefer them bigger, is that what you're saying?'

She looked up at me with faux shock. It was telling, her lack of a denial. I mean, I knew she liked a man with a big dick, of course. But this was now out there. And I wasn't losing a hint of my hardness as she sucked on me.

I liked thinking of her craving a big cock. I wouldn't have said it made me feel inadequate, or hurt, or even particularly envious of larger men. It was as if she had a serious crush on Brad Pitt, but that didn't stop her from loving me, from wanting to sleep with me.

'I did have a couple of boyfriends... who were on the larger end,' she said, speaking cautiously, looking up at me as she pumped my shaft in her hands to monitor my response so that she could stop if I showed any kind of distaste or objection.

But I only smiled, and my cock throbbed in her hands. I asked her, 'Did you like them to spank you?'

I think my question surprised her a little. It wasn't just me tolerating discussion of her exes, it was me inquiring further about them and their sexual dealings with her.

'Uh-huh,' she said, still paying close attention to my face to register how I was responding to these revelations.

'You liked it when they told you what to do?'

She nodded. 'It was fun,' she said.

I smiled. 'I'm sorry... it doesn't really come naturally to me.'

She shrugged. 'No,' she said, kneeling up, climbing onto my lap. 'But that just means we need to figure out what does come naturally to you.'

She sat down on my hardness, and wiggled a little to rub her burning-hot sex against my shaft.

I found myself recalling how it had looked when she'd been on all fours, urging me to spank her, to take her in the ass. But now I was imagining some past boyfriend—perhaps an academic, a professor—had been in my place. Perhaps I would be sitting in the armchair in the corner, instead, watching. And that suddenly seemed to throw a whole new light on that awkward memory of mine.

My cock felt as solid as concrete.

‘I’m going to fuck you now,’ she declared, one hand pressed against my chest as though she was forcing me to be there. ‘I’m going to use your cock for my own pleasure.’

‘Yes, honey.’

‘And if you fail to make me come with your cock,’ she said, ‘you’ll have to make me come with your mouth, afterward.’

‘Yes, honey.’

She slipped my cock inside her sex, and it felt like heaven on earth. She pumped her hips, and started riding my hardness—and she ramped up to full velocity quickly, as though she didn’t care whether I was ready or not. She was using me. I loved every moment.

She pressed her tits against my face as she fucked me, telling me to suck on them, telling me to lick her nipples. I found myself wondering if she pushed her tits in other men’s faces. If she’d done it with her small-dick boyfriend in college.

She put her stocking-clad feet up on my thighs as she continued fucking me, as though I really were just part of the furniture, and it seemed sexy as hell. She rode me until I was very close to coming—and then she stopped.

She turned around, saying, ‘That was nice, wasn’t it? I still feel like you need to make me come again, though, before I let you come.’

I wasn’t sure what she was getting at. She turned around, straddling me reverse cowgirl style. But then she didn’t slide my cock back inside her—she backed up, she wedged her knees back against my armpits, and moved back so that her rear approached my face, and I was gazing at a full-on close-up view of her glistening sex.

‘Go on, get going.’

I craned my neck so I could reach her pussy, and kissed her there. She was so wet, so fragrant. It was intoxicating as I set to tonguing her groove, lapping up her wetness. Then she pushed back further, until she was sitting on my face again, this time facing my feet, and I eagerly serviced her in the

hot, humid space between her thighs as she squirmed and wriggled and rocked on top of me.

It struck me, as she made herself come with great soprano cries, that something about making love to her with my mouth was different than it had been earlier. She'd had my cock inside her just now, I was now licking her pussy after she'd been fucking me. I don't know—probably, the difference was subtle, maybe even all in my head. But the feeling that I was sucking her pussy after she'd had sex made my mind leap to wondering if it would be like this to go down on her after she'd been with another man.

I wanted her to cheat on me. I wanted to be there afterward, to reclaim her, to experience her unfaithful sex firsthand, up close and personal.

She came, hard, as I was imagining her recent infidelity—reaching behind to grab my hair as she rode my face. She must have looked like she was in a rodeo, trying to stay on the mechanical bull.

When she finally released me, picking herself up off my body, she said, 'Did you like that?'

'Yes, honey,' came my immediate reply.

She was looking down at my cock, again somewhat surprised by what she was seeing. I was stiff as a board, even though she hadn't been touching me there.

'You want to come?'

'Yes, please.'

'You have to beg for it.'

'Please let me come, my sweet. Please let me come...' I wasn't sure I liked begging. But it seemed to be enough for her. She lay back on the bed, stroking herself as she did so. She looked just stunning, still wearing her stockings and her garter belt. She got comfortable, and parted her legs, and beckoned me forward with the hand she wasn't using to stroke her pussy.

She made me wait there a moment or two, as she just pleased herself. Then she said, 'You can put it inside me now.'

I knelt up against her hips, my thighs touching against hers. I touched my cock down against her sex, pressing my shaft against her lips. She didn't stop stroking herself.

'You have to ask permission,' she said.

'Please let me put my cock inside you,' I asked her. The words felt alien in my mouth, but seemed to provoke a response in her, so the hint of embarrassment just faded.

'Okay,' she said, parting her pussy lips with her hand as I pushed forward, and eased my cock back inside her.

'Mmm...' she moaned.

She felt incredible. So tight, so hot. Was this how it had felt for Jackson Ross?

Was this how it had felt for Russell?

She pulled me down on her as my thrusting accelerated to a healthy pace. Then she pressed her hand against my mouth, like she was gagging me—her hand, wet from stroking her pussy, filling my chest with that wicked scent of sex once again.

It was enough to send me over the edge. I grunted, groaned, and let go, releasing my thick cream deep inside her.

'My God...' she beamed, and I guess I was coming inside her for an unusually long time, my orgasm just powering on far further than it should have—but then, it was as powerful an orgasm as I could remember.

'That felt good?' she asked me.

I could only nod, exhausted. But that was good enough for her. Her beaming smile spread across her face—but there was something in her eyes that really hit me. A sparkle I'd never seen before, at least as far as I could remember. I'm fairly sure it wasn't only me imagining it—it seemed that Dana was recognizing that she really liked turning me on. That, somehow, more than it had ever done so before, making me feel good actually made her feel good, even beyond the simple fact that I'd made her come earlier.

Somehow, although she didn't personally crave a submissive husband, she had come to see that fulfilling her husband's desire to be controlled in the bedroom could make her feel good, too. What she lost in terms of a powerful climax because she didn't have a big cock drilling her, an alpha male pounding her, she made up from the simple joys of altruism. Of pleasing the man that she loved.

Maybe I was reading too much into her expression in that moment. It felt like a monumental night—we'd looked at the flaws in our marriage, and instead of worrying about them, we had addressed them head on. We had pledged to prioritize each other above work from now on. That was important.

But it also seemed to me that Dana had learned more about me in this one night than she had all of the rest of our marriage combined. And I guessed I was learning about her all the time.

VIDEO EVIDENCE

When I woke up, I was in my bed again. It was late morning and my body ached everywhere. To my surprise, Dana was still in bed with me, facing away, her bare shoulder exposed where the cotton sheets had slipped away.

I kissed her shoulder, and she murmured something sleepily. ‘I’ll make coffee. Keep sleeping.’

Was it a Saturday? A Sunday? I had no idea. Between the pandemic, the lockdown, and me not having to work at all, the days of the week had lost their meaning to me, but not to Dana. She still had a job. She still had meetings.

I took the stairs down to our kitchen, holding the railing and feeling like I’d just awoken from my coma all over again. Last night had been intense—in the best ways possible. Things were not as doomed as they had been before. When I got sick, it seemed to give us some borrowed time, but deep down, I knew that one day it would run out. I’d wake from this fairytale, and while the house and the beautiful wife were not imagined, none of this around me would last.

Now, I felt like there was a chance. We could mend things. We *were* mending things.

We could get past the past.

Russell. Other men. Affairs. It should have made me sick to my stomach to think about, but it didn't. If anything, it got me hard all over again. As I descended those stairs, I tried to wrap my head around that. By the time I stepped onto the ground floor, I had my answer.

It wasn't just the electric feeling of her being with another man. It wasn't just that she craved a 'rock-hard stud' to fuck. It was the cheating part, too, because it meant that she was doing this for herself and her pleasure alone, and after last night, I realized that I liked that place of utter submission.

Had this always been inside of me? This cuckold desire? Or was this something that happened when COVID-19 hit me. Did the virus rewire my brain? Was that even possible?

I wandered out to the courtyard. Two empty bottles of wine sat on the low, rattan table, as well as their two empty glasses.

Along with a phone.

I looked up towards the top of the house, checking to make sure that Dana wasn't up there, watching. I picked it up, wondering if maybe it was Sarah's phone, although I recognized the white iPhone with its rose-gold trim.

When I picked it up, the screen lit up, and there, right on the lock screen, mixed in with a couple news alerts about the coronavirus and hidden in plain sight, were the texts. My stomach dropped.

"Yes, I still have the videos. They've kept me going through this pandemic."

"Here's my favorite."

And then, a video, the still image of my wife looking up at the camera with her hand wrapped around another man's enormous, hard cock.

Short of breath, I tapped the play button of that video, half-expecting the mirage to disappear. It didn't. Instead, the image came alive. My wife, stroking another man's dick, *came alive*. Oh God, there was also sound.

'Say it again,' Jackson demanded.

'I love your big, fat cock.' Her eyes were luminous as she stared right into the camera, like she was looking right at me. *'Please, sir, may I suck it?'*

'You may suck my balls. Then we'll see.'

She looked elated by the denial. Obediently, she pushed his cock against his torso and dipped her head lower. He was shaved bare, making him look even larger. As instructed, she opened her mouth wide and wrapped her lips around his full sac.

'That's it, my pet.' He pulled on something, and I suddenly realized that she was wearing a collar, and in his hands he held the leather leash. *"Earn that cock."*

I didn't recognize where they were. The room—what little I could see—didn't look like it was in our home. Maybe it was Jackson's. Maybe it was the gym where she went to work out, pre-virus.

She kept sucking his balls, swirling them with her tongue as she jerked off his shaft. She couldn't quite wrap her fingers around its girth. Jesus.

'Okay, you may suck it.'

She practically gobbled his cock down, her excitement manifest. *'Look at me,'* he ordered, forcing her to look at him—to look at the camera. *'Fuck this camera while I fuck your face.'*

I winced at the harsh language. I just couldn't imagine saying those words to her. Yet Dana actually moaned. Her dark irises glittered. She was into it as surely as Jackson was receiving.

He tightened the leash, forcing her deeper into her throat. She gagged, opening her jaw wider. Those eyes began to water, but she didn't resist. She let him use her, his cock bulging in her throat. The choking sounds were unreal and unmistakable. I wanted to help her. To reach into the screen and pull her back.

Jackson didn't let up. Not even as her mascara began to bleed and her face turned red. She was suffocating on him. She was going to pass out. Just as her eyes began to roll back, he released the leash and let her breath. She gasped hard, sucking in breath—and yet she didn't look away. She knew her place. She knew what was expected.

He did it to her again, yanking her forward to fuck her face. This time, after release and as she gasped for it, he slapped her face with his cock. She just knelt there, letting him humiliate her like that, her eyes glowing, wanting more.

'Tell me, pet, what do you want.'

'Your come.'

'Where?'

'Wherever pleases you, sir.'

I watched this guy kneel over Dana's pretty face, and squeeze his enormous cock into her mouth. Goodness knew how she fit it in there. It made her cough, splutter, but she just about managed to cope. I honestly thought she'd be ill when he withdrew it from her mouth again—but she was smiling. Pink-faced, getting sweaty, but smiling as though she was feeling fulfilled. As she gazed up at him, his cock flopping all over her face, slapping her cheeks, she looked as though she'd just climbed a high mountain and was now taking in an incredible view.

It was grueling to watch. The guy was treating her so roughly—and yet she was loving every minute. And that, it turned me on, despite its power to shock.

He held the top of her head with one hand and fucked her face for a few seconds—then he'd stop, and she'd break out into a broad smile, and lick his shaft while he waited for the next burst.

She enjoyed this?

But then, I supposed, I had enjoyed it when she rode *my* face.

It looked like hardship, but from her expression, she saw it as a joy. I watched him fuck her face until his huge cock started bucking, and he pulled it out before shooting thick, white cream all over her pretty face. And it was hot, because she was getting off on it.

I closed the video, and looked at my wife's text messages. These messages had been sent last night. In fact, she'd received them—including this video—while she'd been talking to Sarah, after I had gone upstairs to bed. Had she shown Sarah what Jackson Ross sent her? Was Sarah in on the full details of her adultery?

But Sarah wasn't the issue here. The thing that shocked me most was that Dana had been texting Jackson Ross last night. I scrolled back through the messages a little, before he'd told her that their videos had been getting him through the pandemic.

I was stunned—and yet turned on at the same time.

Jackson: Come to my house. No one needs to know. I'll give you what you need.

Dana: It's too risky.

Jackson: Where's the risk? I had a test yesterday, negative. You had a test while Damien was in hospital, and you were negative.

Dana: It's still against the rules.

Jackson: They changed the rules. We can go out now.

Dana: We have to stay 6 feet apart. We have to wear a mask.

Jackson: You can wear a mask while I spank you.

Dana: Mmm... I wish.

Jackson: You can wear a mask while I fuck you in the ass.

Dana: I think that violates the 6 feet rule.

Jackson: You never used to object to being violated.

Dana: God I miss it. I can't believe it. Do you still have the videos we made?

Jesus. She was holding him off, but there was no question she wasn't ending things with him now that I was back from the hospital and our marriage was fully rekindled again. She may not have been cheating, but she certainly sounded as though the only reason she wasn't was because it was against lockdown rules.

But I felt I didn't have time to read any more of Dana's text messages. She wasn't one to sleep in for very long.

I wandered back to the kitchen, leaving the iPhone and the wine glasses where they were, so that she wouldn't think I'd checked her phone. I ate a little cereal, pondering the dilemma of Dana's cheating. I wanted her to cheat, I wanted her to scratch the itch that I could not reach myself. But there was something decidedly off about her doing it while professing her love and adoration to me. Okay, she hadn't lied, per se, since I'd come out of the hospital, but she was carrying on with another man without letting me know anything about it.

Perhaps I needed to force all of this out into the open. Tell her I knew she needed a man to treat her rough, to treat her mean, to spank her and so on. To do things I could not. Tell her she needed to have an affair.

But at the same time, for some reason, I liked the secrecy surrounding her dealings with Jackson Ross. I liked discovering little clues. I liked knowing she was breaking the rules, that she had this dark secret, that she was a wicked, dirty cheating wife. It was all a thrill ride, an adventure.

Maybe I wouldn't tell her I knew about her infidelity. Not for a little while. Not until I had to.

IN CONTROL

I was finishing up my light breakfast when Dana strode in, wearing a fairly loose, black t-shirt and white, Lululemon leggings that were beautifully moulded to her shapely legs.

‘Have you seen my phone anywhere?’ she said, sounding a touch annoyed.

‘Uh... where did you have it last?’

I watched her open the fridge, and reach up within it to grab a bottle of juice, and as she did so her t-shirt lifted to offer a superlative view of her behind.

‘I was...’ She said, piecing together her recent movements. ‘I was with Sarah last night...’

She strode out of the back door, purposefully, and I assumed she would easily find her phone sitting there on the table in the courtyard. Sure enough, when she returned, she was smiling, clutching the iPhone. She approached me and stooped to plant a little kiss on my forehead. When she did so, I could see down her t-shirt, her superb breasts bound in a black sports bra.

‘You’re a star,’ she said.

‘More CrossFit?’ I asked her, unnecessarily.

She smiled, and padded over toward the doorway. ‘Keeps me in shape, better than anything,’ she said. ‘At least during lockdown.’

Then she paused, just before leaving, and added, ‘You could come try some of it. Even if you can’t do the more strenuous stuff.’

I laughed, thinking about all those pull-ups, and the weight lifting. ‘I think I’ll pass this morning.’

She grinned. ‘You could just watch me.’

I felt a burst of warmth between my legs when she said that. ‘That does sound tempting.’

‘Join me in the shower, afterward?’

‘Now we’re talking.’

She blew me a kiss, and then was gone.

I cleared away my breakfast things, thinking about her text messages with Jackson Ross, about the fact that she would be seeing him in a few, short minutes, on the screen of that huge TV down in the gym.

I felt a flicker of pride, knowing that a man like that so desperately wanted sex with my wife. But right now, she was only allowed to see me. That gave me a deliciously smug feeling inside. At the same time, I liked that she’d be seeing him, and I’m assuming judging by his last class, he’d be flaunting his bulge at her, and the rest of the women in that online class.

Drifting out of the kitchen, I was getting all geared up to go down to the basement to watch Dana getting all nice and sweaty—but then my phone buzzed.

Russell.

I sighed.

‘Hey, I tracked down a copy of that photo,’ he said straight out of the gate, sounding slightly breathless.

‘Hey, thanks, buddy,’ I said, sounding cheerful, upbeat. I was a little amused at him—he had been scrabbling around trying to source a photo

that definitively proved that Dana had been cheating on me, when his best evidence, surely, was his own memory of sleeping with her himself.

‘I can scan it, send it straight over?’

‘Actually, I found a copy myself,’ I said.

‘Oh, great.’

I thought about not telling him that I’d found out about him and Dana. I mean, I felt fairly sure I could forgive him—like Dana, he hadn’t exactly lied to me, he’d just kept some of the juicier details to himself. But I figured, if this guy was going to still be my friend—and right now, I could use some friends, since I didn’t remember any—then I didn’t think we should have this kind of secret between us.

I said, ‘Russ. Did you ever... sleep with Dana yourself?’

Here it was. I could almost hear him gulp cartoonishly.

‘Why would you say that?’ he said, and I felt a pang of disappointment deep in my chest.

‘I heard from a *very* good source...’

He sighed. ‘Look,’ he said, quietly, as though he’d been in danger of being overheard before. ‘So late last year, before the world went to shit... you asked me to try... you know, *seducing* her.’

Well, that was a surprise.

‘I was, like, buddy, buddy, there’s better ways of getting the settlement in your favor...’

‘But I was fairly insistent?’ I prompted him.

‘Wouldn’t take ‘no’ for an answer,’ he said. Then, after a beat, he added, ‘Hey, I’m sorry, bud. I should have said something... I mean, I couldn’t quite believe you wouldn’t remember that...’

‘There’s a lot of things I don’t remember.’

‘I thought... you know... maybe it would be better if you didn’t remember that.’

‘How did it happen?’ I asked him.

‘Just like you told me.’

Russell described a trip we all made to the Caribbean on board a large yacht rented by one of the major start-ups trying to butter up the venture capital players. Everyone had been in their swimsuits. Russell’s had been purposefully tight, and with nobody else paying Dana any attention—since everybody knew her husband was around—Russell’s friendly interest had her sticking by him for much of the duration of the trip.

‘I told you to wear tight trunks?’

‘Speedos,’ Russell laughed. ‘Jesus, I haven’t worn those since grade school.’

‘Wow.’ So I must have known about Dana’s predilection for big cocks, even back then. Russell must have looked a real sight in a pair of speedos. *Donkey dick*, Sarah had called him. No wonder Dana had taken an interest in him.

‘When we got back to the States, Dana invited me over for a coffee one time, while you were at the office.’

‘One time?’ I asked him.

He laughed. ‘I saw her a couple more times after that.’

‘Gotta be sure,’ I joked.

‘I thought you wanted pictures—you know, proof. Only, the first time I was kinda surprised she moved in on me so quick. Then the second time... I didn’t get good pictures.’

‘And the third time?’ I prompted him. My heart was hopping about—I was hoping he had the pictures so I could see.

But he said, ‘The last time I spoke with you, before you got sick... you told me to delete them.’

My heart dropped.

He added, ‘I assumed you’d reconsidered, you know, ending things between you guys.’

I was thinking. There was a big gaping silence developing between Russell and I, but I felt like letting him wait for a moment or two. To underline my disapproval at him keeping things from me. Why would I set up my friend to sleep with Dana, and then when he managed to get pictures from the occasion, I would decide to have him delete them?

If I'd been seeking an easy divorce, I could probably have hired a gigolo—were we allowed to call them that anymore? A sex worker. I could have found a guy with an enormous dick and a can't-fail pickup technique to seduce Dana. Had I been worried about kiss-and-tell stories in the media? Was I famous enough for that? Sure, I was wealthy, but there are 20 million people in the States who could call themselves millionaires.

I trusted Russell. I certainly had trusted him back then. If I wanted him to sleep with Dana for the purposes of providing evidence to a divorce court, then why would I ask him to delete the pictures.

'Wait, did you send the pictures to me before I asked you to delete them?' I asked him.

'One of them.'

'Only one?'

Why keep hold of one picture? In this day and age, pictures could be faked. A judge probably wouldn't give much value to a single picture as evidence of infidelity.

Why did I get the sense that I'd already been feeling a strange kind of excitement at the idea that my wife might cheat on me even *before* I'd gotten sick and ended up in the hospital?

'Hey, look, thanks Russ,' I said, and my tone was bright enough to make it fairly clear I was no longer blaming him for anything to do with sleeping with my wife.

'Uh... sure, no problem.'

'I'll call you, right? We should have a drink sometime—apparently we're allowed to meet up now. You know, socially-distanced and all.'

‘Uh, yeah. That would be great. Hey, anything you need, buddy.’

By the time we ended that call, I was feeling fairly confident that I had been feeling this strange attraction to the idea of Dana being unfaithful before my coma. Perhaps I’d even witnessed something between her and some other guy. It felt like there were memories to that effect, if only I could quite reach them.

Had I started changing my ways, rekindling my desire for Dana, even before I’d lost my memory to a coma?

WHEN THE CALL WAS OVER, I heard the beat of the music emanating from the basement. I glanced at the clock on my phone—was her class really still going? It seemed like a long one.

I felt a buzz from talking about my best friend seducing my wife, and perhaps also from figuring out how I’d been before my coma had struck. There was something heartening about learning I might have been changing, as a person, even before the amnesia had happened. Although the amnesia had given me a nice blank slate to start from, it didn’t entirely sit well with me to think that my new, more considerate persona was purely the result of brain damage.

It was reassuring to think that I might have started edging away from being Gordon Gekko while I’d been entirely *compos mentis*.

I padded down the stairs to the basement, now hoping I’d get to see her doing a little working out before the end of her class. Hoping she hadn’t been kidding when she’d suggested I join her, afterward, in the shower.

I approached the door to the gym—but I held back from marching in there and making my presence known.

Call it the voyeur inside me. For now, I preferred to conceal myself, and enjoy the sight of her while she believed herself to be on her own in there.

She was using the treadmill, the running machine. But she wasn't going fast, she wasn't even jogging. She was walking. Was this her cool down activity? Only, she looked like she was having real trouble walking.

Had her CrossFit class exhausted her so much, she couldn't even walk properly?

'Keep going, keep going, don't stop,' her CrossFit trainer barked.

I noticed that there were no other windows featuring other women working out on the TV screen above the view of the instructor. This was one-on-one, Dana was now alone with the big dick. She was wearing a fairly loose black t-shirt today —rather disappointing for the discerning voyeur husband. She was also wearing leggings, rather than shorts, which covered her right down to the ankles—but at least they were skin-tight. And, as I peered more closely, they were white and actually somewhat transparent.

Were her leggings wet?

As I watched her more closely, I could see she was unbelievably sweaty. Her hair was damp, her t-shirt stuck to her in various places. And yes, her leggings were soaked through.

She was holding on tight to the safety rail as she continued on the running machine at walking pace. She was even hanging her head, as though she was ashamed about something. I came to see that it wasn't shame she was going through, though.

As she walked, she wiggled oddly from time to time. Sometimes she lifted a leg, pausing slightly, to press her thighs together, as though she needed the bathroom rather urgently. At other times, she arched her back and pushed out her butt, and almost lost her balance on the machine.

What were those little spasms?

'Please, please...' she said, pleading.

But her trainer said, without mercy, 'Not yet, not yet. Walk on.'

She continued, and I saw one of her hands move to between her legs, pressing at her mound, pawing her sex.

Was she turned on? Was she in the process of some kind of orgasmic response to her CrossFit trainer? Was that why she was finding it so difficult to walk, why she looked like she was in pain?

It went on for a while—I couldn't actually tell whether she was suffering, or experiencing intense pleasure at times.

What I did notice was that her leggings seemed particularly transparent between her thighs and around her crotch, and I came to realize it probably wasn't all sweat. In fact, it was highly likely that very little of her wetness down there was perspiration.

At last, her trainer told her she could stop now, she was done. I watched her sit on the bench press machine, spread her legs, and then start stroking her pussy through her leggings with both hands—really going at it. I could see absolutely everything, thanks to the mirrored wall. Her body kept on jerking and shuddering—I'd watched women masturbating before in porn, this wasn't usual.

I looked at the CrossFit trainer, who had pulled out his big dick and was clutching a phone. An iPhone, if I wasn't mistaken. As he slowly jacked his manhood in one hand, he seemed to be fingering the screen of the iPhone.

Was this some kind of incredible technology he was using? Was he touching the screen of his phone, and somehow it was translating into physical sensations for Dana?

He said, 'You can come now, Dana.'

And then I watched Dana shaking like a maple leaf in an ocean breeze—and when she came, I saw a fresh burst of wetness burst from crotch to saturate her leggings. Was she squirting for him?

I held back from going in there—stroking my own cock, now. I felt like that husband from Dana's Pornhub video, standing in the doorway watching while another man fucked his wife.

It was seriously hot, though. I couldn't entirely explain why, and I certainly couldn't explain why I felt no jealousy at all.

And then, finally, she was done. She seemed completely exhausted.

'Good, Dana. That was a good workout today,' her instructor said, tucking away his cock. Had he come? I'd been too focused on Dana to notice. 'I want you to think about going for a run with me some time soon. You know, we can maintain the required social distance.'

I was too curious about what kind of tech he was using to notice that he'd just demanded that she see him in person.

Dana said, 'I'll think about it,' seeming to me very in control for a woman who apparently got off on being dominated. But then nothing about my beautiful wife struck me as being simple or uncomplicated.

I watched her end the call, and wondered whether she would be too tired for me to join her in the shower again. She did look completely drained.

When she shuffled over into the bathroom, of course I followed her. This time, I stood behind the other side of the doorway, where the wall wasn't made of transparent glass bricks. I watched her switch on the shower, and then peel off her t-shirt, and her soaking leggings.

Then, I watched as she removed her drenched thong, and when she bent down to pull it down, I saw that there was something bright neon pink protruding from her pussy. It had a bulbous end, and seemed to be made of hard—but flexible—plastic or rubber.

She tugged on it, and the part of the device that was buried deep within her pussy emerged, again, bulbous and this time about the shape of a large egg.

She'd had a vibrator in her pussy during her entire CrossFit class?

Wow, that was wild.

And her trainer had controlled it over his phone. What crazy technology. Now that was something worth investing in.

After she'd stepped into the shower, I called out, 'Are you in here, honey?' Making myself sound as though I'd just come into the gym to check on her.

'Yeah, in here!' she called back.

I was so unbelievably horny.

What if she was too exhausted to let me make love to her?

Oh God, I wanted her so badly.

'OH! OH, MY... OH MY—YES!' Dana was going off as I held her against the tiled wall of the shower. Her toes left the ground. She wrapped a leg around my body as I slammed her again and again. She was coming. This was real. This wasn't a fake. 'Fuck me, Damian. Fuck me... *right there!*'

This wasn't like last night. Or our failed night before. This wasn't about power or control. Neither of us were dominant, neither of us were submissive. But both of us sure the hell had those things in mind.

'You fucked my best friend.' My thoughts burned. *'And you can't wait to fuck your CrossFit instructor again.'*

'Ah!' she cried out as I hauled her higher, my hands beneath her plush buttocks as I lifted and dropped her on my shaft. 'Yes. Yes, yes!'

Was this how good she came with Jackson Ross?

Was this how good she came with any of the others?

That did it for me. I couldn't hold out any longer. I pressed all that I had against her, flattening her against the wall as I unleashed myself deep inside her wet and welcoming body. Dana practically crawled up the wall, arching her back and lifting her hands high as she screamed in time with me.

Her eyes were shut. Was she thinking about being with another man? As my cock pulsed, I knew what I was hoping for.

In the comedown, my legs practically gave out beneath me. I dropped her ungracefully and sank into a squat, the shower hissing all around us. I was still weak. It was only my passion for this woman that gave me the energy to do what I'd just done.

Concerned, Dana sat down beside me. 'Are you okay, honey?'

I smiled at her weakly. She really was concerned. She really did care for me. 'Pretty sure I'm going to be. Just... just need a minute to recover.'

She kissed me softly and stood. 'I'll order us some lunch. Get some calories back in you.' She strode over to the towels, pulling one around her buxom body. Turning, she smiled. 'That was fun. Can't wait to see what you can do once you're fully recovered.'

When she collected her sweaty things, she was careful not to reveal the toy she'd buried among them. The deception tickled me. She didn't have to hide that, but I couldn't help but get off on the fact that she did. God help me.

DINNER OUT

Over a leisurely lunch of salad and fruit and far too many weird grains and health foods I couldn't even pronounce, Dana told me about her work.

She worked on various start-ups during her 15-year career in the sector, including the one I'd agreed to partly finance, when we'd first started our relationship. I'd had to step away from her project when we were ready to go public as a couple, and professionally we'd gone our separate ways since then, feeling that it made sense to forge our own career paths, and not ever be in danger of muddying the waters for the other.

Right now, the start-up she was working on seemed like a huge project.

Essentially, it was like a virtual mail delivery company. But Dana didn't like to call it that. 'We don't actually deliver anything ourselves,' she said. 'We're just a platform. People can come to us if they have something that needs delivering—an e-commerce seller, or even just a consumer who needs to ship a package somewhere—and we can then put that job to the marketplace, and the delivery company offering the right service for them gets the job.'

'So you'll be like the post office, but online?' I asked.

'Something like that. Except that we'd offer more options than just the post office, or a single delivery company. We offer choice, proper

competition on prices and service.'

'And there's nothing like this available already?'

She smiled. 'There's things like it. Shipping software that e-commerce companies can use, for example, that can select between different shipping companies. But there's nothing to join up the whole system. Everything's fragmented into different delivery companies. A consumer can go to the post office if they want to mail something. Or to FedEx. Or UPS. But we would offer them smaller, local delivery companies, too. And all the companies would compete for the job. So you could get different returns options, different delivery speeds, tracking—whatever you are willing to pay for, but you're going to get the best price for that.'

'Oh, right.'

'And we're not just talking packages, either. Restaurants would be able to send out meals, florists would be able to send out fresh flowers... all kinds of things. And there would be a central point for businesses and consumers to go to, it would make life simple for anyone.'

'Sounds ambitious.'

'You wouldn't believe it,' she grinned. 'And we're not only looking at the States, either—we're looking at an international market. You would not believe how difficult it is to ship stuff when you're in other countries. We're going to allow anyone, anywhere, to get into e-commerce. To send gifts to their loved ones. To shop for anything anywhere in the world.'

I had to hand it to her, she wasn't working on something trivial.

'And what's the long-term prospects for this? I mean, it sounds like a pretty major business venture.'

'We're trying to be as virtual as possible—we don't use our own physical assets. But, yeah, it should scale up to quite a size.'

'And the other big players in e-commerce will just let you get on with this?' I laughed, knowing the way the market would view something like this.

‘We’re talking to Amazon, eBay, Alibaba, Rakuten and so on. They’re very supportive so far—Amazon, and some of the Asian giants have been investing their own delivery systems because they don’t like the quasi-monopolies some of the existing delivery firms have in certain regions, but they would rather not invest in delivery.’

‘So they’d really leave you to it?’

She shrugged, smiled. ‘You know how it works. If this gets successful—and it has a good chance of that—then we’ll get offers.’

I nodded. On the surface, the company was working to transform the world for the better. Behind the scenes, there was an eye open for a multi-billion dollar offer from another Silicon Valley player, a giant along the lines of Apple, or Amazon, or even a company outside the States. Dana said even something like Uber, which started in the taxi business, could end up wanting a piece. And if the right deal didn’t come along, then there was always the possibility of an IPO.

Anyway.

As we were finishing up our lunch, Dana said innocently, ‘I’m going out for dinner tonight.’ Then she gave me a glance that I’d say was a little less than innocent—she looked at me and blushed.

‘A business thing?’ I asked, assuming she didn’t mean she was taking me out to dinner, since she’d been very first-person-singular in her statement.

‘Uh-huh,’ she said. Somehow, I could tell her heart was beating rapidly. Mine was too. Was she meeting Jackson Ross? But she said, ‘Just someone I used to work with—he might be able to help me get in with a number of possible investors...’

I nodded, and secretly wondered if she was telling the whole truth—she could still be intending to meet Jackson Ross. But something in her manner seemed to suggest it wouldn’t be Jackson Ross she’d be meeting.

‘People are allowed to go out for dinner now?’ I asked her.

‘If the tables are outside,’ she said, ‘and there’s still social distancing.’

I thought of her little meeting with Sarah the previous evening. Fair enough.

‘Who’s the guy?’ I asked her, taking a last sip of water.

‘Someone I used to work with at Google, before I even met you. Before I started focusing on start-ups,’ she said. ‘Leo. I guess we’ve kept in occasional contact since we worked together. He’s sometimes useful to bounce ideas off, to give me advice...’

I was aware, as she was telling me about this guy, that she was scrutinizing me more than I was her. It struck me that she was gauging my reaction to hearing that she was going out to dinner with someone else. Another man. A man she knew before we’d even met.

Was this guy an ex?

I stayed calm. If anything, it was mildly exciting to me that she was going out to meet another man. It all fitted in with this strange new kink of mine. I sat there hoping that she was going out to meet an ex-boyfriend for a little illicit sex.

She was quite clearly searching my face, my tone, my body language for any hint of jealousy or mistrust.

I just acted calm, innocent, completely trusting. ‘Probably do you good to get out of the house,’ I smiled. ‘What kind of place is it? What kind of food?’

For a split second, I caught a slight furrow of Dana’s brow, suggesting she was surprised I would show no insecurities whatsoever that she was meeting another man for dinner.

‘Uh... Benu... It’s Asian fusion, I guess,’ she said.

I gave her a smile. ‘Sounds good. Maybe you could bring me back something?’

She studied me, weighing my reaction. ‘I’m not sure when I’ll be back. Could be late.’

This was definitely a test—one that I was going to pass. ‘I can heat it up for lunch then.’ A test that was making me excited just thinking about. ‘Don’t worry about me. Focus on... business.’ I made sure that she heard the pause. What I wasn’t sure of was how she took it.

THE TEST DIDN’T END THERE, THOUGH. Later that evening, after a relatively normal day, as these things go, I caught sight of her getting ready for her dinner meeting—or rather, she made sure that I caught sight of her.

First, around 7, she made a point of letting me know that she was finished with her calls for the day and that she was going to get ready for her dinner meeting. Then, I swear that she waited until I was passing by her bedroom with the door wide open before stepping out of her bathroom in nothing but her lingerie.

My heart skipped. It was black, lacey, and very small—a thong, a plunging demi-bra that made her tits look enormous, a garter belt that held her lace-topped black stockings in place. And shoes, tall and shiny black—shoes that reminded me of the night when she’d dominated me. When I’d gotten off on it.

I nearly tripped as I moved past, especially when she turned and treated me with a view of her ass in that thong. It was lily white right now. Would it be red by the time she came back, criss-crossed with lash marks or the imprints of another man’s hand?

I moved on, trying not to linger, and absent-mindedly fixed myself something for dinner. Dana descended an age later, her sexy underwear hidden beneath a much more appropriate business attire. She already wore a breezy, quarter-length jacket and carried a leather satchel.

‘Sorry to run off. I’ll let you know when I’m headed back.’

‘Hope you get what you need,’ I said, looking her right in the eyes.

She blinked, processing it. Did she hear the innuendo? Did she hear the permission? ‘I’m sure I will,’ she said with a wink. And off she went.

I don’t remember eating, although I’m sure that I did. I do remember the way my stomach swam that whole night, though. How it couldn’t settle. How my brain just could *not* settle. I paced until I was winded. Twice I went to the garage, as if intending to go out to this Benu place before stopping myself.

I thought about calling Russell, but I was still upset with him. After him, though, I had no one else. Instead, I went back to my office and started researching Dana’s old friend, Leo. Unfortunately, with just a first name, I couldn’t find him. Instead, I was left with my imagination, which filled in a good looking man with flowing blond hair and a week-old beard who looked like he’d just returned from a surfing trip in Tahiti.

It didn’t help. All that did was serve to make me uncomfortably hard again. Trying to keep my mind off of it, I dove further into my files. I went back through my emails, starting with work ones before I realized just how lost I was. And how completely disinterested.

I ended up going back and listening to the audio file of Jackson dominating Dana, and it was just as electrifying as the first time I listened. I could not ever do that for her, but clearly she needed it. It made me feel inadequate. It made me feel so turned on.

Turned on enough that I ended up pulling my cock out and stroking it.

‘You love a big cock, don’t you?’

‘I do...’

‘You crave a big cock.’

“Mmmm, yes...”

I was close to coming, and almost at the point where I didn’t care if I made a mess—it was my office. But then I remembered that little scrap of memory I’d regained, of Dana coming into the office, angry at me for shutting myself in here to masturbate, rather than pay attention to her.

I knew a little masturbation here or there was hardly going to put our marriage back into jeopardy, but in that moment, sitting there in that chair where that confrontation had taken place, I suddenly lost the pressing need to come on my own.

A few moments of peace allowed me to think. And actually, I didn't want to come before Dana returned. I wanted to be available for her if she was in the mood after her evening out.

WHAT HE DESIRES

I waited.

I tried not to think about her too much.

I knew it was going to drive me crazy.

But who was I kidding?

I sat on the couch and tried to behave all innocently, calmly watching TV. I did pretty well, too, for a while. I discovered Disney Plus, as well as the fact that apparently there have been an endless string of Star Wars movies. I tried losing myself in that galaxy far, far away, but it didn't entirely rid my feverish head of thoughts of what Dana might be up to on her dinner date, however.

Was it really a date?

Leo, the guy she was seeing, was an old friend. Someone she kept in touch with, who occasionally advised her, or assisted her, in her work. But she didn't really work with him, he wasn't a colleague, he wasn't a boss or an employee. If she slept with him occasionally, it wouldn't be so strange. At least, that was my thought train.

I knew my thoughts were running away with themselves, but I knew for a fact that Dana was desperate for a little alpha male right now. It was perfectly possible she'd go out for dinner with someone and end up in bed with him.

But if she was planning on cheating, why reveal to me that she was seeing a man? She could just as well have told me she was seeing Sarah, or some other female friend I didn't even remember, and I would have been fine with it. I wouldn't have suspected a thing. But she had told me plainly that she was seeing Leo, a guy she'd known since before we'd met.

And then there was the fact that she had changed into sexy lingerie for her evening out, with her bedroom door wide open as she did so—knowing that there was a distinct possibility that I could wander past and accidentally catch sight of her like that. As I had. She was forcing me to suspect that she was cheating on me tonight.

But did that mean she was testing me? And if so, was it more likely that she was cheating on me tonight, or was she more likely to be faking it, making it seem like she might be cheating in order to test whether I'd be jealous.

I waited until midnight, watching Star Wars, raiding the kitchen for snacks.

I thought to myself: if she was testing me to see if I was going to be jealous, and suspect her of cheating, then she'd come home at, say, midnight, or 1am. Late enough to make me certain she was having more than just a business meeting with an old friend—but not so late that she couldn't check on me, and maybe seduce me if she felt like it.

I waited until 1am.

I was getting fairly tired, but the later it got into the night, it seemed to me that the higher was the chance that Dana was actually cheating, and not simply testing me—or, more innocently, merely having an actual business meeting with her old friend Leo.

2am.

It was late. I was sitting on the couch in the TV room sporting a hard-on. Did this mean she was sleeping with Leo tonight? She hadn't texted me to let me know where she was.

2:15am.

I contemplated what Dana might say if she came home now, and found me waiting for her. She'd think I was jealous—even if I categorically denied it—I was fairly certain. She'd certainly believe I was at the very least suspicious.

What was I doing? I was going a little crazy, for sure.

What did I want?

I wanted Dana to cheat. I wanted her to break the rules and have a dark secret, I wanted her to find the 100-per-cent-satisfaction she needed from another man, a man with the huge cock she craved. I wanted her to be wicked, to be selfish, to let her libido go where it took her. I wanted her to be a naughty nymph, a despicable siren, a temptress.

I wanted her to come back to me after a big, sexy adventure and find solace in my love and affection, letting me worship her as my goddess.

Why couldn't I just tell her I was happy for her to see other men if she wanted to? Let everything out into the open?

I just had a niggling fear that things would unravel if I did that. She would take the attitude that there was no point being married if we just went out and enjoyed other people like that. Or she'd imagine I was being open to her infidelity out of some quid pro quo notion that it would mean I could see other women. I really didn't want other women, but whether she would believe that if I came clean on my wish for her to be unfaithful, I had no clue.

Anyway. I had too many doubts to come fully clean with Dana.

And besides, I quite liked the intrigue of having an unfaithful wife who believed she was keeping her affairs a secret.

2:30am.

I went to bed, and now my plan was to get to sleep, to make Dana believe I'd had no concerns whatsoever about what she might be doing with

her friend Leo. That I'd been so at peace with the idea that I'd had a very ordinary night and had then just gone to bed.

Only, the thing was, I couldn't sleep. I lay there in bed wondering what she was doing at that moment. What her plan was. Was she sleeping overnight at Leo's place? Would she tell me in the morning that she'd checked herself into a hotel because she hadn't wanted to come all the way home? But it was a 10 minute car ride away, hardly worth finding a hotel.

Lying in 'my' bedroom, I started wondering if she'd come home and had gone to sleep in 'her' room, not wanting to disturb me. I was even tempted to tip-toe over there and check out her room.

But then, before I could make a move, I heard the door open, and knew that Dana had just returned, and had come to my bedroom.

I was able to glance at the alarm clock and see that it was nearly 3am by this point. Where on Earth had she been? I pretended to be asleep. I didn't want her thinking I'd waited up for her. If she thought I was jealous, that I wanted to keep close tabs on her, she might feel it was too dangerous for her to pursue her interest in alpha males.

I wanted to make her feel secure. I wanted to make her feel bold.

She whispered, 'Honey, you awake?'

I moaned quietly, as though I was asleep, but that she hadn't quite disturbed me enough to wake me. I remained lying there, facing away from her. I could hear her breathing. I could smell her perfume—and, perhaps, a hint of liquor.

'I love you,' she whispered, but I did my utmost to remain still and silent, feigning sleep, even though it was so sweet that she'd said that. Her tone made me feel like she'd had quite a lot to drink, however.

Had she slept with Leo?

I couldn't see her as she sat on her side of the bed, since my back was toward her, and I didn't want to subtly turn over, as I didn't believe it would appear subtle at all. I could smell her perfume, I could smell that she'd been

drinking. I couldn't detect the cologne of another man, however, or anything that might get my suspicions going.

I waited.

I listened to her take off her shoes, and then she seemed to sit entirely still. Was she trying to listen to me? Trying to work out if I really was asleep? I made a few sleeping sounds, a little light snoring. After a moment or two, she lay down—almost collapsed, in fact, hitting the pillow at a fair whack, feeding my suspicions that she had had quite a bit to drink.

And now she was asleep. She was very definitely asleep. If you were a woman, and you were faking sleep noises, you wouldn't make yourself sound like that. I chuckled. Maybe she was a little congested.

I still couldn't sleep.

Had she cheated?

My thoughts just would not settle down.

I turned over to face her. She was lying on her back, still wearing the clothes she'd been wearing when she'd gone out—although she'd removed her jacket. Her hair was a little messy around her head on the pillow, and she had that slight stale aroma of restaurant food and alcohol about her as anyone might get on a night out. Her makeup was a little smeared. Nevertheless, she looked stunning. It turned me on to gaze upon her and imagine she might have been unfaithful.

I couldn't exactly check her out to see if she'd had sex—even if she was sleeping pretty heavily by now.

I took a deep breath, and told myself I couldn't rush this. She'd cheated before, and had got away with it. She had the desire to cheat again, and I'd make sure she got away with it again. I'd enjoy her cheating.

What about the deception, the lying, the fact she would be doing things behind my back?

Well, there were plenty of marriages where one spouse turned a blind eye to the other spouse's infidelity in order to maintain the relationship over

the course of many years.

My eye would only be semi-blind.

I wanted to make love to my wife after she'd been unfaithful, knowing what she'd done.

A PROMISE FOR A LOVER

Dana slept in the next day—a testament to how late she’d come back, and how much she must have had to drink. Reminded me of the other night. I wondered how often this happened with her.

I climbed out of bed, and she barely stirred. All around the bed were her clothes, flung to the ground.

I yawned, went into the bathroom to brush my teeth, and then found some clothes in the walk-in closet. I bypassed all the nice shirts, the polos, the khakis, and grabbed a pair of worn jeans and a t-shirt—my go-to clothes since the coma. I didn’t try being quiet, hoping that Dana might wake. I wanted to know what happened last night.

Of course, if she had slept with Leo, she probably wouldn’t tell me, but even still, I figured I’d be able to sense... something.

But she didn’t wake up. She was completely out of it.

On the way out, I stooped to glance at the clothes she’d shed before collapsing on the mattress. I even picked up her panties—strangely hopeful they’d give away evidence of her infidelity. But I was disappointed.

I left her sleeping, leaving the bedroom and descending to the ground floor, actually disappointed she hadn’t cheated on me. That was a weird sentiment. I ought to be happy, right? She’d gone out with a friend, and it had been nothing more than a night out with a friend. No broken trust there.

I had a little breakfast downstairs, as usual. Dana was sleeping so solidly she missed her usual CrossFit class.

The doorbell rang—a grand bell sound that tried to imitate Big Ben. I groaned, and traipsed to the front door expecting some kind of delivery. Well, we had to eat, right?

But there on the doorstep was an elderly couple wearing masks. Not too elderly, I guess. Early sixties, I'd say. The masks threw me for a moment—despite their age, I had that fraction-of-a-second scare where I felt certain I was being held up, kidnapped or something. But then they slipped the masks down, and I remembered we were all supposed to be taking care to help control this pandemic. I noted the recognition on their faces, and in their warm smiles, and quickly got the message that I was supposed to know these people.

‘Good morning, sir,’ they both said, politely, deferentially. From their bearing and tone, they were either Mormons, or perhaps they were my employees.

‘Morning?’

‘How are you, sir?’ the woman asked.

‘Good,’ I smiled. ‘Thank you.’ I felt a little stupid, more than a little awkward.

‘Mrs Sullivan told us you’d lost some of your memory...’

I felt some relief. I know, I shouldn’t have been ashamed of having amnesia. But when confronted with people you were supposed to know, you didn’t want to offend them by seeming like you’d forgotten who they were.

‘Yeah, I’m real sorry, I am not exactly myself right now...’

The two of them smiled again, warmly, acknowledging and accepting the effects of my condition.

‘We’re the staff, sir. Elsie and Jack McKee. I’m the housekeeper, Jack’s the caretaker.’

‘Great,’ I said, stepping back to invite them in.

‘Normally we’d be here every day,’ Elsie explained as I closed the front door behind us. ‘During the lockdown, Mrs Sullivan had us come once a week, just to get the most important things done. But now the lockdown is beginning to ease...’

‘Okay... well, the place is looking pretty good, so thanks so much...’

‘Is Mrs Sullivan at home?’ Elsie asked, as her husband headed for the stairs down to the basement. Elsie seemed to be leading us to the kitchen, like it was the natural place for her to start her housekeeping duties.

‘Uh yeah...’ I felt a hint of shame as we got into the kitchen and I hadn’t yet managed to clear up after my breakfast. ‘She’s just upstairs, still sleeping.’

‘Of course, sir. We can do the bedrooms this afternoon.’

I picked up my plate, my bowl, heading for the dishwasher, but Elsie took them from me. ‘It’s okay, sir, you can leave all this.’

I nodded. She looked like she knew what she was doing. She didn’t need me around. I said something about letting me know if there was anything they needed, and then sauntered off, back upstairs. I felt a little at a loss, with Dana sleeping. What was I supposed to be doing? Resting. It seemed like a waste of time, though.

I found myself gravitating toward my office. Once sealed inside, I fired up my computer.

On the desktop, there were various folders with names I did not recognize, containing files full of information on companies and products—and even people—of which I knew absolutely nothing. I found investment strategies, analysis reports, and plenty of financial figures. Some of the intelligence seemed like stuff I should have known about—but didn’t. I knew my way around a business plan, I knew my way around a results statement, I knew my way around an investment strategy, but none of the details were familiar to me here, and I knew none of the context for any of these enterprises.

Flicking around, I tried to get a sense of what I was doing before my illness had hit—but I didn't know where to start. I got the feeling that the key to unlocking all this information had been a central plan in my head—but that had all disappeared.

This was like someone had printed out the complete works of Shakespeare on loose pages without page numbers, and then completely mixed them up. I didn't know enough about the plays of Shakespeare to be able to make sense of anything.

I didn't get any brainwaves while I skimmed some of the reports on my desktop, I didn't get any of those flashbacks. I spent an hour, maybe two, looking around at things until I felt tired. I sat back in my chair and it dawned on me that I didn't actually care about any of this stuff. Perusing all these reports, I realized that I'd been more hopeful of remembering something about myself, and the memories I'd lost, than actually learning about any of these companies, or the developments in the markets.

I just didn't care about the work I'd been in before my illness.

'Hey,' I looked up at the sound of Dana's voice. She was leaning against the doorway, and I couldn't help but catch my breath at the tight, pink crop top and the short, black lycra running shorts she was wearing.

'Hey, how you doing?' I asked her. 'You have another CrossFit class?'

She smiled, and slowly walked toward me. 'I missed it,' she said.

'Ah well.'

'My instructor was pissed,' she laughed. 'Said I'm going to completely lose my figure...'

'Ridiculous.'

She rested her behind on the edge of my desk, sidling herself in between me and my computer so that my attention was completely on her. I didn't need to conceal the fact that I was ogling her, taking in the breathtaking sight of her in those workout clothes.

‘I promised I’d go for a run with him,’ she said, and I got the feeling she was teasing me. Testing me. Trying to make me jealous.

‘Right now?’ I asked, feeling an intense heat inside my chest at the thought of her going out to meet her CrossFit guy—her lover. Seeing him in person.

She leaned over me, enjoying my attention, enjoying giving me an eyeful of her cleavage as she stooped to plant a little kiss on my mouth.

She said, ‘I have to meet him at the park in half an hour.’

Stroking my cheek as she kissed me, as she slipped me a little tongue.

‘How long does it take to walk to the park?’ I asked her, as though warning her she’d be late.

‘Not half an hour,’ she grinned. I ran my hands over her trim figure as we kissed, and her hands moved to my lap, where she found the telltale bulge proving her effect on me.

Was she horny, thinking about meeting up with her lover? She smelled so good—she hadn’t put on a lot of makeup, but she’d been liberal with her date perfume. She was looking to attract male attention. I reached between her legs, stroked her thighs, and brushed the back of my hand up against her sex.

‘The housekeeper and her husband are here,’ I warned her.

She smiled. ‘Then I’ll have to remain out of sight, just in case they come in. Yeah?’

She slipped down to her knees, unzipped my jeans, and fished my erection out. I glanced at the open door. Somewhere on the floors below, I heard a vacuum running. It didn’t help ease my nerves, but I wasn’t getting soft, either.

I looked down just in time to see Dana take me into her mouth, those large, dark eyes staring up at me with so much promise. It made me think about the video I’d witnessed on Jackson’s phone, which in turn reminded me that she was going to meet up with Jackson.

I didn't last long. As soon as Dana took me into her throat and started gagging on me, I lost control. I grabbed the arms of my chair and bucked forward. Dana adjusted, knowing what came next. Unlike in the video, she didn't ask me where I wanted it. She just kept those eyes locked on mine and swallowed it all. I shuddered. She was in control, not me. Not like with Jackson.

Popping up, she said, 'Well that was efficient. I'm going to go brush my teeth and head out.' She glanced at the monitor, where she saw my work. She furrowed her brow. 'You're not supposed to be working—remember?'

'I know... I was just trying to jog the memory a little.'

She raised an eyebrow. 'I might have to punish you if I catch you working again.'

'Promises, promises,' I flashed her a sheepish grin.

She laughed. 'Any more memories coming back?'

'None.'

'Well, when you are ready, maybe we can call some of the partners to try and get you caught up to speed?'

That didn't sound appealing *at all*. 'Probably not a bad idea.'

'I'll be back in an hour or two.'

'Wow. Long run.'

'All depends on how hard Jackson pushes me.'

Now that *had* to be a loaded statement. She didn't give me a chance to dwell, though. She turned and was off again, her long, high ponytail bouncing.

I FELT MORE nervous about her leaving the house to meet up with Jackson than I had when she'd gone out at night to meet her old friend Leo. I knew for a fact something was going on with Jackson.

And yet, while I worried about her feeling something for Jackson, a man who could give her the alpha male attention she craved, after she'd gone, I still found myself hoping something would happen while she was out with him.

I wanted her to cheat.

It was a confusing conflict of feelings.

I sat there at my desk a while, looking at more of the financials—more wondering if I'd ever get back to finding this stuff interesting. For now, none of it seemed even slightly intriguing. I thought only of Dana going out in public wearing next to nothing, her running clothes covering not much more than a swimsuit would. I thought about how Jackson Ross would see her—presumably, wearing that kind of outfit, he'd assume she wanted more than just a running companion.

Would Dana break lockdown rules to get a fix of his huge cock?

Now the lockdown is beginning to ease...

I remembered Elsie's words when we'd been standing at the front door. Lockdown was beginning to ease. Dana would probably argue that if she'd been self-isolating, and Jackson Ross had been self-isolating, and both of them had tested negative for the virus, then what would be the harm in a little contact, if lockdown rules were beginning to ease?

I clicked on various folders on the desktop of my computer. Trying to find anything—anything at all—that might divert my attention from the imminent meeting of Dana and her lover. I wasn't interested in financial reports, though. I was looking for memories. There wasn't anything obvious here.

Didn't I have any photos? Anything personal at all?

I suppose this was a computer I used for work. Like the phone I'd found, there was nothing personal on here.

Maybe I hadn't been the type to keep personal things like photos to record the family side of my life.

In the top right hand corner of the computer display was a magnifying glass symbol. I clicked on it, and a search box came up. Well, this had to be quicker than perusing the hundreds of folders on my machine. I typed in the word ‘photos’. Plenty of results came back—folders, images, videos.

I caught my breath as I saw some of the file names of the videos uncovered in my little search.

Cheating wife gets busted while fucking with her friend

Watching Wife Getting Fucked By A Friend

Cheating wife on hidden camera

First Time Watching Wife Get Big Dick

Cuckold watching wife fuck other men

There were a ton of these. I felt my heart burn and my manhood thicken up—thickening up even though I’d only just come—just seeing these suggestive words.

Had I been into this whole cheating wife thing before the coronavirus? Had I wanted Dana to cheat on me even prior to the massive changes my coma had inflicted?

I double-clicked on one of the videos. A window popped up on screen showing a man apparently standing outside some kind of apartment gazing at its floor-to-ceiling windows like a peeping tom. Inside the apartment, an attractive brunette approached the windows, staring out at the man. She put a hand on the glass, and now another, suited man approached from behind her. As the man stepped up to her, she slowly pulled up her skirt, exposing the tops of her stockings, her panties and her garter belt. She kissed the man—all while the other guy, outside the apartment, was watching. He had to be the husband, judging by the title of the video.

I sat up in my chair as the woman in the video knelt down in front of the suited man, pulled out his cock, and started sucking it while her husband watched.

Had this been my fantasy before my personality had changed?

Here, the suited man was fucking the brunette up against the glass—while her husband watched from outside. She was standing up, her lover entering her from behind, so she could maintain eye contact with her husband while the other man fucked her.

I couldn't help but notice the woman in the video—the actress, performer, porn star—looked like Dana. Enough like her to be uncanny. I clicked on a few of the other videos—they all featured attractive brunettes with the same kind of figure, same kind of feline good looks, as Dana.

It wasn't a coincidence, I was certain. Before my coma, I had fantasized about my wife cheating on me. And from what Russell had told me, I knew that I'd at least suspected that she had, in fact, been cheating on me. But which came first—her cheating, or my fantasy about her cheating? And why, if I fantasized about her, had I not tried to rekindle our sex life before my coma?

Maybe Dana and I had been too set in our ways. But then my coma came along and made me forget all about our relationship, and how it had developed.

And now I was back here, staring at a video clip of a man watching his wife being fucked by another man.

And Dana was out spending the next two hours with another man, a man I knew she'd had an affair with in the past.

I stood up. I suddenly felt certain I didn't want to just sit by while she enjoyed other men, and wait for her to return to me. I knew she was supposed to be meeting Jackson Ross at the park—and from what she'd said, it was a park fairly close by.

I went downstairs. I was all set to walk straight out the front door to go stalk my wife, when I saw Elsie through the kitchen doorway, mopping the floor.

'Uh... Elsie?'

She looked up from her mopping. 'Something I can do for you, sir?'

I thought about my black Mercedes roadster—one of the few things I do remember buying. ‘Do I... do you know if I happen to have a car?’

The housekeeper looked stumped for a moment. ‘Your collection is out at the house in Napa, sir...’

‘My collection?’ I was intrigued. But even if I had the best cars in the world out in Napa, that was no good to me now. ‘Don’t I have anything available here?’

‘You have Tom, sir...’

I remembered the limo that had collected me from the hospital. But I didn’t want a driver to take me over to the park to see if I could spy on my wife.

But then, after a brief pause, I could see it dawning on Elsie’s face that I might not be using a chauffeur-driven vehicle during the lockdown. She said, ‘Uh... but there is a car parked out on Scott Street, sir. For Mrs Sullivan—she likes to run her own errands.’

‘Oh, right?’

Elsie smiled. ‘You used to have Jack take it in for servicing once a year, and give it a run through the car wash down past the Target.’

‘Great,’ I nodded.

‘The key is hung up inside the panel by the front door, sir.’

I nodded, and thanked her as I scampered over to the front door, thinking about Mrs Sullivan liking to run her own errands—which no doubt included little secret visits to her personal trainer, and whichever other men she’d enjoyed over the years of our marriage.

To my disappointment, there were no keys hanging up anywhere near the front door. But then Elsie emerged from the kitchen, smiling at realizing I probably had no idea how to get the keys in question—she pushed on one of the oak-paneled walls and to my mild surprise a small part of it opened to reveal a little secret recess in which row upon row of little hooks held keys of various shapes and sizes.

‘Thank you,’ I smiled as she departed back to the kitchen.

I squinted at all the keys, and found the one that looked like a set of car keys. Here it was—a fairly simple Honda logo. I grabbed it, and only while I was on my way out the front door, striding around the corner to Scott Street, did I wonder why we’d have a Honda when we were wealthy enough to afford a multi-million dollar mansion in the middle of San Francisco.

When I pressed the central locking button, and the most nondescript little black sedan flashed its blinkers at me, I had my answer—if someone wanted to pursue an affair, this was the most subtle runaround you could ever want. Nobody was going to pay any attention to someone driving something like this.

As I sat in the car, and fired it up, I was actually thankful that it wasn’t my Mercedes. Even Dana, who obviously used this car from time to time, would be unlikely to spot me if I was lurking by the park looking for her.

Driving, like using a phone or a computer, came back to me easily. I pulled out on Scott Street, heading uphill to begin my search for a park. As it happened, just a block away, at the top of the hill, I found a park.

My heart was thumping hard in my chest as I slowly circled the park, trying to glance across the street at the open green area while at the same time navigating the road. Thankfully, no doubt because of the lockdown, the traffic was light.

And here, on the south side of the park, I found a large stone stairway leading up to the top of the hill—and in the middle of it working out on the steps—was Dana, with the recognizable form of Jackson Ross standing in the middle of the stairway, urging her on.

They were quite clearly in the middle of an innocent workout.

I parked up in a location where I could easily monitor their progress. And I hoped they weren’t planning on spending the full two hours simply working out.

RUN, RABBIT, RUN

I watched them as Dana did a full workout on the steps, and it was a proper workout—alpha stud Jackson Ross barking orders at her, Dana pumping her legs and her arms and working up a real sweat powering up and down those steps.

The two of them went for a run around the park, and because the park was practically a hill in its own right, their run seemed mostly to be uphill. I did my best to follow them in the car, trying to keep behind them so they didn't notice me, while attempting to avoid the few other cars on the road at the time from thinking I was an idiot and honking their horns at me. A few times I had to drive quickly past, circle the block and then come back to find them again.

It was quietly exciting, though. Watching them together. Stalking them like some kind of seedy private eye.

And to start with, there didn't seem anything particularly wrong going on—but I had the knowledge that Dana had slept with this guy, Dana had had some kind of affair with him. Why would she keep seeing him if nothing was going on?

As I persisted in watching them—getting a lot of practice at parallel parking in the process, I might add—I was given some rewards. It started with some smiles between them, a little flirtatious laughter. After the run, I

found a great spot for the car as Jackson took Dana through some stretches—and helped her get into the right position each time by laying his hands all over her.

I watched him holding her hips, trailing his hands down her legs, even straddling her as she lay on the ground, so he could pull on her arms and get her stretching her stomach muscles by raising her shoulders. He had her bending and stretching in some very gymnastic poses, stretching her legs where they were very nearly doing a classic missionary position—and I had to wonder if the man's cock was at least a little hard, as his crotch brushed against her.

Out in public, it looked very innocent unless you were watching closely. Just a woman with her personal trainer—except that some of the touches were subtly intimate, and the glances between them came with flames in their eyes.

And at all times, Jackson's eyes were all over Dana's trim body, taking in every inch of her toned frame—her gorgeous breasts confined by a tight sports bra, her exquisite ass in her shorts, so tight that they nearly offered a camel toe between her legs. Dana seemed to be enjoying the sight of Jackson in his own tight shorts, his t-shirt offering plenty of bulging muscles on view—she might have been the client doing the workout, but he still managed to flex and pump his biceps, his powerful thighs, and offer her a real gun show.

After an hour's workout, I was hard as a rock watching them. And then they walked away from the park.

I caught my breath, and attempted to follow—again, making it subtle, keeping behind them. I'd gotten better at this stalking stuff, making it seem like I was looking for a decent parking spot by the side of the road, but each time I tried to pull into one, I made it seem just too small, ending up crawling up the road a little further to try a different space.

There was one time where I had to drive past the two of them as they headed down the hill, and circle back to find them again—and I was deathly afraid I'd lose them. But I did manage to track them down. My heart was pounding—my whole body felt feverish. They were walking in the wrong direction to get Dana home again. I wondered if they were heading for some kind of cafe or restaurant—except that cafes and restaurants were closed for the lockdown, weren't they?

Perhaps Jackson lived this way.

The houses were smaller down here. Still a nice neighborhood, though. No traffic, so I had the perfect opportunity to park, wait for them to move on a little further down the street, and then catch up with them again to monitor their progress. I was glad I'd got myself some wheels—there was no way I'd be able to keep up with them on foot.

And then I lost them.

That gave me a jolt of fear—and yet, after a moment or two, I told myself it was no big deal. So maybe I would lose them. I knew they were together. I'd had the thrill of watching them together during the workout, and now I could imagine they'd gone inside one of these houses and were going to do more of a private workout, restarting their affair.

The fear didn't entirely dissipate—I felt the worry that Dana had experienced what I had to offer in the bedroom, and was now choosing to sleep with Jackson Ross, and that made me worry that if I truly wasn't good enough for her, she could one day decide to leave me. And financially, she'd no doubt walk away with a decent settlement. I just had to tell myself that every time I was with her, we were good together. She loved me, and I loved her—and that was clear.

She was only with Jackson Ross for the sex. For the chance to get fucked, hard, by an alpha male.

I parked, and got out of the car, and walked back a little way, to see if there was any alternative to the theory that they must have gone inside one

of these houses. Midway down the block where they'd disappeared, however, I found a little alleyway between some of the houses. They could have gone down there.

I glanced up and down the street to make sure I was unseen. Then, I ventured down the alleyway.

I could hear my heartbeat as I went, moving like I was in slow motion, keeping my eye out for potential hiding places in case Dana and Jackson suddenly double-backed. As I eyed a dumpster that I could hide behind, I heard something. Whispering.

I slowed to almost a stop, creeping along from dumpster to drainpipe to the corner of an outhouse, vigilant to the slightest noise, the tiniest hint that they were coming back, or they'd heard me behind them and were now looking for me. The whispering grew in volume, and it was undoubtedly two people, a man and a woman. As I drew near, I recognized Dana as the woman.

And then I saw them.

They'd found a shady spot under the overhanging branches of a large apple tree poking out of one of the small gardens behind the fence. The tree meant it wasn't overlooked by any of the surrounding houses, and if anyone happened to be walking through this alleyway, there seemed to be plenty of cover around to help them hide.

They were kissing already, Dana had an arm curled around her CrossFit trainer's head. He had a hand on her bare midriff, no doubt enjoying how toned she was. And—

I caught my breath as my eyes fell lower.

Jackson Ross was naked from the waist down, his shorts and underwear bunched around his ankles. I could see his shaved nether regions, his huge cock jutting straight out, and Dana's other hand gripping the shaft as she kissed him.

Intense heat flared through me. Dana was cheating on me.

I watched them kissing, passionately, hungrily. Jackson moved his hands up to fondle Dana's breasts through her tight pink crop top, but he wasn't putting much effort into it—he seemed taken aback by the feeling of Dana pumping his cock in her hand. Had he been a good boy during the lockdown? Following all the rules? Leading a life of chastity?

He was breaking the rules now, though lockdown may have eased slightly recently. But it seemed that Dana was the first woman to actually touch his cock for many weeks. And he didn't seem like the kind of guy who'd be used to that kind of hiatus.

I heard him say something—almost a growl—and then Dana dropped to her knees.

I caught my breath again. She squeezed his shaft tighter still, and her other hand—complete with wedding ring on her finger—gripped Jackson's thigh. And then the tip of his cock was touching her lips. The end of his cock was slipping into her mouth. Her lips were stretching around his mighty girth.

I was so hard.

I could hardly believe what I was seeing. It was like some kind of weird out-of-body experience, because only an hour or two previously, she'd been doing this exact thing to me. She hadn't had to stretch her mouth quite so much to suck on my cock, sure, but for a moment, my stunned mind felt like it was me I was watching her with.

And then it so obviously wasn't me.

The size of his cock.

The manscaped crotch.

It started to sink in that I was watching my wife sucking on another man's huge cock. She was moaning, pumping his shaft as she sucked on its tip, bracing herself for him to start taking control, to start fucking her face. He reached down, yanked up her top, exposed her bare breasts, her nipples impossibly stiff.

It was her, doing what she'd done for me, but somehow she did it differently with him. It was harder, rougher, less affectionate. More like a pornographic performance than making love to him with her mouth.

Dana. Cheating on me.

I couldn't stop myself. Right there in the alleyway, I pulled out my cock as I watched Jackson urging Dana back up onto her feet. I grabbed hold of my stiff shaft as I saw Jackson shove Dana up against the fence, so that she was facing away from him. I started pumping my full length as I watched him fondle her tight ass through her lycra shorts, push his hand between her thighs to feel how wet she was already.

I tried not to come early as I watched him yank down her tight shorts, exposing her beautiful rear with only a thin, pink thong to cover it—and then as Dana took hold of the fence with both hands, I saw Jackson tug her underwear aside and slide his hard dick straight into her.

This man I had no memory of was thrusting his big dick inside my beautiful Dana's exquisite pussy.

Dana was properly cheating on me.

As I watched him fucking her, I was just stunned. But I started to understand why she might need a man like Jackson Ross, even though the two of us were rekindling the passion in our marriage wonderfully. Firstly, his cock was huge. I had no need to feel humiliated by it—it wasn't normal. The kind of thing that if a woman tried it, you could believe she'd never feel completely satisfied by another man's cock ever again. How did she even accommodate it?

But accommodate it she did. And while she was obviously trying to keep as silent as possible while he fucked her, so that nobody called the cops, the expression on her face as that huge thing penetrated her seemed almost like some kind of trauma.

She panted like a runner at the end of a marathon as he thrust into her again and again. The sweat was flowing down her flushed skin. She held

onto that fence for dear life as he started to pound her so roughly it was like corporal punishment.

He was like some kind of machine.

I didn't feel jealous at all.

It was just sex. It was just fucking. It was hot, but it wasn't romance.

It was just a workout.

Jackson reached around, covering her mouth to keep her quiet. The fence shuddered with her body. She was coming, her entire body rippling with the intense rush of her adultery. I held my breath, waiting for Jackson to finish with her.

Instead, he yanked out of her. Dana seemed to know what to do next, too, moving like they were choreographed. She spun around and knelt down, taking his cock in her mouth as he jerked it.

When her hand strayed between her legs, though, Jackson grabbed her by the ponytail and shook his head. 'No more coming until I come.'

I'd see this before, only from a different angle—from Jackson's. Video was one thing. Seeing Dana there, on her knees, grasping another man's hips as he fucked her face, was totally different. I was simultaneously on the verge of emptying my balls, and jumping in and protecting her. If she wasn't into this, I'd be in there in a flash.

But she was. She was so very much into the dominance.

He didn't warn her. He didn't give her the courtesy. He just thrust forward, held her there, and arched back like he was about to howl. I knew he was coming, filling Dana's mouth with his seed. I could see it in the way she tensed, the way her throat muscles rippled as she swallowed, the way her nostrils flared out breath.

Incredibly, that wasn't the end. She didn't release his cock. She didn't even slow much in the blowjob. They'd done this, too. She knew the drill.

When she released his cock, he was only semi-soft, glistening with spit and come. She took over stroking him as she lowered her mouth to his

balls... then even lower.

‘That’s a dirty girl,’ he said, hands on hips like the super man that he was. She slipped her left hand up his thighs and into the space behind his balls. ‘Use all your *tricks!*’

Was she fingering his asshole? Was she licking it? Whatever she did, he was hard again, and she returned to sucking him off.

‘This was worth the wait,’ he groaned. ‘The egg was fun...’ He raked his fingers through her hair. ‘Ordering you to shave for me on the webcam was hot. But nothing beats the real thing.’ He pulled back, his full length hard and impressive. ‘Am I right?’

Dana’s laugh of delight carried so much that she covered her mouth and looked around to see if they’d been discovered. I ducked again, nearly getting caught. Again! I should leave, but there was no way.

When I peeked again, they were back at it. This time, Jackson had her pressed back against the fence. They were kissing again, hard and deep, intermixed with little snippets that I couldn’t hear. Jackson seemed to do most of the talking, with Dana nodding at it all. She looked pained and desperate.

And then he was lifting her, his broad shoulders flexing as he held her against the fence. She wrapped her legs around his back as he thrust forward, filling her once again.

We had done it standing up in the shower. I’d even taken her against the shower wall. But this was the next level. Jackson manhandled her with a power bred from hours upon hours of toning and working out. The physicality was unmatched. This man could fuck, and Dana loved it.

She raked her fingers along his back. She held the thick column of his neck as he lifted her, bounced her, drove into her. She worked her into a continuous, frothing orgasm. They were no longer being discreet. They were no longer being quiet. She was on fire, and Jackson was her gasoline.

‘Tell me what you want,’ Jackson barked.

‘Your come... sir.’

‘Beg.’

‘Give me your come, sir. Please... please, I need it. I’ve missed it...’

I was right there on the edge. I wanted her to feel that, too. I wanted her to get from Jackson that which I could not offer. I begged in my mind.

Jackson obliged. Squeezing her buttocks hard, he drove forward one last time. All of his hard muscle flexed—his shoulders, his buttocks, his powerful arms. Dana shook in his grasp, her head back, her hair cascading around her as he pumped his come into her cheating pussy.

It was her face, though, that I couldn’t look away from. It was her expression that I wanted to remember for the rest of my days—pure, real, unadulterated satisfaction. It was someone who’d had an itch they could not reach for days on end suddenly scratched perfectly.

I nearly got lulled into that expression of hers.

I nearly forgot to hide, to get out of there, to escape before they came out. I watched until Jackson was done filling her. I watched as he let her down to her shaky legs and kissed her. I watched as they exchanged quiet words and small laughs.

Dana glanced around again, towards me. My heart squeezed. I ducked away, pulling my cock back into my pants. Had she seen? Was I caught? When I peered out, the two of them were standing there, straightening up their clothing. Dana was pulling her wet hair back, tying it up in a long ponytail.

I took a relieved breath—neither of them were looking my way. They both looked relaxed, confident, not at all threatened. I was certain she hadn’t seen me.

But now, I had to flee. I had to get to the car, and get home, and make myself look all innocent before Dana could run—or walk—home herself.

I had to calm down and prepare myself to try not to look as though I’d just been through one of the most erotic experiences of my life. I had to

work out how I was going to behave around her now that I had witnessed, firsthand, my gorgeous wife cheating on me, and being so unbelievably sexy while she'd done it.

PROVING HIS WORTH

I was in my office when I heard her return. Thanks to the car, I'd had plenty of time to get back home, to calm down, to settle. I couldn't quite get my head around the reality of having an unfaithful wife, however. The reality that I had seen with my own eyes.

I heard the front door open and close, and my heart started beating a little more quickly. Then I heard her in the hallway outside my office—so close I could hear her steps, her heavy breathing.

'Hey Elsie,' I heard her speak, addressing our housekeeper. 'How are you?'

'Oh, very well, thank you, Dana. You had a nice run?'

I suddenly felt my stomach contract, as fear set in—what if Elsie revealed to Dana that I'd gone out in the car during her run? What would she suppose I'd been doing?

'Very pleasant, thank you. It's good to get outside the house, even if it's only for a couple of hours.'

'Jack and I are always very pleased to be able to get out of the house. Do you want me to do the upper floors today?'

'Uh... no, I think it might be best if you keep to the lower floors,' Dana said. 'I'm going to take a shower and then I need to help Mr Sullivan with his physical therapy...'

‘Of course, my dear. I can get the upper floors done the next time we come.’

‘Thank you so much.’

I only realized I’d been holding my breath when I heard Dana heading upstairs to the next floor, and Elsie began vacuuming the hallway. Then I let it out, as relief flooded my system. I felt thankful that Elsie hadn’t mentioned my little motoring excursion. I felt certain Dana would have at least suspected I’d been keeping tabs on her.

She probably would have felt quite angry at the thought I’d followed her. Would she imagine I might, possibly, have seen her spending time with Jackson Ross?

I breathed. The worst that could happen was that everything would come out into the open. She’d know I knew. She’d soon know I wasn’t against her infidelity. What would she think of that? Would she think me pathetic? Would she feel like giving up on me? Like running to the strong alpha male she knew would satisfy her every sexual desire—Jackson Ross.

The thing was, I liked the strange dark intrigue that surrounded her cheating. I understood her reasons why. For me, the excitement that went with it overwhelmed the sense of betrayal. My heightened desire for her, because of her infidelity, counterbalanced the feeling that she was being cruel by two-timing me. And her warm affection and sexual interest when we were together seemed to suppress most of the fear that I could lose her to another man.

I didn’t follow immediately, worried that if I suddenly went to find her the minute she’d got back from her run, she might think I was suspicious. I stewed as long as I could, the scene of Jackson fucking his come into her pushing me right up to the very edge. At last, the craving in me for the wife I’d just seen cheating on me got to be too much.

I left the confines of my office, heading past Elsie, who was so busy vacuuming she didn’t even see me pass. Then I was gliding upstairs,

hopeful that my gorgeous wife would not be too tired for a little affection.

It was odd but I found myself disappointed that she was already in the shower, already washing away the evidence of her adultery. ‘There you are,’ I said as I entered the steam filled bathroom.

‘Hey,’ she said, turning towards. She still hadn’t grabbed the loofah yet. She was still just getting her body wet.

I moved automatically, stripping as I went, trying to keep calm. ‘Looking good,’ I grinned, my eyes traveling along her body. Was that glistening between her thighs Jackson’s come? Or just the water washing him away. ‘Nice run?’

‘Uh... yeah...’ she said. She half turned away, concern flashing across her face as I approached. She did a good job hiding that, though, looking calm, innocent. ‘I’m all sweaty now, though...’

I wasn’t about to give her the opportunity to escape without making herself seem suspicious.

‘That’s always a good sign after a run,’ I joked, stepping into the shower and pulling her into my arms from behind. and put my arms around her from behind, leaning into the crook of her neck to kiss her shoulder. I breathed her in—even through the water, I could smell her perspiration, and her skin had a clear saltiness to it. But it was much more than just sweat.

I could detect her arousal.

I could smell sex on her.

I could even catch the subtle scent of her lover on her.

‘Let me just... finish up here,’ she said as my hands cupped her breasts. Her nipples were definitely hard. Kissing her neck, I could still taste that sharp saltiness on her skin.

I squeezed her tight in my arms, as though claiming her. I felt a strong desire to have her—to consume her—before she could wash away the evidence of her betrayal. It wasn’t brought on by a need to catch her. It was something deeper, more primal.

She moaned as I kissed her behind the ear and slid a hand between her legs. My cock was so hard as I took in her incredible body, the dampness of her skin, and the fact that another man had been enjoying this woman just minutes earlier.

‘You’re so wet,’ I whispered.

I squeezed her stunning tits and played with her pussy as the water washed away the lingering evidence of Dana’s infidelity.

‘Running... makes me... feel good...’ she said, panting.

I thrust two fingers into her slick pussy, only too aware that minutes before, there had been a huge cock here, squeezed inside her. That most of her wetness was Jackson’s only made me grow harder. I said, ‘It makes you feel this good?’

‘Maybe I was thinking about the horny husband I had waiting for me,’ she smiled. ‘Maybe I imagined my sweet hubby jumping me as soon as I got back home.’

‘Is that what you were thinking?’ I sucked gently on her earlobe, and pulled her against me using the fingers buried inside her drenched pussy, so that my hard cock pressed against her behind.

‘Uh-huh,’ she said, moaning as I fucked her with my fingers. ‘Maybe I was thinking how you’d be so horny, you couldn’t even wait for me to shower before taking me.’

‘I guess you were feeling fairly prescient on your run,’ I grinned.

‘Okay,’ she said as I stepped in front of her, ‘I’ll admit I thought you’d probably want me either in the shower or after a shower...’

‘I can’t wait until then,’ I said, kissing her mouth and down her chest. I nibbled on her breasts and took her nipples in my mouth, feeling her body language softened. How far would she let me go before she got nervous?

‘You’re so horny, all the time, since you came out of hospital,’ she giggled.

‘I woke up to the fact I have such a gorgeous wife,’ I said.

When I went to crouch—when I could practically smell the bleachy scent of another man’s come—she stopped me. At last. ‘No,’ she said. Reaching between us, she grasped me cock. ‘I don’t need that right now. I need something *hard*.’

I need a Man, my brain translated. My cock surged.

I pressed her against the tiled wall of the shower, just as Jackson had pressed her against the fence. I wasn’t so strong that I could lift her completely off the floor, but just helped, setting her left leg on the soap tray as I pushed into her juicy slit.

She *felt* different than the last time we’d had sex. She was slipperier. She was looser. She was already well-fucked.

‘Oh, God...’ I groaned, nearly losing it. I couldn’t stop the comparisons. I couldn’t stop my thrusting. This was how he did it, and inevitably, she’d be comparing him with me, too. I felt so inadequate, and yet incredibly, that only spurred me on. To try harder. To fuck harder. To love her harder.

‘Oh, honey,’ she sighed. Her fingers curled along the back of my head, tugged at my damp hair. ‘You feel so good. Soo... good...’

‘I love you, baby,’ I cried, on the brink.

She gasped, nodding, practically climbing up the tiled wall as we fucked. I thought of what I’d heard Sarah say about us. *I know, he makes you come with his mouth... But he doesn’t make you come with his dick...*

Was she faking this now?

Her fist clenched, fingers tightening in my hair as I felt her pussy squeeze around my cock. No, no it didn’t seem like this was faked at all. Her fingers dug into my shoulder blades as she tossed her head back and cried out.

I was there again, watching her in the alley, watching her cheat on me. I could picture so vividly the way she’d been in that alleyway, bent over, taking her trainer’s cock from behind. Why was it such a thrill?

‘Oh God... harder, Damien. Fuck me... harder!’ she cried behind eyes shut tight. Was it me she envisioned? Was it Jackson?

She started to come before I could decide on an answer, and I was right there with her, my cock pulsing deep inside of her. I filled her, just as another man had, our come intermingling, giving my wife the feel of two men in less than an hour.

It felt so good.

I might not have the huge cock, I might not have the alpha temperament, but I still made her come, and come forcefully, her whole body pulsing and jerking as she did so, her pussy trembling and quivering as I pressed her to the wall and emptied all of my pent-up libido there.

Afterwards, in the come down, when the spray of the shower cleaned us up and we’d crawled from the shower and beneath the sheets of the California King, amidst all the doubts that I still had, I knew one thing for certain—Dana still loved me. More than that, she craved me. She needed me. I may not have been the guy with the monster cock, but I was Damien, her love, her constant.

In bed, she crawled over me, straddling me and taking my once-again stiff cock into her. And once again, it struck me how different we were together compared to how she was with Jackson Ross. It was slow, gentle, sensual, completely unhurried. We kissed, we touched, we stroked each other while she rode me.

Everything had been a learning process for me, but as we bathed in the glow of our love making that afternoon, I got the impression that she was learning a few things herself, too, and how it could be with her changed husband.

CONFIDANTE

The next morning, I was the one who slept late. I guess I was fairly tired after a day as a stalker and a voyeur, even before I'd reclaimed my gorgeous wife.

By the time I hauled myself out of bed, pulled on some clothes and headed downstairs for a bite to eat, I could hear that Dana was already well into her normal morning CrossFit class. I couldn't resist the temptation to slip down there, into the basement, to see what was happening. My elevated pulse and morning wood suggested I was hoping she was having a special one-on-one class with the instructor, but when I ventured close enough to catch sight of Dana working out, I could see clearly that it was just a regular class—Jackson was on screen leading the exercises, but so were a load of other women exercising along with Dana.

It was still enjoyable to watch my wife working out, though. She was wearing tiny black shorts and a black sports bra, and looked just divine working up a sweat.

I smiled at myself for being such a pervert.

Then my phone buzzed, startling me out of my daze, and threatening to expose me to Dana as a peeping tom. I managed to flee the scene as I grabbed for my phone. It was Russell calling.

On my way upstairs, I thought about how annoyed I'd been at Russell for keeping secrets from me, particularly about my wife. But after a day in which I'd watched another man roughly fucking my wife in an alleyway, I felt differently now, more at ease with what Russell had done. How could he know how I'd feel about finding out about his involvement with Dana, after I'd become so different following my coma?

'Hey, buddy,' I said, heading into the kitchen for some breakfast.

'Hey, man? How're things? Haven't heard from you for a while... I just thought I'd see how you're doing.'

'Oh, I'm doing okay,' I said, feeling my attitude toward my friend softening further—I liked that he was checking in on how I was doing. It made me feel less isolated, more connected somehow. I added, 'I think I'm beginning to figure out a little more about myself.'

'Oh, right?'

'Hey, look, why don't you come over... we can have a drink or two, and really catch up,' I said. I felt the need to see Russell, face-to-face. As good as things were going with my wife, I needed a friend. I needed perspective.

'Hey, that would be great,' he said, and sounded genuinely cheerful at the idea.

'I'm sure it's okay... Dana had a friend over the other day, and managed the whole social distancing thing.'

'I promise I won't get too close to you, my friend,' Russell joked.

I NOTICED that Dana's CrossFit music had faded while I was partaking of a leisurely breakfast, but I resisted the temptation to head down there and attempt to join her shower. I felt the need to give her some space—she'd already commented on how horny I had been since returning from the

hospital. I didn't want her to get tired of my attention, I didn't want her to start thinking I was getting clingy.

So, I had a slow breakfast, and read the Chronicle via my smartphone, and generally chilled out.

Dana eventually emerged, freshly showered and changed into a very business-like white blouse and dark skirt. She looked faintly surprised that I hadn't come down to see her after her workout.

'Hey, how's it going?'

'Good, thanks. You sleep well?'

'Very well, actually,' I smiled. 'Hey, I invited Russell over for a drink or two later—I hope you don't mind.'

I caught an initial reaction from Dana, before she concealed it with a benevolent smile, which made me wonder if she didn't feel slightly awkward about Russell. Perhaps because she'd slept with him before my illness. But then she said, 'That's great—of course, you guys need to catch up.'

She turned away from me to get herself a glass of orange juice from the refrigerator, and then said, 'Actually, it might be good for you to have company—I have to go out to a few meetings later today, and I'm not sure how late I'll be.'

I found myself wondering if she was actively trying to avoid Russell by going out, or if one of her meetings might be with a certain Jackson Ross. Strange how hopeful I was that she would be doing something interesting, rather than merely engaging in business activities. At the same time, Dana was a successful businesswoman, so chances were she did have to go out for business.

'You can't just have meetings on a video call?' I asked her.

She laughed. 'I think people are getting tired of having to meet via Zoom,' she said. 'And when you're talking to investors about significant

sums of money... well, now lockdown rules have eased a little, they want to meet in person.'

I smiled, 'Well, I'm sure if it was me, I'd prefer to meet you in person, too.'

DANA HEADED out in the afternoon, looking gorgeous, though very professional at the same time, leaving me alone in the house with my hope that she was going to be naughty while she was away.

I took a cold shower and spent some more time at the desk in my office trying to get my head around more of the business intelligence on my computer. It still wasn't exactly holding my attention. I ended up sitting there trying to think if I needed some kind of career change.

When Russell turned up on my doorstep in the early evening, bearing a sizable bag stuffed full of Chinese food, the first thing I asked him took him rather by surprise.

'So, Russell. What the hell am I going to do with my life if I'm no longer even slightly interested in my work?'

Russell looked confused. 'You're not interested in your work?'

I stepped back to let him in, and said, 'Bear in mind that Dana's forbidden me from thinking about work for a couple of weeks, anyway, while I recover...'

'How much do you remember about your work?' he asked me, rather insightfully connecting my present state of mind to the changes brought on by my coma.

'I remember a lot about my time at Chifford, Shore & Paice... I remember selling NewsCast to Google...'

'Okay, so that was a while ago,' Russell said, as I led him into the kitchen to grab a bottle of wine to go with our Chinese food.

‘I had... I guess, what you’d call a flashback... of meeting Dana... you know, when I was going to invest in her business...’ That did bring up a curious inconsistency between my memory and what Dana had said. Maybe Russell could clear it up. ‘What do you know about that beginning time?’

‘I know some of it.’ Russell unpacked the Chinese food, distinctly not meeting my eyes. ‘What do you want to know?’

‘Why are you acting oddly?’

My friend sighed. ‘It’s all just... pretty scandalous is all.’

‘So we were sleeping together while working together?’ I ventured.

‘Yes, that’s part of it.’ He hesitated, then seemed to get over it. ‘You remember that she was seeing someone else at the time?’

I didn’t. ‘No. Was it serious?’ I asked, but I already knew.

‘Yeah. They were living together at the time.’

For a second, I felt that uneasy sense of vertigo, the way I used to feel when I first woke up. Like the world around me had shifted when I’d closed my eyes. Like I’d forgotten how to walk while I was running.

‘And I was okay with that?’ The man that I remembered prior to the coma wasn’t the type who’d cheat.

‘You weren’t. In fact, you were Mister Serial Monogamomist back then. But Dana was quite irresistible. She seduced you—’

‘At some gala?’ I guessed, recalling my memory.

‘Yeah, pretty sure that was your first time with her. It was even crazier since she came with her boyfriend.’

‘That seems crazy.’ We took the Chinese food out onto the patio, to eat in the safer open-air.

Russell picked up the story out there. ‘I can still remember those days. You were so enthralled by her. Kind of like now, to tell you the truth. The women you dated always kind of... this is going to sound bad, but they always seemed to be in it for your money. Dana was different.’

‘She was attached,’ I said.

‘That was probably part of it. You know I never trusted her. Not for a long time, even after she broke up with her guy and you two got married.’

‘I can’t blame you there.’

He looked thoughtful. ‘You once told me that it was almost like she enjoyed the cheating part. Like it was a game to her...’

‘A game that she continued after we got married.’

Russell shrugged noncommittally. We ate in silence, the chirping of insects filling the night air.

I broke the silence, asking the question I’d been wondering all along. ‘How long do you think she’s been cheating on me while we’ve been married?’

Russell looked at me for a moment, and I could tell he was trying to judge exactly how much I wanted to know about all this. Then he seemed to decide honesty was probably the best approach. ‘When you first came to me and said you wanted my help trying to figure out what was going on with Dana and that Jackson Ross guy... I got the impression you’d had suspicions about her and other guys in the past.’

‘Had I ever mentioned anything to you about other guys she knew?’

‘No, but considering your history... and then there was you, and how things became... I don’t know... like all business.’

‘Yeah, I get that impression.’

‘There was one time, I remember, when we were all at this party... and we were trying to talk to this guy from Facebook about some kind of app he was developing on the side... and Dana was being kind of friendly with some dude from Fresno...’

‘Friendly?’

‘Well, you know, it started all innocent, but she was getting quite flirty... and later on, I remember pointing them out to you—you know, warning you. You just waved it away.’

‘Oh. I did?’

Russell nodded. 'Like it wasn't important to you. You needed to know more about this Facebook guy and his app.'

'I was an idiot,' I said.

Russell shrugged. 'After that... I guess I didn't worry about it whenever I saw Dana flirting with other people. I think I assumed you trusted her, and that nothing would happen...'

'But maybe things did happen, and I didn't care?' I asked him.

He gave a cautious smile and a nod. 'I'd considered that, too. And when you came to ask me to look into this Jackson Ross guy, it was a bit of a surprise, but not exactly shocking...'

Had Dana always had a predilection for infidelity? Had it always been a game to her? Maybe she was hooked on it. For some reason, it didn't anger me—more like, it interested me. Maybe it wasn't just guys with big dicks that she craved—maybe it was infidelity itself.

'And when you... slept with her...?'

He sighed. 'I know, I shouldn't have... I mean, at the time... I trusted you completely, I guessed you'd finally had enough of her infidelity, that you wanted a simple divorce, you needed enough incontrovertible evidence...'

'But what if I told you I didn't want to divorce her?' I asked him. He looked baffled. I said, 'What would you say if I told you that before my illness... I'd come to the realization that I *liked* the fact that Dana was constantly being unfaithful...?'

Russell looked confused. 'I don't get it,' he said. 'You liked that she was cheating on you?'

I nodded. I was blushing, feeling the sense of shame I clearly felt I ought to have—but at the same time, I'd confided in Russell before, to the point where I'd pushed him to seduce my own wife, and if he was going to go on being my best friend, I felt the need to be truthful with him. God knew I needed a friend, right now. I needed to be open with him.

‘When I came out of my coma...’ I said, trying to find a way to explain myself where I wouldn’t come across as crazy. ‘...It was like meeting Dana for the first time...’

‘Of course,’ Russell nodded. ‘You lost all your memories.’

I nodded. ‘I lost my memories, I lost the details about what happened... but I don’t think I lost everything. I think, under the surface, I still feel the same way about things...’

‘You still love Dana.’

‘Yeah,’ I agreed. ‘But it’s not like I’ve only just fallen in love with her all over again. I know what falling in love with someone is like—you’re never quite sure, early on, if it’s really love you’re feeling, or if it’s lust. Eventually, you can tell, but to start with you suspect you love them, but... there’s a whole uncertainty at the same time.’

‘Right, yeah, I suppose so.’

‘When I found out I was married to Dana, there was no uncertainty. I’m in love with her, I know that. It’s not like starting over.’

‘Okay...’

‘So I start searching for clues to all the time I’ve lost, everything I’ve forgotten... and everything points to the fact that before my coma, I was a workaholic, and I’d been neglecting my marriage for years...’

‘Right, yeah..’

‘...and it seems that I had become aware, before my coma, that Dana had been cheating on me. And it probably wasn’t just the once.’

‘No...’

‘You got me evidence to confirm it,’ I nodded, ‘But I didn’t act on it, I didn’t kick Dana out of my house, I didn’t launch divorce proceedings...’

‘You said so yourself—you were a workaholic. Your marriage wasn’t your priority,’ Russell theorized.

I shook my head. ‘When I got back from the hospital,’ I said, ‘and I discovered that Dana had been unfaithful... it didn’t make me hate her. For

some reason it only made me want her more.'

Russell looked a little confused, but he said, 'It's perfectly natural—you've only just been re-introduced to this woman they've said is your wife, and she's gorgeous...' now it was Russell's turn to blush, and I felt a funny little twinge in my chest at the realization that he had slept with Dana himself—that he probably had residual lust for her. He flashed me an apologetic glance, as though it was inappropriate for him to judge Dana, particularly after sleeping with her himself. Then he went on. '...of course you want her, and if you discover she was cheating in the past... well, that was then, and this is now—'

'But you don't understand,' I stopped him. 'I didn't just want her because I was worried someone else would take her from me... it turned me on that she'd been unfaithful.'

Russell was stunned into silence by that one.

'Knowing that she'd been with someone else... I didn't have a problem with that, I was happy knowing she had. I found myself hoping she wasn't done being unfaithful.'

'I don't get it,' he said.

'I guess it's not the normal thing for a guy...' I said, a little sheepish.

'But you did have your wires all messed up by that coma,' Russell said, a wry grin spreading across his features.

I laughed. 'Yeah, that might explain it. Except... looking back at the evidence... I honestly think I was feeling this way about Dana before my coma.'

'When you asked me to look into it...' he said, and I could see in his eyes he was revisiting memories from an entirely different perspective. '... you weren't looking to end things with her...'

'No, I don't think I was.'

'And when you got me to... you know... sleep with her...'

‘I think it was because I liked the idea of her being unfaithful... I wanted her to be unfaithful...’

‘Wow, that’s twisted,’ Russell said, looking a little freaked out.

‘I’m sorry,’ I said. ‘I shouldn’t have gotten you so involved...’

‘I mean, I tried to persuade you it was a bad idea... I refused to do it at first, you know that? But you can be pretty insistent...’

‘Yeah, I have no doubt.’

There was a moment or two of silence, and I just let things sink in for Russell, so it didn’t seem too overwhelming. It felt cathartic to get this out there, though. If I didn’t feel like I could talk to Dana about it, yet, I needed some kind of outlet. Someone to confide in.

After a few minutes, Russell broke the ice, asking me, ‘So you think... Dana’s still cheating on you? I mean, you know, that she’s still seeing that guy...?’

I nodded, but did my best to appear calm. ‘I saw her with him. Yesterday, she went out for a run with him...’

‘Seriously?’

‘And I liked seeing her with him... the excitement in her face...’

‘Did anything happen... on their run?’ he asked me, looking like he could hardly believe we were talking about this, but at the same time coming to terms with the fact that I was obviously okay with my wife being unfaithful. More than okay.

‘Uh-huh,’ I said. ‘I... guess I followed them...’

‘You saw it happen?’

‘I did.’

Russell rubbed his chin. He suddenly smiled. ‘You know, we haven’t talked like this... about a girl... since college?’

That made me chuckle. I remembered talking to him about girls we dated. To me, memories of college were clearer than things that had happened much more recently.

‘From what I remember, we mostly talked about girls you dated,’ I pointed out.

He laughed. ‘You were a bit of a dork back then, you know that?’

‘I guess so.’

‘You knew absolutely nothing about women. I think... you might even have been a virgin in freshman year... until...’

‘Until you persuaded Margie Bailey to sleep with me,’ I said, remembering the lithe redhead, a girl who had been way out of my league, but who had smoked a lot of pot and had been amused by me to the point where she had agreed to Russell’s suggestion that she be my first.

‘You just needed a jump-start, I guess,’ he chuckled. ‘After that... you were more confident with women...’

‘But I seem to remember you passing other girls my way, once you were done with them,’ I nodded, wondering if the fact that, in many respects, I’d shared girlfriends with Russell back in college had in any way shaped my eventual desire to share Dana.

‘That was mostly whenever you had your damn heart broken when some girlfriend or other dumped you.’ Russell said, then grinned, ‘And here we were, years later, and you persuaded me to sleep with your wife.’

‘I guess I’m just not the possessive type,’ I said.

‘No,’ he nodded. ‘I seem to recall your response to women who dumped you tended to be to suggest they sleep with whoever it was they were dumping you for without actually ending your relationship.’

‘Would’ve made sense,’ I nodded.

‘I don’t know. Girls didn’t have open relationships in our college, they just moved on to the next guy.’

It felt good talking to Russell about all this. It felt good that he wasn’t reacting to my revelations as though I was a freak, as though he couldn’t understand me, as though he no longer wanted to be friends with me. I

guess it was like reverting to the kind of friendship we'd had back in college.

And time just flew by.

When I heard the front door open and close, and realized it had to be Dana coming home from her day of business meetings, it was past midnight.

Dana came outside, appearing in the French doors. She looked tired, but still very much dressed up in her business attire, seeming entirely professional, even this late at night. I actually felt disappointment at the sense that she probably hadn't ended up in bed with Jackson Ross, or some other male friend of hers after all.

'Hey, guys, you been having fun?' she asked us.

Then I saw a look pass between Russell and Dana, and it made my heart flutter. There was something there, still. Some residual chemistry that had not diminished even though things between them had ended after Russell had felt he had enough evidence for a decent divorce settlement for me.

'Uh... yeah, it's been great catching up,' Russell said after a moment, managing to conceal his initial reaction to seeing Dana in person again.

'We had a good evening,' I nodded, intrigued by how Dana was standing, leaning up against the doorway so that her chest was pushed out, her cleavage emphasized.

Russell made a show of looking at his watch, saying, 'It is getting late, though. I should probably get going...'

I looked at Dana, an inappropriate thought passing through my head. I said, 'Hey, you know we have plenty of guest rooms, Russ. Why don't you just crash here for the night. You can head off in the morning after a decent breakfast.'

Russell gave me a brief, quizzical look, but Dana said, 'That's a great idea—we have so many bedrooms that don't get used these days...'

A look passed between Dana and a slightly bewildered Russell before they managed to hide it from me, and I felt the flames of excitement sparking up inside my chest. Was there any chance Dana might want things to continue between her and Russell? And if Russell was aware I wasn't against the idea of him fooling around with her...

I felt like the Devil.

FRIENDS WITH BENEFITS

“It’s settled then,” Dana said before Russell could actually answer one way or another. “Honey, could you get Russell settled in? I’m going to take a quick shower.” She definitely glanced over at my friend as she said this. “Long day.”

We both watched her slip back into the house in quiet disbelief before he looked back at me. “I really should go—”

“Do you really want to?”

“I said I *should*.”

I grinned. “Right.”

Russell looked like he couldn’t decide whether this was a nightmare or a wet dream. I pressed. “Think of this as me repaying you for Margie Bailey.”

“This is crazy, man.”

“I mean, I do probably have some brain damage.” I stood. “Come on, let’s find you a room that’s nice and far away from my own.”

“I... I can find it on my own. Let me, um, pick up our things out here.” He was being strange until I realized that he had a hardon—and not that I was checking him out, but it looked pretty big.

I laughed. “If I don’t see you later, have a good night.”

With that, I followed my wife up the stairs, wondering if I’d be able to resist joining her for her “quick shower.” She was, indeed, upstairs in the

bathroom off of our bedroom—ours, now that she was staying there every night. Her clothes were piled on the bed, and I was about to move into the shower when I saw her phone, nestled on top of her clothes, light up.

I couldn't resist. I almost knew what I would find before picking it up and looking.

'I am addicted to your body.'

The message from Jackson was right there, on the heap of her lingerie. I picked the phone up, my hands shaking, just as the phone rumbled again.

A photo slid into view, taken from Jackson's perspective—a woman's ass, thong pulled to one side, garters stretching from lacy belt to her sheer stockings, and a man's cock half buried in her pussy. Dana's pussy.

I glanced at the clothes that the phone was sitting on. The black garter belt matched the one in the photo. It was still attached to the same stockings. And beneath it all, the same thong. I looked at the photo again, at the pile of clothes, back at the photo. Where was this? His house? He'd asked her to go. Had she?

The shower cut off, and my heart leapt with it. I set the phone back onto the pile of clothes where it had been and snuck back out of the room again.

I went to a bedroom on the opposite side of the house, next to Dana's, and made sure that there were fresh towels out for Russell. I was already surveying it from a voyeur's perspective, my mind working on how I could watch the way it must have once worked calculating the worth of a startup.

Like our room, double doors walked out onto the veranda. I knew that this stretched around half of the house. I could sneak in there and look in. I made sure to pull the curtains most of the way closed, leaving a sliver for me to peep in. Shameful, yes, but it all felt so easy.

Russell had recovered by the time I got down there. I helped him stick the last of the Chinese food into the fridge. 'She was with Jackson earlier today,' I whispered as we carted things in, just in case Dana came back down.

‘I’m sorry, man.’

‘Don’t be. You know how I feel.’

Russ shook his head, but didn’t say anything more until we were heading up the stairs. ‘You know she loves you—’

‘I do.’

He’d started in like he was trying to make an argument that I didn’t agree with. But I did. I knew, despite all of this. Recovering, he nodded. ‘When I think back on those times that we were together, it was almost like she was performing, now that I think about it. If you two really did have some kind of arrangement, maybe I was just part of the game.’

I hadn’t thought about it like that.

‘Russ, I’m still recovering from a coma. You’re over-taxing my damaged brain.’

He snorted. ‘Damien Sullivan being self-effacing. Now I really know you changed.’

We arrived at the room I’d prepared for him, just as Dana emerged from the bedroom in a long, silk robe. ‘Oh, good, you put him in the Green Room,’ she said. ‘Excellent choice.’

We said our goodnights. It was late, but there was no way that I was going to get any sleep. I felt wired, the way I always felt wired whenever I knew my wife was about to be naughty. I wondered if that would ever get old.

‘So your meetings went well?’ I asked Dana as we settled into our own bed in our own expansive room.

She yawned, stretching her arms over her head. ‘They did. After all these months, it was odd seeing people in person—not to mention wearing a mask the whole time—but odd in a good way.’

‘I... I actually have no idea.’ We laughed. ‘Everything is odd for me now.’

She untied the sash of her robe and let it fall. Beneath, she wore a short negligee of the same black silk. My breath caught. As she climbed into bed, she treated me with a glimpse into the deep cavity of her cleavage.

‘Your memories not coming back at all?’ She rolled onto her side, her head on the pillow, facing me. There was real empathy in her voice. She wasn’t calculating. She wasn’t trying to figure out if she’d gotten away with something. This was just a woman concerned about the man she loved.

‘Some, but not many. Nothing concrete. It’s more like remembering an emotion, if that makes sense. Like how certain smells can remind you of something? It’s like that, only the smell reminds me of a feeling, rather than an actual memory.’

She reached out, touching my face. ‘That must be hard.’

‘That part may be, but I have a lot to be thankful for.’ She smiled, her eyes drooping. She yawned again. ‘Goodnight, Dana. Get some rest. You had a long day.’

I COULDN’T SLEEP. I didn’t. I tried. I turned away from her. I listened in the dark as Dana slipped into a restful sleep. I sat there and thought about my life and where it was going. I didn’t want to go back to work. That was starting to become crystal clear. Life wasn’t going to go back to normal, memory loss or not.

I also wondered how open our “open” relationship was. Funny thing to think about. Did I look the other way from her past indiscretions because they were harmless and I was focused on work? Little of both?

I almost fell asleep as I contemplated these questions. An hour passed. Maybe two. I was on the cusp. Lying there, my back turned from Dana, staring out the window, I could practically feel sleep taking hold when she shifted.

I didn't move myself, but only due to some miracle. It was like I was injected with adrenaline. This was it. This was the moment. Dana, quietly, slipped out of bed. I pretended to sleep, regulating my breathing as if by some miracle.

She sat there in bed, listening, making sure that I didn't wake up. She even whispered my name. 'Damien? Are you awake?'

I swore that she must have heard my beating heart. It felt like thunder clapping inside my skull. She didn't, though, and a moment later, she was out of the room, the only sound the click of the door as it shut behind her.

I WAITED.

I waited quite a while.

I probably waited a lot longer than I needed to—but I had to be sure. What if she was just slipping out to get something from somewhere else in the house, with the intention of coming straight back? A drink from the kitchen, a snack. Her Kindle. A pair of headphones.

My heart was thumping, though, my cock was stiff. Adrenaline flowed through my system. I had a fair idea what Dana was up to.

She was hooked. She was addicted to adultery. She'd enjoyed a few occasions with Russell, and as far as she knew the two of them hadn't ever actually ended things. She didn't know he'd been acting on my instructions—as far as she was concerned, it was just a dangerous little adventure with her husband's best friend.

Exciting.

At last, I felt sure she'd been gone long enough that her reasoning could not be innocent. Silently, I slipped out of bed. I found my t-shirt in the darkness, and put it on.

God. This was living.

I moved to the French windows that led out onto the veranda. The air from outside was cool on my skin as I slipped outside, double-checking the windows as I went so that I knew I wouldn't be in danger of locking myself out.

Was Dana with Russell? She had to be. Had he been waiting for her, or did she have to wake him up? He knew it was coming—although, he might not have known how late she'd leave it. I could imagine his excitement at seeing her arrive, knowing what she wanted. I could imagine it because I remembered how it had been in the limo when I'd been released from hospital after recovering from COVID.

I was glad Russell would get to have that excitement. I was glad that Dana got to experience the rush, too. The rush of adultery. I had understood her reasons for cheating on me when I'd learned that our marital sex life had been comatose for years. Now, feeding my own kink with this stalker-like behavior in the night, I felt like I really connected with her reasons for cheating on me. I wasn't just tolerating her going behind my back, I was loving it.

I moved along the veranda, around the house. This building was incredible. It was far, far too much for a couple who had no kids. I had an idea I didn't want us to stay living in it—it was obscene. Our wealth was obscene. But for now, I was going to enjoy the experience.

I had to think about the layout of the house, I had to picture where Russell's room was, which windows on the veranda I needed to find. In the end, it wasn't difficult to figure out where I needed to be—it was the windows where the lights were on in the bedroom inside. I found the gap I'd left for myself in the curtain, and peered inside, my heart in my throat, my breath held.

And there they were.

The scene was explosive, unreal, yet undeniable all at once. There was Dana on all fours on the bed, in full profile to me. She still wore the

negligee that she'd gone to bed in, but it now acted more as a wide belt than something to hide her modesty.

Russell stood beside her, stripped down to his boxer-briefs, his cock stretching it obscenely. And just as I looked in, I watched him land a glancing blow along her ass cheek. She stiffened, but the look on her face was ecstatic. He asked her something that I couldn't hear, and she nodded in the affirmative.

They exchanged a few more words as I looked in. Russell was a good looking guy. The last memory I had of him without a shirt on was University, and if anything, he'd only filled out more. The hair on his broad chest was still, mostly, dark, his shoulders were still wide, and he'd managed to maintain a six-pack.

He circled her, a predator sizing up his prey. Dana's eyes followed him, unable to look away from that colossal bulge in his tight boxers.

He carried himself differently than Jackson Ross. Jackson was like pure testosterone, a form of masculinity that only exists in young men—or men who forget that they're no longer young. Jackson earned it through sheer grit and determination. Russell, now that I saw him the way Dana saw him, had a confidence that was just as powerful as Jackson's, only more refined. He was a single malt Scotch compared to Jackson Ross's Jack Daniels.

He leaned against a dresser, facing Dana, who remained on all fours. Crossing his arms, he asked her something that made her laugh.

That was different, too. She may be posed as a sub, but the banter between them wasn't whatever I'd watched with her and Jackson in the alley.

And then he pushed his boxers down his thighs, and he was enormous. *Donkey dick*, Sarah called it. Dana reacted, her mouth parting as he kicked the boxers away. The time for friendly banter was over. Now the real lust took control.

Jackson pulled something off the dresser behind him that I'm pretty sure I didn't leave out for the guests. A riding crop. He marched right up to her, his stiff cock bouncing, almost too thick and heavy to jut upwards.

Dana bit her lip as it came within inches of it, but when she moved her head out to kiss it, Russell stopped her. "Not yet," he said with steely resolve, loud enough that I could hear it through the glass.

He traced the riding crop down her bare back, between her shoulder blades and the scrap of black satin around her waist. He didn't strike her with it, instead using the flexing end to caress. He teased the dimples that sat on either side of her tailbone. He nudged it between her cheeks, teasing her asshole and drawing a gasp.

He was speaking again, low enough that I couldn't hear. Dana listened, nodding, hypnotized by whatever he was saying.

With his left hand, he grabbed his cock and stepped closer. This time, Dana didn't move. She remained frozen, staring up at him as he rubbed cock over her face, the bridge of her nose, her sharp cheekbones.

'Good,' he seemed to say with a nod. Then, with a quick flick, he lifted the crop and brought it down on her right buttock. Dana's eyes flared quickly, then drooped in lust. He spoke again, feeding his cock at last between her lips.

Dana remained on her hands and knees, staring up at him as she wrapped her lips around the swollen tip.

Outside, I groaned. Watching this obscene act would never get old. Russell seemed to feel the same, releasing his shaft to reach out and brush her dark hair from her face so he could watch her cheeks cave around him as she bobbed. It gave me a perfect view of the blowjob, too.

Was he even bigger than Jackson Ross?

No wonder Dana leapt at the chance to play with him some more. Holding that huge thing in her mouth, she had to seriously stretch her lips to

accommodate it. Just unbelievable. But the fire in her eyes suggested she liked the challenge—and to me, it was just hot to see her try.

He continued to tease her with the crop, holding her hair, speaking words of encouragement as she managed to get more and more into her mouth. He spoke encouragingly as her tongue flashed out, teasing the base of his manhood.

I found myself gazing at my wife taking that huge thing in her mouth, taken by the sight and by the strange feeling it provoked in me—sheer desire, tinged with a hint of insecurity and lashings and lashings of amazement. Dana seemed to play up to all the attention, gagging on him, giving him the kind of sloppy blowjob that she'd never give me.

When he pulled back, she didn't whine or complain. She knew her place. She stayed where she was, obedient and waiting, as he started rubbing his saliva-coated cock all over her pretty face. He spoke, she nodded and listened. 'Open up,' he seemed to say, emphasizing the command with another swift lash of the riding crop.

The exchange was fascinating. The command he held over her—and her desire to submit—was undeniable. I could never do that, I knew. I could never give her what she truly wanted and so desperately craved.

This time, she accepted more of his member, deep enough that she visibly gagged. She faltered at the elbows, blinking back tears, but fought through it. When he pulled back and let her gasp, he rewarded her with a few more lashes. 'Good slut,' he mouthed.

He drew the riding crop back up her body, flicking it around until it rested just under her chin. With a nudge, he guided her up to a kneel. Her nipples were not only hard, but she had clamps on the ends of them. He tapped the clamps with the crop as they spoke some more.

Unlike before, she didn't stare at his cock. She stared up at him, into his eyes, nodding and speaking only when spoken too. Russell ran the crop up

through her cleavage, along her neck, across her lips. She opened her mouth, sucked on it like a cock.

The one thing I was missing was the dialog. How I longed to know what he was telling her, and what she was nodding at. How I would have loved to hear what he said when he stepped back, letting her finally get to her feet before him.

She wiggled her negligee over her hips, letting it drop, and at last she was stark naked before him, wearing—I finally noted—a pair of tall, patent leather heels. And in those heels, she was nearly as tall as Russell.

A smile broke, first on his face, then hers, contagious as it was. He stepped up to her, hooking the riding crop behind her head. With a tug, their heads came together for a deep, hungry kiss. It was so personal, so intimate, kissing like that.

His free hand filled her breasts, playing with the nipple clamp. She gasped, breaking the kiss momentarily before going back in for more.

Why was this so much hotter than when I'd seen her with Jackson Ross? Because this was more sensual, I guessed. Or maybe, because I'd totally set this up. I'd invited Russell into my home, I'd suggested he stay over, knowing Dana would make a play for him if she could. I had made it clear to Russell that I was good with this.

For a moment, the dominance and submission disappeared, replaced by something more intimate, more erotic. They were just two, attractive people doing something naughty together. They seemed to revel in it, and revel in one another.

Insecurity raced through me, and with it, elation. Was it always like this with her men? Was it always like this with Russell?

And then the power games were back. Russell stood back. 'Turn,' I saw him say, twirling his finger. She turned. 'Bend over,' he ordered. She bent at the waist, placing her hands flat on the mattress, her ass presented to him.

This was it. This was the moment. He set the shaft of the riding crop between her teeth, freeing both hands to grab her hips and line himself up.

I shook. I felt woozy. I had to look away, glancing around the veranda to double-check that I was safe. No neighbors could see me here. No neighbors would call the cops on this peeping tom.

I heard Dana cry through the glass and through the makeshift gag of the riding crop. I turned back, just in time to watch Russell drive his huge dick into my wife's pussy. My best friend's hard cock was inside my gorgeous wife!

I was transfixed. I couldn't get enough. I freed my own cock and started stroking in time with my cheating wife, fucking my best friend, right under my own roof. Their position was good, letting him spank her as they fucked, but unsustainable.

Russell repositioned her, her knees back on the bed, her chest down, head to the side. He fucked her like that, from behind, doggystyle, spanking her until she came hard enough that I could hear through the window.

From Russell, though, that seemed to be just the warmup. Grabbing her by the elbows, he pulled back until she was suspended off the bed, her breasts bouncing wildly with each thrust. When Jackson had fucked her in the alley, it was strong, but this was on another level. Russell was far stronger than I remembered, his biceps thick and straining as he manhandled my wife.

My own hand was a blur, jerking in time with the two. My legs ached from the perpetual crouch and I felt light-headed.

Russell was saying something, barking an order that came muffled through the glass and the delirium of my lust. He was close, though, his face tight, every muscle in his body taut. He pulled harder on her elbows, bowing Dana back, a parabolic curve launching into infinity.

I expected the yell, the groan, the wild ejaculation into my wife. Instead, he nearly tossed her back to the bed, his monster dick sliding free. Dana

knew what to do, moving with quick efficiency.

She spun around, slid until she sat on the edge of the bed, and wrapped both hands around Russell's cock, jerking him in time. '*Do it,*' she seemed to tell him, eyes on his. '*Please... sir...*'

I came along with Russell, although where I coated the patio tiles of our outdoor veranda, Russell pumped his come on Dana's tits, her neck, her smiling face. And there was a lot of come. Dana seemed determined to milk everything from him, jerking him through it all.

I wouldn't have been able to take more of it. Even outside, by my own hand, I felt sensitive and sore. Not so with Russell. When he began to soften and Dana leaned in to take him back into her mouth, he didn't push her away. He stood, hands on hips, and let her work her magic.

I slumped down, leaning against the outer wall of our home, staring at the night sky over San Francisco. Even as the sweat cooled beneath my pajamas and my dick grew soft, regret didn't start to creep in. I didn't feel shame for what I'd just watched, nor anger for what my wife and best friend had just done.

This was so messed up, and yet I somehow knew, deep down, that everything was going to be fine.

I straightened myself up, pulling my pants back into place so that I wouldn't have to walk around the house with my dick hanging out—no matter what time of night it was, that seemed like a bad idea.

For one brief moment, the fear of discovery sliced through me. What if Dana had already cleaned herself up? What if she had already returned to our bedroom only to find the bed empty and the door outside open? Funny that of all the things, that's what I was worried about.

I needn't be. Inside, Dana and Russell were sprawled out on the bed, making out. She was stroking his erection as he fondled her tits, rubbing his own come into them.

But they weren't just kissing. They were talking, whispering, having an intimate conversation, both enjoying the forbidden nature of this encounter.

My hard cock throbbed, my heart skipped a beat. I should have left, but wanted to see this, too. I wanted to see more, the way an addict wants more and more and more. He touched her shaved mound and seemed to ask her something. 'You like it?' I thought she asked in return. He nodded.

She bit her lip, such an obvious signal that she wanted him, but so hot for me to see. She laughed again—pretty, flirty, laying it on thick for him. And then they were kissing again, sweet and soft at first, but headed harder. Headed for more.

I wasn't the only addict. This was Dana hooked on the cheating.

Here was my beautiful wife, entirely naked with my best friend, her cheeks still flushed from their first round of sex, climbing onto another man's lap. Reaching behind her, she lined his huge cock with her, rubbed the crown along her clit once for good measure, and sank back onto him.

My angle into the room was perfect. I could see everything—his thick shaft penetrating her stretched pink pussy, her face as she accepted all that thickness, the way she held her breath until he sank all the way to the root.

I was lulled into watching her fuck him reverse cowboy, half facing the windows, her shapely legs parted so that I could see every little detail of his enormous cock impaling her—and then, suddenly, she seemed to be gazing out of the window and smiling, so sweetly, so beautifully, so damn sexy.

It shocked me to the core.

Had she seen me out here?

I jerked away from the window, horrified, stunned, feeling the hot flush of shame spread all over my face and chest.

In the shadows, I felt stupid. Had she seen me? Did she know I was watching? Did she think me some pathetic peeping tom? Or worse, did she care nothing about whether I discovered her cheating, and might be hurt by it?

But I couldn't tear myself away from this. I ventured closer to the window again, and watched her continue working out on his pole, no longer gazing out of the window, her eyes closed in sheer bliss. I began to believe that she hadn't seen me—she couldn't have. She was going on regardless, certainly acting as though she couldn't have noticed me at the window.

They shifted on the bed. Russell guided her onto her back and took her missionary style, his body dominating her as she twisted her long legs around his torso. They two rocked together, beautiful creatures committing a beautifully illicit act.

I was hard again, but not so hard that I felt the need for release. I just watched Russell's hips rise and fall, again and again, rocking Dana's world until at last, at long, long last, he drove forward no more. Leaning down, he kissed her as he pumped his come into her.

She was so beautiful. I could hardly believe how much I wanted her just then, and yet at the same time I wanted her to keep fucking him, to maximize her pleasure before she eventually returned to me.

At long last, I crept away, as satisfied as I knew my wife must be right then.

FAITH IN THE UNFAITHFUL

I was waiting a while.

I knew, early on, that I would be kidding myself if I thought I could just slip into bed, close my eyes and drift off to sleep. I was buzzing, fizzing with energy and excitement. For the greater part of half an hour, I lay there with a full-sized erection that just throbbed wanting to be stroked and pulled.

The trouble was, the longer she was gone, the more thrilling it seemed to be—because I knew she was with him.

I knew she was fucking him. Round three, at least!

I had a lot of time to think about it. To think about them. At first, I also had a smartphone with which to while away the hours—and don't think I didn't try to distract myself with it. I didn't have the attention-span to watch anything on Netflix, or any of the other streaming platforms Dana had helped me find via my smartphone. I read the Chronicle for a while, and the Washington Post—I'd been dipping into the Post's archives in spare moments for a while, now, trying to read up on some of the historical events I'd forgotten during my coma. But my mind kept drifting back to my beautiful wife, and thoughts of her bouncing on my best friend's enormous cock.

Why did it feel different, knowing that she was with Russell?

I wouldn't say it was better than when I'd seen her with Jackson Ross, per se. Different. I was expecting to be more jealous, seeing Dana with my friend. I was expecting to feel more insecure, more threatened, because I knew Russell was a nice guy, someone she might have, or form, a close bond with—someone who was too similar to me to rule out a long-term relationship. But I didn't feel insecure. I felt a warm glow inside, knowing that she was with someone I liked, someone I knew, someone I trusted.

Sure, there wasn't the sheer force of what Dana experienced with Jackson Ross—his dominance, his control, the sheer thrill knowing she was under his power. Russell wasn't a particularly dominant alpha male, though he was undoubtedly an alpha with her. Watching Dana, it was clear she lusted after his big cock, donkey dick, but also, I had the sense that Russell's closeness to me gave her something she couldn't have with Jackson Ross—an added soupçon of wickedness when she was cheating on me.

Because with Russell, she was cheating on me with my best friend.

Did that make her cruel? I suppose others might see that. I just saw it as mischievous. Playful, almost. As long as she still wanted me, as long as she still loved me, I was fine about her taking her own sexual decisions, whoever it might involve.

And as for Russell—sure, he hadn't given me the full truth when I talked to him after my return from hospital, but that had been for my benefit, since he hadn't known how much I'd be able to handle, or how I now felt about Dana. But now I knew where he stood. I trusted him. I felt certain that I could let him spend as much time as he liked in bed with my wife, and he wasn't going to want to steal her away. What could he gain from stealing her away? He could have as much of her as he wanted, with my blessing.

I guess, when I thought about it, I didn't feel as much fear as I did when I watched Dana with Jackson Ross. I felt more in control. I even felt, a

little, as though I was giving Dana to Russell, and giving Russell to Dana, and so there was that warm rosy glow inside from giving people I cared about a wonderful present.

With Jackson Ross, there was more of an ever-present fear lingering under the surface—even though I knew he wasn't the type of man Dana could live with, could ever want to marry, could ever think of leaving me for—and that was a different kind of strange pleasure for me. Like spice in a red-hot chili.

Watching Dana with Jackson Ross, and with Russell, was just like enjoying two of your favorite foods—only, they were completely different kinds of food, and you obsessed about them for different reasons. Steak and hamburger, chocolate and cheese. Or more accurately, perhaps, chili and ice cream.

The worst fear I had about any of it wasn't even about Dana, it was about myself.

The worst fear I had was that I would turn back into the stupid workaholic bonehead who had neglected his wife before falling ill with the coronavirus.

I'M NOT SURE WHEN, exactly, I decided not to pretend to be asleep when she came back. Part of it was the realization that I might not be able to hear her tip-toe back into the room, and I might not see her coming soon enough to conceal the fact that I was lying in bed reading my smartphone. And if she came in, and I was stupid enough to try to conceal the brightness of my phone and she saw me, it would look just plain weird to be attempting to hide my phone from her—as though I was in boarding school again, trying to hide my night reading activities from my schoolmaster.

Part of it was a mischievous sense of what Dana might say when she came back to our room and found me awake, and I might have been awake long enough to have realized she'd been gone for a while.

And part of it, I suppose, was my craving for her, and my hope that if she came back to bed and knew I was awake, there might be half a chance she was still in the mood for something a little risqué. If she got off on being unfaithful, after all, she might see me here and want to really indulge in that whole two-timing thing.

Anyway. I felt better about not hiding my wakefulness from her. And even when I got to the point where I couldn't do anything much with my smartphone to distract myself other than play Candy Crush, I recognized that doing something other than just lying in the dark contemplating my wife's infidelity was going to be more healthy for my overall mentality.

What if she stayed with him all night?

Well, for some reason I felt certain she wouldn't. And if she did, maybe I would eventually drift off to sleep.

Eventually—perhaps even a couple of hours eventually—my faith in my unfaithful wife was rewarded.

'Hey.'

And even though I'd been waiting for her, believing that she would come back to me that night, she still made me jump when she returned, saw I was awake, and first spoke.

'You're awake?'

There was a note of mild fear in her voice, no doubt as she pondered how long I might have been awake, and if I'd been awake a while, what I must think of her sustained absence from our bed.

But I just smiled, whether or not she could see it, and sighed in a very casual, relaxed, reassuring way, 'Yeah, I guess my mind just won't stop spinning with all this new information I keep trying to absorb.'

I showed her the Washington Post on my phone screen, as though to suggest I'd been reading that all night, rather than playing mindless fruit-based puzzle games, but it was a better explanation if I wasn't going to let on that I knew about her and Russell.

She climbed onto the bed beside me, and gave a similar sigh, saying, 'I can't sleep, either. The world's gone so crazy... it's hard to stop thinking about it, even if I haven't lost twenty years of my memory.'

I wondered if she'd had a shower since being with Russell. If she was afraid I'd smell sex on her. But she leaned over, put a soft hand on my upper chest, and kissed my lips, briefly, and I breathed in a lungful of her faint perfume, and the subtle but obvious earthy scent from their coitus, and I figured that if she thought I hadn't detected it after Jackson Ross had fucked her, I wouldn't detect it now.

My manhood thickened up in record time.

'You know, they're saying there's a possibility that we may have another lockdown,' she said, kissing my cheek, and then my neck—showing that she was planning on giving me more than just an affectionate kiss of greeting.

'Oh, really?' I said, trying to remain calm, as though I hadn't witnessed her having sex with my best friend earlier that night, and as a result was horny as sin.

'There's been an uptick in COVID cases, I guess,' she sighed.

I kissed her back, luxuriating in the softness of her lips, the sweetness of her scent, and the gentle smile of sex about her. 'That's a shame,' I said. 'It's been nice, starting to see friends again.'

'Are you... awake, then?' she said, flirty, sexy.

'Oh yes.'

I felt her hand slide down my chest, and her fingers soon found the hardness I was stowing between my legs. I liked hearing her catch her breath as she discovered just how hard I was, and then we were making out

some more, with added passion. I pulled off my shirt, and she was exploring my body as though she hadn't had sex for weeks.

Russell had clearly left her wanting more.

Or else Dana was turned on by her infidelity, as I was, and coming back to me fired her up even more. As she kissed me hungrily, it felt like the latter.

'We have to be quiet...' Dana whispered. 'Don't want to wake Russell.'

I pulled open her bathrobe, revealing her gorgeous breasts. 'What will he care?' I said, amused that she would mention his name just now—but the way she said it, it was almost as though she was reminding herself that she'd just slept with him, and now she was with me.

I squeezed and fondled her magnificent breasts, moving to lie between her legs as I pressed my face against her cleavage. This was heaven. I was on fire. I took a long, slow breath and filled my chest with that wicked cocktail of her personal scent, her perfume, and the unmistakable hints of recent sex.

He'd come all over these tits, and yet that didn't deter me from taking one of her nipples in my mouth. It felt deliciously wrong. She moaned at the feeling of my hot mouth on her sensitive bud, but soon enough I was moving down, planting little kisses down her breasts, over her stomach, sensing the hint of perspiration on her smooth skin. Every little suggestion, every hint of evidence for her infidelity only seemed to drive me on more and more.

I found my way to her panties, which were fairly plain and pink, but took on a whole extra level of eroticism because they were soaking wet—and I knew she hadn't had time to get this wet since she'd come back to me.

I kissed and licked her soft skin around her sodden underwear, teasing myself with that dark, spicy scent of her sex, but also apparently teasing her by delaying her gratification.

‘Please...’ she moaned, as I edged close to her pussy, nudging her panties a little aside with my nose, but stopping short before I reached her labia. ‘Please...’

I took my time, gazing at her exposed sex in the low light of a single bedside lamp, the memories of Russell sliding his huge cock inside her again and again fresh in my mind as I took in the sight of her glistening-wet, freshly-fucked pussy.

I couldn’t hold out for long, dipping down to wedge my face up against her shaven sex, feeling the heat of her body, the wetness of her arousal against my mouth and my nose.

She moaned as I began lapping at her juices, she put a hand on my head and stroked my hair as I flicked the tip of my tongue close to her clit. I glanced up at her, and she was looking down at me with an expression that was very close to amazement. What a delight, feasting on her. She looked like an angel, lying there on the pure white bedding. I couldn’t get enough of her, and from the sound of her sighs and little gasps, she couldn’t get enough, either.

I wasn’t rushed. I was high on her adultery, intoxicated by her wickedness, addicted to her exquisite, well-used pussy—addicted to the undeniable taste of another man’s come. I swear, she came twice before I remembered the hardness lurking between my thighs, and pushed up in order to press my case for penetration.

She smiled that heavenly smile as I rested my stiff shaft against her open flower.

‘If we go back into full lockdown, I think I’ll just stay in bed with you,’ she said sweetly.

I teased her pussy with the tip of my cock. ‘I think I could handle that,’ I grinned. ‘But I might need some help...’

Her eyes suddenly widened, and her jaw dropped as she looked at me, shocked at what I’d just said. The funny thing was, I wasn’t meaning to

suggest that she might need other lovers, although I've no doubt she was suddenly surprised, or even afraid, that I knew more than she thought I did about her secret adultery. I quietly enjoyed the flush that spread across her cheeks, hinting at her guilt for cheating on me multiple times.

I let a heartbeat or two pass before I explained, 'Well... you know... if we're in bed all the time, we might need some toys or something...'

Her face broke into a broad, amused grin, and I managed to make myself look so earnest, that she seemed relieved that apparently I didn't know she was cheating on me, after all.

'Well, that might be fun...' she said, reaching down for my cock, slipping its tip inside her entrance to show me what she needed.

I slid inside her, feeling her pussy so slippery, so warm, my body buzzing with excitement to know that mine was the second dick to slide inside her that night.

I was way past wondering why I was so enamored with her adultery. I held onto her thighs and pushed my manhood as deep inside her as it could go, and she responded to me with a joyous groan. I can't believe how good it felt to be inside her. Thrusting into her again and again. She didn't seem to mind that I wasn't as big as Russell. I think the main thing was that I was different—and that merely emphasized how naughty she was.

I was a driven man. This was the most energetic I'd been since I'd gotten out of hospital—I was soon working up a sweat, dripping as I powered into her again and again. It was like one of her CrossFit classes. My muscles were burning.

Then, she pulled herself out from under me, and rolled me over so she could climb on top. It was a mercy to my lack of fitness that she did, so I could just lie back and take in the sight of her stunning figure, her glistening skin, her pretty face, and just wonder at how incredible it was that I had got to marry her.

I didn't last long, but she knew what was coming. Just before I exploded, she stopped, and picked herself off me before going down on all fours. She had me fuck her from behind that final furlong, clutching hold of her hips as I stared down at her peach of an ass, picturing the extraordinary sight of her in that alleyway with Jackson Ross fucking her.

I just felt like a trillion dollars as I eventually exploded inside her—and came, and came, and came, a whole surprising load of cream within her cheating pussy.

'Wow,' she said, completely breathless as we collapsed on the bed together, gasping for oxygen. 'You know, you were never like this—not even when we were dating.'

I laughed. 'Did you spike my drink with Viagra?'

She grinned, 'Maybe you're feeling intimidated because there's another man sleeping under our roof tonight.'

Well, that comment was more than a little close to the bone, but maybe not for the reasons she imagined.

Playing it straight, I said, 'I don't think I'm intimidated by Russell, he's my best friend.'

'I guess you do trust him a lot,' she said, perhaps mulling over whether Russell really was betraying that trust because he had been sleeping with her.

I grinned, 'Are you saying you're all worked up because he's in the house?'

Teasing her, like I thought it was funny.

She laughed it off, but as though jokingly confirming my allegation, suggested, 'So you should invite him over more often...'

I WOKE up feeling strangely disoriented—because I didn't remember falling asleep, I didn't recall the precise moment at which I'd stopped talking to Dana and actively tried to get to sleep. It felt almost as though I must have just collapsed into a slumber mid-sentence.

It also didn't help with my feeling of disorientation to wake up and find Dana gone. Didn't she need any sleep?

After a moment or two, I felt a jolt of heart swamp my heart—had she gone back to Russell's bed? Now my pulse was picking up, my manhood thickening. I hopped out of bed as though someone had just connected a car battery to my chest, and scampered into our walk-in closet to find a shirt and some jeans.

I tip-toed quietly toward Russell's guest room, ears pricked.

But there was only silence. And the door to the guest room was open, Russell quite clearly no longer inside. I felt disappointment, my hard-on faded. I turned on my heels and headed for the stairs—a dry smile spreading across my face. I was amused at my growing obsession with Dana's infidelity, at the fact that I'd been hoping she'd been having another round with my best friend behind my back.

But as I descended toward the ground level, I realized it wouldn't be at all safe for them to have another tumble in the hay at a time when I might wake up and come looking for them. The thought made me certain they couldn't have snuck down to the basement, or found a broom closet somewhere for another little quickie, either.

Venturing close to the kitchen, however, I heard their voices and I did hold back from the doorway, I did hold back from letting know I was there. Partly, I think, it was because as soon as I heard them, and realized they were using hushed tones, I knew they were talking about me, or about something they didn't want me to know—and that made whatever they were saying instantly intriguing.

'Don't you think that would be a fairly dangerous situation?'

That was Russell's voice.

'Why would it be dangerous?'

'Because he'd probably figure out pretty quickly that something was going on.'

'Not necessarily. It's a big house. Lots of space. And we could give you a room far away from ours...'

There was a teasing, flirtatious tone in Dana's voice. It made my pulse quicken.

Russell's tone was very sober and responsible in reply. 'He'd still get suspicious after a while—and if I'm spending lockdown with you guys, there'd be a good while for him to get suspicious.'

I caught my breath. Dana was trying to persuade him to spend lockdown with us?

My cock stiffened up to the point that I had to alter my stance to allow myself room in my jeans. My heart was really pumping now. Dana would actually want my best friend to stay with us so she could continue her infidelity if they tightened up the lockdown rules again? She'd want to cheat right under my nose?

And I felt myself wanting it, too. Longing for it. How crazy hot would that be?

'We could be careful. He wouldn't have to find out.'

'It only takes a few nights where he happens to wake up in the middle of the night to find you gone...'

'We wouldn't have to do it every night,' Dana said, though there was a note in her voice that hinted at it being difficult to resist not sneaking away when I was asleep to play with Russell's enormous cock. Needless to say, I liked the way she sounded.

Pervert.

Dana added, 'We'd probably end up having plenty of time during the day—you know, when he finally gets back to work, when he gets back his

taste for it.'

I heard Russell sigh. 'Sounds like you're worried he's going to turn full workaholic again. You know, you can talk to him. If he starts going that way... you can pull him out of it so he doesn't end up neglecting you...'

'I know,' Dana said, but she sounded as though it was something she'd only recently learned. 'That's not something I'm worried about anymore.'

'You're not?' Russell was genuinely surprised.

I heard Dana giggle. 'No. All this time together since he came out of hospital... I've learned a few little tricks to keep him hooked.'

'Oh, right.'

'He just needs a firm hand sometimes. Someone to... take charge.'

I shivered with lust at that, remembering how she'd been in my office, sitting in the green armchair. Taking the advice from her best friend Sarah to try dominating me sexually.

Get down on your knees.

'So maybe it would be better if you just... took charge whenever you needed him to stop working and pay you some attention...'

'Oh, I will.'

'So you don't need me around...' I heard Russell trying to talk my wife out of future infidelity, and I wanted to somehow tell him, telepathically, to stop. To embrace the idea of joining us in lockdown.

'I'm not saying I'd need you around...'

'You're not worried about your marriage, going behind his back...'

I couldn't understand it—he knew, clearly, that I'd allowed him to sleep with her last night. That I was good with all that. So why was he trying to talk her out of it? I got the feeling he was trying to do this for my own good. Like, maybe he didn't think I was of sound mind just now. That later, when I was fully recovered, I might change my mind about accepting his part in her infidelity. But I didn't think this was something from which I was going to recover.

There was a good chance I'd felt this way about Dana before my coma.

'I'm not worried,' she said.

'You don't think, someday, he happens to walk in on us...'

'That won't happen.'

'If we're spending every moment of every day under the same roof, for weeks—maybe months on end—chances are it would.'

'I think... maybe he'd forgive me. Us.'

I heard the acoustics of her voice change just then, subtly, like she was nuzzling up to him. I heard the unmistakable sound of a kiss.

She was seducing him.

'You wouldn't want some more of this?'

Another kiss.

'He's my friend...'

I groaned, silently. Thinking, you know I'd want this. Why are you trying to talk her out of it?

'Trust me...' she said, softly. 'It would be so good... good for him, too, I think.'

'Good for him?' It struck me that Russell just didn't understand—perhaps, he couldn't understand—why I would benefit from my wife being unfaithful. I guess it was a strange concept.

'Having his best friend around,' my wife said. 'Having a fully satisfied wife around...'

I heard some little moans. What was she doing with him? Didn't she know the risks—I could wake up, come downstairs any moment.

Then Russell said, 'Hey, look, if he walks in on us, right now, I don't think there'd be any chance he'd agree to me camping out here during lockdown.'

Dana giggled, like maybe she suspected it wouldn't be as much of a problem as Russell feared. But then I heard her say, 'Okay, I'll be a good girl... for now...'

And I felt another little shiver of pure lust sweep through my body—was Russell actually considering her idea, was he actually opening up to the idea of staying with us if the lockdown rules tightened up?

Well, Dana could be so very tempting.

I heard the clink of silverware on china, and it sounded as though the two of them were attempting to get back to their breakfast. I felt like it would be a good time to walk in on them—but I worried that if I suddenly appeared at the doorway, it might seem like I'd been eavesdropping.

Silently, I crept back upstairs. I was role-playing now—role-playing the innocent, unknowing husband, waking up, unconcerned about his wife's whereabouts, putting on some clothes. My performance was Oscar-worthy, though no one was there to see it. I just needed to get myself in the frame of mind to act as though I hadn't been there at the kitchen door, listening in on their private conversation. And I needed a little time to pass until it didn't seem coincidental that I'd suddenly enter the kitchen just as they were finished with their little secret chat.

When I felt ready, I went back downstairs again, this time not taking any care to remain particularly silent. I breezed into the kitchen, saying casually, 'Well, here you guys are...'

Alerting them to my presence before I appeared, just in case.

'Morning, hon,' Dana got up to greet me, even gave me a nice little kiss. She was wearing her workout clothes, of course—it was early enough that she hadn't had her CrossFit class yet—and didn't she look extra devastating with Russell there to see her in a sports bra and gray leggings that left almost zero to the imagination.

'Wow,' I said, joking as I unashamedly ran my eyes all over her sensational figure, 'you are going to get me feeling jealous...'

Dana giggled. 'You know that's not true.'

I saw a glance pass between Dana and Russell—a somewhat conspiratorial glance, as between two lovers behind the back of the

wronged husband—and tried not to react as though I'd noticed it. It struck me that Russell was playing a role here, too—more than one, actually. He was pretending to Dana that he was pretending to me that he hadn't just spent the night having sex with her behind my back.

'You guys put on a good spread,' I said, taking a seat at the breakfast table. The table was laden with food—bagels, cheese, ham, fruit, even scrambled eggs.

'Well, I have to be getting to my fitness class,' Dana said, moving to the fridge to retrieve some more orange juice.

'Say 'hi' to your trainer for me,' I grinned, then chuckled, adding, 'On second thought, don't bother. He kind of intimidates me...'

That made Russell laugh. 'He intimidates you? Who are you, and what have you done with my friend, Damien Sullivan?'

Dana seemed amused, too, leaning over to give me a somewhat patronizingly maternal kiss on the forehead—offering me a nice view of her cleavage as she did so—saying, 'Don't worry, honey, I won't let the Bad Man know you're here.'

She grinned, and added a real kiss on my lips as if apologizing for teasing me, then gave us both a flirty little wave as she exited the kitchen, knowing that the eyes of two men were firmly fixed on her delectable rear as she went.

'SHE WANTS me to move in with you guys, if they tighten up the lockdown rules again.'

Russell waited a few minutes into my breakfast before dropping that little bombshell. It gave Dana plenty of time to be properly gone, ensconced in her usual morning CrossFit class downstairs.

'That's what she said?' I grinned.

Russell looked surprised at my reaction.

I was faintly surprised at his.

‘She said it would be good for you to have a buddy around—you know, while you’re getting back to normal.’

I laughed. ‘I don’t think I’ll be getting fully back to normal.’

But I could see this was difficult for him. He was trying to be the fully responsible friend, but I could see he still suspected I wasn’t fully *compos mentis*. He was still mentally battling with the ethics of sleeping with a man’s wife with his blessing. Surely if I would let my friend sleep with my wife, I couldn’t be recovered, mentally—that would be what he was suspecting.

I said, ‘I think it would be a great idea for you to stay. God knows we have the space.’

Russell gave me a sharp look.

‘I’m serious,’ I insisted. ‘You know I don’t have a problem with you being with her. I like how she is when she’s well... attended.’

Russell sighed. ‘I don’t think I’m ever really going to get my head around this.’

‘You don’t have to. Just have some fun,’ I said, trying to sound reassuring.

‘If you guys want an open relationship, why don’t you just... talk to each other about it?’

I laughed. ‘Because it’s fun this way. And anyway, it wouldn’t really be an open relationship. I don’t feel a burning need for other women...’

Russell’s brow crinkled. He scratched his head. ‘You know she’s being unfaithful... and you like it. So why not just tell her she can be with other guys with your blessing?’

I shrugged. ‘I’m not sure I’m ready to,’ I said.

‘What are you worried about?’

Now it was my turn to sigh. ‘What she’d think about me, if she knew,’ I suggested.

‘It’s got to be better than having her think you’re some idiot she can just cheat on, every chance she gets, and you haven’t the faintest idea...’

‘I don’t think she thinks I’m an idiot...’ I insisted. ‘I don’t know... maybe she cheats on me, and feels a little guilty about it... maybe she feels a little sorry for me, even. But there are plenty of people out there with closed minds who would think a husband like me is somehow weak, pathetic.’

‘She’d never think that about you,’ he said, confidently.

‘Yeah, I’m hoping...’ I sighed again. ‘I’ll probably tell her, when I’m ready. But also... I don’t know... the cheating part is kind of fun. It’s just so... naughty.’

‘Naughty for her,’ he said. ‘I mean, I can understand why she would get off on it. I’ve had a few girlfriends I ended up cheating on...’

‘And a wife,’ I said, the image of a sun-tanned California blonde suddenly leaping to my mind—another flashback emerging from the fog of my lost memories.

‘Yeah,’ he said, surprised and suddenly curious about my little nugget of information.

‘Lisa,’ I said, the name coming to me.

‘Did Dana mention her?’ he asked me.

‘No—it just came to me,’ I revealed. ‘Sometimes... totally random memories from the period I’ve lost just come back to me.’

‘Weird,’ he said, but his surprise was thawing into amusement.

‘You cheated on Lisa with that woman from Fresno,’ I said. ‘Didn’t you?’

‘Yeah, I did,’ he laughed. ‘I mean... our marriage was already beyond repair. But I guess... the cheating part was... kind of exciting...’

I smiled. 'I think Dana gets off on it. And I... really like thinking about the excitement she's having...'

Russell laughed, but I think he was beginning to understand a little more about what was going on inside my head. He said, 'I think, maybe that coma's left you permanently messed up.'

'I don't care,' I laughed with him. 'I think I like being messed up.'

MAKING ARRANGEMENTS

The next month, we fell into a happy rhythm. Russ didn't move in right away, but the more we talked, the more convinced he seemed to be that it could happen. COVID-19 was still as frightening as ever, but with the warmer weather and the ability to social distance outside, some sense of normalcy (or at least a new normal) began to set in.

Dana took more and more "work" meetings offsite, and I was pretty certain that each of those also involved a stop at Jackson's for a bonus good time.

Her morning CrossFit sessions also continued remotely, despite the change in weather. I liked that. It meant that I still got to watch. It became part of my routine. I'd sneak down and listen from the quiet of the stairs, always unsure what I'd witness. Even after a month, the possibility sent a nervous thrill through me.

"And that's a wrap." Jackson was finishing up his class as I descended the stairs. "Nice job, everyone. I'll see you all tomorrow."

"Dana, can you stay a moment longer?" he asked. My heart skipped. This was one of those moments. I paused on the stairs, just out of sight, my ears perked up.

"Of course."

I waited, trying to control my breath without hyperventilating. The minute that passed felt like an age. At last, they were alone.

Jackson spoke first. "Have you invited your friend to Napa yet?"

Napa? As in Napa Valley, wine country, just north of the city?

"I told you, Jackson, I'm not so sure about that. She's like a sister."

"Even better."

Dana chuckled. "You're a pervert."

"You love it. And you've already told me you think she's hot. Bring her."

"Just because I think Sarah is hot doesn't mean I want to have sex with her." Sarah. Sarah Mallory? Jackson wanted to have a threesome with Dana and Sarah Mallory?

"We both know you're not opposed to a little girl-on-girl action."

Dana snorted. "And I'm still upset at you for that little surprise."

"Hey, I was double booked. Figured you two would be game. And besides, you didn't look too upset as Maria went down on you."

"Well, she did have excellent technique."

"I bet your friend has excellent technique, too. You two ever—"

"No!"

"Not even a kiss?"

"Only to get the guys worked up. She's my friend. We've never crossed that line."

"Mmm, you know how much I like crossing lines."

Dana giggled. "I'll... I'll think about it."

"Stop thinking. I'm telling you. Bring Sarah. That is an order."

There was silence after that. A moment later, I heard Dana cross the room and head into the shower as I stood there, stunned on the steps. Something that Dana had said on the phone to Sarah made me suspect that she had experience with other women. This drove that home.

Yet as hot as the idea of my wife exploring her bisexual side was, the thing that turned my insides molten was that she was doing it for another

man—that another *man* was telling her that this was what he wanted, and that she was to obey. Was there anything that she wouldn't do for Jackson Ross?

I LEARNED about this Napa trip a couple days later, when we were having lunch together between Dana's meetings. 'Hey, I need to take a few more meetings next week.'

'In the city?'

'Actually, farther north. In fact, I was thinking of staying in our house up there in Napa.'

I laughed. 'We have a house in Napa?'

I actually knew that we did, although only vaguely. Elsie had mentioned the collection of cars I kept out there.

'I keep forgetting how little you remember. Yes, we do. Smaller than this one, of course, but...'

'You like it better up there, don't you?'

She frowned. 'It's not that I don't love this house, but it's just so...'

'Big?'

Dana nodded. I *almost* said, '*But I thought you liked big.*' I was living a double life, and it was getting harder and harder to remind myself what I should and should not know.

'This place is too big,' I agreed.

This seemed to take her by surprise. 'You really think so?'

'Yeah! It could house dozens of people. You and I could go weeks without running into each other.'

'We used to.' Her smile was wan.

'It was that bad?'

‘Sometimes, yeah. Every marriage has a lull.’ I wondered where we were now. She was carrying on an active affair behind my back, yet I couldn’t seem to get mad. She seemed to read me and my thoughts. ‘I’m lucky to have you, though. When you got sick...’ And that was a genuine tear.

She wiped it away and smiled. ‘Have you thought about returning to work?’

‘I have.’

‘Great. I think you’ve got a few meetings lined up next week, too, then. All on Zoom of course. The timing should actually work out. I can give you space to get back into the groove while I’m up north.’

I nodded. *While you’re getting fucked morning, noon, and night by Jackson Ross.* I started to get hard. ‘The timing does sound perfect...’

I didn’t tell her that I planned on resigning next week. I couldn’t go back to that life, even if I wanted to. And I certainly didn’t want to.

‘SO HOW MANY homes do I own?’ I asked Russell the next day.

‘Other than the one here and in Napa Valley, you have two more.’

‘*Two more?*’

‘Yeah. You’ve got a flat in London, and a cabin in Tahoe, but honestly I’m not sure how much you get to the cabin.’

‘Work?’ I ventured.

‘Always work.’

‘The more I learn about myself, the less I like.’

Russell chuckled. ‘You weren’t that bad. Don’t beat yourself up about it. You were good at your job, that’s for sure. Always able to predict the best up-and-coming companies.’

‘Yet I couldn’t predict that this is where my marriage would go.’

‘That’s the way it works though, right? The work skills don’t always transfer to our personal lives. But...’ He trailed off.

‘What? Go on and say whatever.’

‘Just that... maybe you did know what you were getting into with Dana. Maybe the upsides outweighed the risks. You were never one who didn’t do your homework first.’ Intriguing thought. ‘So what are you going to do next week?’

‘About quitting? Or about Dana?’

‘Yes.’

We laughed. ‘Well, about the quitting, I guess that’s a question for you.’

‘I’ve looked through your accounts, and have my accountants take a look just to be safe. We’ve got a strategy to divest. You should be able to retire and live off your options, although...’

‘I can’t keep the house.’

‘I’m sorry.’

‘Don’t be.’ I looked around. ‘I don’t need this place. Why did I ever think that I did?’

Russell laughed. ‘You really have changed, my friend. I remember when you got that place. You were a bachelor then. We thought you wanted to be the next Hugh Hefner or something.’

‘Did I ever throw lingerie parties?’

‘Too busy with work.’

I scoffed at myself. ‘What a squandered opportunity.’

‘I’d say you landed yourself a much better one.’

‘Thank you, my friend.’ I wondered if my old self would be able to thank a man who’d slept with my wife. Sounded like maybe that was a yes.

‘And about Dana next week?’

‘I’ve got a plan for that, too. I do have one other question about the Napa house though.’

‘Go for it.’

‘Would you still be interested in moving in with us up in Napa?’
Russ just laughed.

WE HAD SEX EVERY NIGHT, and most mornings after her workout. As far as I could tell, she didn’t see Jackson Ross—or any other guy—physically in the lead up to her out-of-town trip, but all I had to do was think about it and I was raring to go.

It was Dana, however, who usually took control. Especially at night. She seemed to take the suggestions from Sarah to heart. She used me more. She treated me ‘a little mean,’ as Sarah had said.

Sarah. Sarah Mallory. Jackson wanted to share the bed with both her and my wife—and not just share them, but watch them fool around. I thought about that a lot, too. About what kind of man it made Jackson. When he wanted something, he asked for it. He didn’t concern himself with things like humility or shame. He was a man of pure ego.

I knew it wasn’t what Dana wanted from her life partner, but clearly it was something she was attracted to with her sexual ones.

I wanted to ask Dana about her sexual past. We’d started on the shakiest of ground, and she seemed fine with that arrangement—her cheating, me being the other man. How many were there before me?

And how many other *women*? Was Jackson’s surprise threesome her first time? It certainly didn’t seem like it. I wanted to ask her about *that*, too, but couldn’t muster the nerve. She still wore a mask of professionalism-with-a-hint-of-sexual-aggression with me, but it was still a mask.

I wanted to know more. I craved to know more. But I was so afraid. Of what? I don’t know. That once the ruse was over, she’d lose interest? That

she'd feel too ashamed? Was she, like me, just pretending, and one day, this dream would crumble and I would be all alone?

I kept waiting for the other shoe to drop—in more ways than one. The first came over the weekend that followed my overheard conversation.

'Honey, next week, while you're doing your orientation back into work, I need to take care of some business up north.'

'You're going to travel? In the pandemic?'

'Not far. I can drive. We have some business with a firm in Sacramento. Usually when we work with them, I stay in a hotel there, but I figure I might as well check in on our Napa home.'

'Of course we have a Napa home.' It was hard making myself sound surprised for the second time that week, but I manage. 'Don't tell me we own a vineyard.'

'You actually considered it for a time.' She was all smiles. Clearly that was my passion, not ours. 'It's actually quite nice. We should go visit one of these days.'

'We will.' Clearly she liked hearing my optimism as much as I liked saying it. 'How long do you think you'll be gone?'

'Probably two nights. I'll drive up in the afternoon, stay there. Head into Sacramento the next day and crash that night.'

Two nights of unadulterated, adulterous sex with her CrossFit trainer and, possibly, her best friend. It was all I could do not to spontaneously combust right in front of her. Somehow, I managed to stay calm.

'Makes sense to me.'

She gave me a kiss. 'I love you, honey. And I just can't wait spending more time with you.'

Sooner than you think, I thought. The wheels were already turning.

NAPA

We kissed, and her little moan of pleasure made my hard cock throb. But then she stepped away, and I was left standing there on the street as she climbed into the back of the limousine. Once inside, door closed, she opened the darkened window to give me a wave as Harry, our driver, pulled away from the curb.

And then she was gone. My errant wife.

I know, I know. She had business up north. She would be having various meetings, discussing business. But I knew what she would be doing when she got back to our house in Napa. That would be pleasure, not business. And Dana's particular pleasure was adulterous sex.

Watching her drive away in that limo, my heart rate soared. The game was afoot. I knew the where, I knew the when. I just had to get to our place in Napa.

I tried to act casual as I strolled back into the house, in case any neighbors might be watching. Then I raced upstairs, all the way, to the bedroom where I could change out of my pajamas and bathrobe and into some jeans and a shirt. Meanwhile, I was on the phone at the same time.

'Hey. Yeah, she's gone.'

'Great. I'm just a few blocks away,' said Russell, and I felt relief that he was so near. 'Meet you out front?'

‘Uh... round the back,’ I said, feeling a little paranoid in my concern that some neighbor might pass on the intelligence to my cheating wife that I had just hopped in a car with somebody.

By the time I got down to the gate exiting the property from the rear courtyard, Russell was there waiting for me in a fiery red Ford Mustang. I jumped into the passenger’s seat, and he pulled away from the curb with engine roaring and tires screeching.

‘You couldn’t have opted for a more subtle ride?’ I said, grinning as I felt the raw acceleration pushing me back into the seat before I’d even had time to get my seatbelt on.

‘You worry too much,’ he chuckled. ‘It’s not like we’re tailing anyone. Staking out some bad guy.’

‘No, but if we catch up with her...’

‘Relax. Harry always goes on the Bay Bridge, we’ll go the other way.’

And so we did—driving over the Golden Gate Bridge in a Mustang. Quite the invigorating drive. It was an eighty-minute drive up to Napa, where the air was fresh and there were vines everywhere you looked in the gently rolling landscape. It was beautiful around there—made me feel strongly that I’d prefer to stay out here, instead of heading back to the city once this weekend was done.

I was thankful that Russell knew where we were going, since I had no clue where my own property was. But when the single-lane road we were driving on came to a half in front of a strong-looking steel gate, my friend told me this was as far as he was going.

‘Any further, she’ll see us,’ he pointed out.

Well, I had only asked me to take me to the Napa house, not to stick with me while I stalked my wife. Nevertheless, I felt somewhat lost, now, knowing that he would be driving away, leaving me here in a place I had no memory of whatsoever.

‘Just head through that gate, and keep going,’ he said. ‘Can’t miss it.’

‘There’s... a code for the gate?’ I felt stupid, not knowing how to get into my own house. And what if Russell didn’t know, either? I didn’t have a big jangling set of keys.

Russell smiled. ‘You mean you forgot your keys?’

As my expression turned to horror, his smile broadened. ‘I’m just kidding with you,’ he chuckled. ‘Everything’s by fingerprint up here. Just hold your digit up to the reader, wherever you need to go.’

I nodded, relieved.

‘Thanks,’ I said, wishing I could express my gratitude more effectively. Heck, I let him sleep with my beautiful wife—that was gratitude enough.

‘You gonna be alright, buddy?’ He asked me, genuinely concerned.

‘Of course,’ I said. ‘I don’t need much.’

‘Just a suitable window looking in on Dana and her CrossFit guy, right?’ Russell grinned.

I laughed. ‘Hey, who needs a window, if I can get inside and find a decent closet to hide inside?’

He nodded. ‘You didn’t want to just stay at home and tap into the CCTV system? Probably could have seen anything you’d have wanted to.’

‘I told you,’ I said, ‘I want to be here. I want to see it happening right in front of me.’ Never mind that I didn’t know how to access any security system, here or anywhere else.

He nodded, smiled. ‘She’s gonna catch you one of these days,’ he warned me. ‘You know what to do when that happens?’

I shrugged. ‘Don’t tell me, the first step is admitting I have a problem.’

He laughed. ‘You don’t just have one problem, buddy. But, hey, give me a call if you need anything—or, you know, if she calls the cops on you and you need bailing out.’

It was good to know he had my back, even if he was driving back to the city, and any help he’d be able to give me would be more than an hour away. But I was confident I’d be okay—particularly after I touched the tip

of my finger to the electronic scanner on the wall beside the great steel gate, and the thing gave a cheerful little beep before the gate slowly started to swing open.

I FELT VERY ALONE when the roar of the Mustang faded to a hum behind me, and then disappeared entirely leaving me with only the serene sound of the wind in the trees. But this was exciting. My heart was racing as I walked past the gate, and along a single-track road that led into a small vineyard that extended up a slope. As the small trees beside the road fell away, and I entered the vineyard itself, I saw that the road curled through the rows of vines up to the peak of the hill—upon which sat an impressive-looking two-story mansion.

I was impressed—perhaps even more so than I had been at the palatial home Dana and I enjoyed in the middle of the city. As I climbed the hill, I could tell there was going to be a superlative view from the top. And the closer I came to the house at the top, the more confident I was that it was going to knock my socks off.

I had to be careful—although I couldn't see any cars up there at the house, the driveway curled around and into a kind of courtyard, in which someone could be parked and I would not see from here. But I could lurk at the edge of the vines and just gaze at this incredible vista. You could see for miles down the Napa Valley, but the view was all around, the hill's slope dropping away from the house in every direction. A good place for a castle, you might think.

This place was really ours?

I skirted the edges of the vineyard, looping around the building itself to scope out the place. The house itself was modern in style, all straight lines and massive floor-to-ceiling windows taking the place of walls, over two

high-ceilinged floors, with a fairly low triangular roof topping it off. There was a large L-shaped swimming pool out front, on the terrace that enjoyed the view down the valley, while behind the house I found a large tennis court.

There didn't seem to be anyone at home, which was a relief both from the fact that I had free rein to explore the property, and also that there was nobody here to catch me.

What would Dana do if she did catch me? It was my place, too.

She might be surprised to find me here, but I could just tell her I'd changed my mind about remaining in the city—that I preferred to spend the weekend with her, or that I was curious about what our Napa place was like. Would she be suspicious about my motives? Perhaps. But my bigger fear was that if she caught me here, whatever she was planning to do with Jackson Ross would almost certainly be cancelled at short notice.

Back on the swimming pool terrace, I cautiously approached the house, and peered inside one of the huge floor-to-ceiling windows that formed walls between thin, round stone columns. Inside, the place seemed very open plan, with plenty of comfortable but modern-looking seating everywhere—lounge areas, dining areas, a small bar with a view, a fireplace, even a grand piano. The architect had obviously abhorred internal walls, but seemed to quite like bare stone, which spread across the back wall. Behind the fireplace I found a huge kitchen with an island almost large enough for a light aircraft to land on it, and cooking appliances that wouldn't have looked out of place in the kitchen of a large restaurant.

I got the feeling this place was a perfect venue for truly legendary parties.

From the terrace, there were steps up to a veranda that ran around part of the upper floor, allowing me to take a peek at some of the bedrooms up there. The views from the bedrooms were just as breath-taking, if not more so, than from the terrace below.

God, even the pool seemed so very inviting just about now, after my long walk through the hot, dusty vineyard.

How was it that I lived in the city and only, apparently, occasionally visited this place? I stood there by the pool for a while, breathing in the clean air, thinking to myself that I was going to engineer a complete lifestyle re-think. This was the place to be, not the city. Was this our vineyard? Why the hell wasn't I here, making wine from our own grapes, rather than fiddling with numbers on some tedious investment platform?

I didn't want to go back to the city at all.

For now, though, my soul felt alive but my body was thirsty. I should probably have brought a drink.

There was a door opening out from the kitchen to the terrace, and it took me a moment to realize that, since this was actually my house, I should be able to just walk into there and check the refrigerator for supplies without worrying about the cops turning up. At the very least, I could stick my mouth under the faucet.

Sure enough, there was another fingerprint reader on the wall beside the door, and after I scanned one of my digits, there was a satisfying beep and the door lock clicked back. I felt truly blessed, walking in there, a wall of chilled, air-conditioned air surrounding me as I ventured toward the fridge.

Oh joy—the fridge was well stocked with wine, Champagne, various fruit juices and soda.

With my thirst sated, I had a little scout around the inside of the building. There were precious few places where I believed I'd be able to hide. Everything was so tidy and the furniture fairly minimalist. If Dana brought a man here to fuck, where would they go? The master bedroom? One of the four smaller bedrooms? The closets were all walk-in, and none of them offered much of a view of the bedroom to which it was attached. Maybe she'd want to stay downstairs, fuck him on one of the many couches down there. Or out on the terrace, in the pool.

The light was beginning to fade, the sun dipping down over the Mayacamas Mountains. As I stood out on the terrace, I could look down the hillside and see the familiar long, black shape of the limousine making its way toward the house.

It was Dana on her way, and thanks to the prominent location of the house, I had plenty of warning.

My decision on where to locate myself, however, was a difficult one, and I didn't have long to make it. In the end, I figured my best bet would be to remain outside. There were far more hiding places out here, and as it got darker, I was certain I'd be safer out here than in the house.

WATCHING

I hid in the bushes by the western corner of the house, where I could best see the limousine approaching while remaining hidden. The thought of Jackson Ross in there had my heart hammering.

I was so out-of-my-mind that I almost forgot to switch my phone to silent mode. Didn't want Dana calling me and outing my location.

The limo crawled along the final stage of the driveway, around to the building's front courtyard. I carefully monitored it, keeping out of sight, until it came to a halt. I held my breath as I watched Harry step out of the driver's seat and walk around to open the door for Dana.

There she was, looking divine in her sharp suit, her outfit's air of professionalism almost thwarted by how short her skirt was. The warmth of attraction and desire bloomed through me just to lay eyes on her, but my eyes were on the door, and how Harry didn't immediately shut it.

And then he emerged, Jackson Ross, dressed in a suit tonight, rather than his athletic gear. He moved to Dana's side, taking her into his arms. The betrayal and heartache was exquisite.

Sarah emerged next, the blonde wearing a tight, short black dress that showed off her impressive curves. Her golden hair was loose tonight, falling in soft curls around her bare shoulders. She laughed at something, touching Harry on the shoulder as he nodded curtly at her.

Jackson looked up at the house, and while I couldn't hear him, he looked just as impressed as I felt about the estate—*my* estate. Sarah sauntered up to him, pointing out some feature. He set a hand on the small of her back, the other on Dana's, and led them up the walk and into the house.

Once inside, I had to track back around the building to the front, and the swimming pool terrace, to attempt to observe what was going on. I was helped massively by the huge windows—walls made of glass—and the open-plan nature of the ground floor. This house could have been designed by a peeping tom. I was also aided by the carefully positioned foliage by the side of the terrace, which included shrubs suitable for me to hide behind.

I watched as the gloomy interior was suddenly lit up by perfect lighting, all across the house—and to startle me yet again, the entire terrace and swimming pool lit up, too. Everything looked so well-designed, and as I watched the three of them wander through the house toward the expansive kitchen, it felt almost as though I was watching a big-budget movie.

I scampered down the steps from the terrace down to the narrow strip of lawn that separated the building from the dusty vineyard, and then proceeded around the swimming pool before returning to the terrace on the other side. When I came back up, I could see the three of them in the kitchen, cheerfully chatting and sipping chilled white wine.

Behind me, I was slightly disturbed by the sound of Harry driving back down the road. It was so peaceful up here that I could hear the limo until it was really quite far away.

I tried to relax, watching the three of them wander back out to the couches immediately in front of the fireplace, where they could chat and enjoy the incredible view of the sun dipping down behind the mountains beyond. Dana snuggled at Jackson's side and, to start, Sarah sat on the love seat opposite.

He was so familiar with my wife—the way he touched her, the way he pulled up the side of her skirt to rub the bare skin above her stocking top. He nipped at her neck as she recalled some anecdote to them, and when she was done, they came together for a kiss.

Sarah didn't sit there awkwardly. She knew what the score was. She knew where this evening was headed. She set her glass of wine down gently and crossed over to the other couch, opposite Dana.

Jackson broke the kiss with my wife and turned seamlessly to kiss Sarah. I couldn't crouch so far back. I had to get closer. I crept along the stairs. It was bright inside, but the lights were also flooding the patio out here. The glass didn't offer me any cover, so I could only get so close.

Jackson switched between the two women as their hands roamed his body. Dana took Sarah's hand and placed it over Jackson's cock in a show that she was clearly not jealous of sharing.

I could feel the tension grow, even from outside, when Jackson pulled back from Sarah, but didn't immediately switch over to Dana. The two turned to look at one another, giggling nervously.

Jackson spoke again, cradling the backs of their heads in the palms of his hands and gently nudging the two closer. I watched, as mesmerized as Jackson, and Dana kissed her best friend on the lips.

It was soft, almost innocent, and ended with a string of breathy giggles. Jackson whispered something into Dana's ear. She nodded, took a deep breath, and kissed Sarah again. The innocence was gone, as were the inhibitions. Jackson didn't need to coax. He let his hands drop from their heads as the two women engaged in a deep kiss full of tongue and spit and passion.

Now I had to get closer. I had to hear. I had to be a part of this scene.

It was actually Dana who gave me my opportunity. Breaking her kiss, she looked at Jackson for approval. He gave it to her in the form of a kiss of his own, hard and possessive. Sarah, who'd been massaging his cock

through his pants, finally unzipped him and fished out his erection. She didn't wait for permission. She moved into his lap, slurping up the thick meat.

Dana stood, sauntering over to the sliding doors that lead out to the terrace. '...too nice out here to keep these shut,' she said, opening the doors. She scanned the surroundings, and I had a moment's panic before diving behind a shrub as her eyes swept my way. 'Now that's much better.'

Jackson was watching her as the blonde bobbed in his lap. 'So, Miss Executive, did you do as instructed?' he asked.

'Of course,' Dana said, turning back to him.

'Prove it.'

With her back to me, I watched her unbutton her suit jacket, shrugging it off to reveal her bare back and no bra. She'd been in meetings all day like that? The skirt went next, revealing her second surprise. Other than the black stockings I'd glimpsed when she was snuggled on the sofa, she was naked.

'You are a well trained slut,' he said. 'Isn't she, Sarah?'

Sarah glanced up from his lap, eyeing her friend's full-frontal nudity. 'She's very sexy.'

'So you two have never fooled around?' Jackson probed.

Sarah shook her head, never taking her eyes from Dana.

'Well, that's about to change. Dana, come here and undress your friend.'

Dana moved back towards the sofas, her hips swinging. Sarah rose to meet her. Jackson did, too, casually unbuttoning his shirt as he watched the women.

'You have the most amazing tits,' Sarah said. 'May I?'

'Please,' Dana said.

I could just see Sarah's hand slide over Dana's left breast as the women came together for another scorching kiss. Dana reached behind her, pulling at the long zipper that ran down Sarah's LBD.

Jackson doffed his shirt and quickly shucked off his pants. The movement caught the women's attention. Still holding one another, they turned toward him with delighted smiles, and whispered something that I couldn't quite hear.

'Step right up, ladies,' he said, holding his arms out. His muscles rippled as he went shirtless. 'No need to be shy.'

The threesome came together again, sharing kisses and caresses, their hands roaming, their bodies swaying. Jackson placed a hand on their shoulders and together, the women dropped to their knees.

This time, I got a clear view. I could see as they leaned in as though going in for a kiss, only Jackson's huge cock lay between them. I caught my breath as Dana and Sarah kissed the bulbous end of that beast, the two of them so close they could, almost, have been making out with each other—their heads slightly tilted, their noses touching, but their lips sucked on that cock rather than each other's mouths.

They slid down his huge shaft, lashing it with their tongues. Jackson put a hand on each of their heads—blonde Sarah and brunette Dana—pressing their mouths against his cock as he began stirring his hips, gently back and forth. He slid his manhood between their lips and against their cheeks so that it almost seemed as though he fucking two pretty faces at once.

It was so mesmerizing to watch that I almost missed the fact that Sarah's hand had moved down between Dana's thighs, or that Dana was tweaking her friend's nipples through her bra.

My attention moved back to what they were doing with Jackson's cock when Sarah swallowed it and Dana dipped low to suck on his balls. The man was in heaven. I realized that if it were me, there was no way that I'd be able to last. But I also probably would have come long ago.

Turned out, Jackson was impressive, but he was not superhuman. As Dana was taking him deep in her throat, he started groaning and driving his

hips harder. Sarah peeled back, grabbed her friend's head by the ponytail, and held her in place as Jackson started fucking her face.

I nearly bolted out of my hiding place as Dana started choking and gurgling. But then I saw how her hands were down between her legs, playing with herself. Was this how she wanted to be treated? Was this the thing that I wasn't able to provide.

Sarah let her off to catch her breath, but only for a moment. 'You like that, don't you, being used like a little slut.'

'She does,' Jackson answered for her. He slapped my wife's face with his dick. 'We're going to have some fun tonight.'

Sarah shoved Dana back onto the cock, once again holding her in place as Jackson had his way with her.

'You're fun,' he said to Sarah.

'So I've been told.'

He nodded his chin towards the duffle bag that he brought in. 'Why don't you dig in there,' he said. 'See if something catches your fun-loving eye.'

Sarah grinned, releasing Dana's head. For the first time, I got a good look at her in just her bra and thong. She was curvier than Dana, buxom to Dana's athleticism, although no less hard-bodied. Her bubble butt was a work of art as she knelt before the bag and unzipped it.

'Well, well, well,' she said at whatever she found inside. 'Kinky.'

'It's actually all Dana's stuff,' he said. 'I just gathered it.'

Sarah looked at her friend, who continued to bob along Jackson's length. 'You continue to surprise me, naughty girl.' She pulled out what appeared to be three cuffs attached together by another strip of black leather. 'You like being restrained, don't you?'

'She does,' Jackson said for her. He pulled Dana's head back by the ponytail. 'Don't you, pet?'

'Yes, Sir.'

‘Demonstrate,’ he commanded.

Dana hesitated for only a moment before looking at her friend and putting her hands behind her back, wrists together. ‘Collar me, please...’

He seemed to command Sarah with a glance. ‘Do it. Then we’ll figure out the best way to punish her.’

Sarah looked delighted to move into place behind her friend, encircling her neck with the collar first. When the bands around her wrists went on and she tightened the strap between collar and cuffs, it forced her shoulders back and her chest forward.

‘You know, I’ve always been jealous of these...’ Sarah said, cupping Dana’s large breasts from behind. ‘You know how much money I could have saved if I’d been blessed with these?’

Dana moaned as Sarah twisted the tips. Getting right up against her ear, so close that I could barely hear her words, Sarah said, ‘You ever fuck him with these puppies?’

It wasn’t so much the question, or even the answer, that overwhelmed me. It was the way she looked up at Jackson as she answered—the connection, smoldering and unbridled as she nodded her head. ‘Yes,’ she whispered.

‘Would you like to do it now?’ Sarah pressed.

She was even quieter when she answered yes again. Her eyes never left Jackson’s.

Sarah tightened her fingers on her nipples and snapped, ‘Then ask him.’

‘Will you... sir?’ Dana asked.

‘Will I what?’ he said, grinning.

‘Will you please fuck my tits, sir?’

Jackson shuffled to the edge of the sofa as Dana knelt closer. Sarah tightened the band between cuff and collar, jutting her friend’s chest out even further. She spit into Dana’s cleavage before enveloping Jackson’s cock with her titflesh.

‘Oh, yes, that’s so sexy,’ Sarah whispered, pressing Dana’s breasts tight. Jackson was big enough that his cock would jut free with each thrust, and Sarah couldn’t help herself. She leaned over Dana’s shoulder, lapping at the cockhead each time it emerged. ‘You never did this with *Mr. Sullivan*, did you?’

‘No.’

‘And he never had the balls to ask for it.’

‘He wouldn’t,’ Dana said.

‘If he could see you now...’ For a moment, I was seized with the most irrational fear that Dana was going to look my way. In fact, I swore that her head started to turn my direction, only to divert upwards, to where Sarah craned. The two women shared a deep, Sapphic kiss as Jackson kept up the titfuck.

It was Jackson who had to pull back, grabbing his glistening cock and stroking it as he fell back into the sofa and watched the two friends make out again. He said, ‘As hot as that is to watch, this dick needs some pussy.’

Dana began to rise when he shook his head. ‘No, not you. You are to be punished, and I know just how to do it.’ He looked at Sarah. ‘You’re going to watch me fuck your friend. Do not move. Do not make a sound. Understand, pet?’

She nodded, knowing not to speak anymore.

‘Good little slut.’ To Sarah: ‘Time to fuck.’

Sarah crawled onto the sofa, throwing a leg over Jackson as she straddled him just a few feet from her friend. They made out, with Jackson filling his hands with Sarah’s bubbly butt. He twisted her thong, pulling it roughly into her asscheeks, stretching the lacy black material until it tore.

‘That was a \$200 pair of panties you just ruined,’ Sarah said, although she didn’t sound all that upset.

Jackson, for his part, didn’t sound guilty. ‘Invoice your friend. She should have taken them off.’

‘I’ll get the bra,’ Sarah said, reaching behind her to twist the clasp off.

‘Turn around,’ he ordered. ‘We wouldn’t want Dana to miss any of this.’

I caught my first glimpse of a naked Sarah, and she was stunning. Her hips were wider than Dana’s, and while her breasts weren’t quite as large, on her smaller frame, they definitely looked bigger. Like Dana, she was shaved bare, her smooth mound glistening and ready.

She reached down between her legs, grabbed Jackson’s enormous cock in her dainty hand, and sank down onto it, just inches from my tormented wife. ‘Oh, fuck, that feels... so big!’

Jackson didn’t let her get used to it, and he didn’t let her set the pace, despite being on top. He was, after all, a CrossFit instructor, used to being in control with the physique to back it up. He grabbed her by the hips, held her in place, and began thrusting up into her. She went off, arching back and swooning into his body. She cupped her breasts, pinching and twisting her nipples.

‘She’s nice and tight,’ Jackson said to Dana. ‘How do you feel, pet?’

Dana stayed quiet as instructed. ‘You may speak,’ Jackson said. ‘Tell us what you are thinking.’

‘I am jealous,’ she said, like the words were pent up. I felt the same way. ‘But I am so turned on.’

Again, that registered with me. Her words were simple, but the emotion behind them was real and powerful. Yes, exactly.

‘And what would you be willing to do to be part of this?’ Jackson prompted.

‘Anything.’ Dana said the word all at once, like it was one syllable.

‘Anything is a big word.’

‘You should know how much I like big things,’ Dana said, unable to conceal her smile.

Jackson actually laughed out loud. ‘I’m going to fill your friend’s pussy with my come, and then what are you going to do?’

‘I’m going to lick her clean,’ Dana said, quickly adding, ‘Sir.’

‘And?’ Jackson prompted.

‘And I’m going to make her scream.’

Jackson didn’t hold back after that. He dug his fingers into her hips and drove up into her until he was red and panting, until their bodies were dripping sweat. Dana knelt there obediently, watching the wild coupling.

I couldn’t help myself. I went from rubbing myself through my pants to unbuttoning them and taking my cock in my fist, my other hand braced against the wall that hid me. When Jackson came, pulling Sarah down into him as his great, big cock pulsed and filled her, I nearly joined him—not because it was hot to watch him with Sarah, but because I knew what came next.

When he pulled free, he set Sarah on the edge of the couch, her legs spread. Rolling off, he grabbed Dana by the ponytail and first directed her to his softening cock. She sucked it eagerly, come and pussy coated.

‘Clean it up like a good little slut,’ he said. By the time he pulled her back, he was already stiffening up again. ‘Now it’s time to eat some pussy.’

‘Yes, sir.’

‘You like eating pussy?’

‘I do, sir.’

She did?!

‘How about your best friend’s pussy?’

‘I’ve always been curious, sir.’

‘Let’s satisfy that curiosity.’ He tipped her forward, right into Sarah’s lap, and because her hands were tied behind her back, she had to depend on him for support. ‘Show me that you can make her scream.’

Unbelievably, I watched as Dana rested her forehead on Sarah’s mound and started going down on another woman.

‘Look at each other,’ Jackson ordered. ‘Show me the lust.’

Sarah took Dana's head in her hands, grasping her friend by the ponytail the way Jackson had used her. 'You do that well,' she said. 'We should have done this a long time ago.'

Jackson moved into place behind Dana. His cock was, once again, and full, impressive length. With one hand on her hip, the other holding himself, I watched as this other man so casually drove his cock into my wife.

Dana gasped, rolling her head away from Sarah's sex to breath. Jackson slapped her ass, swift but not hard. 'Did I tell you to stop eating your friend out?'

'No, sir.' She turned back into Sarah's lap. Jackson spanked her again. It called to mind my own failed experience with that, and how Dana had to ask for it. '*You can spank me, honey, if you'd like...*'

I hadn't. Jackson did. And it was exactly what she wanted. Jackson unbound her wrists, and for a moment, I thought it was so she could use her hands on Sarah. When she, instead, placed her hands on her reddened cheeks and spread them, another memory sprung to mind.

'*You can fuck me in the ass, if you want...*' I hadn't taken her up on the offer. Jackson didn't hesitate. He pumped her pussy a couple more times before pulling out, sliding it up an inch, and driving into her asshole.

'Is he...? Oh, my God, girl, you can fit that thing back there?' Sarah gaped.

'Dana loves anal sex. Don't you, pet?'

'Yes...' she hissed.

'I'll never forget the first time she showed up with a butt plug.' He spanked her again. 'So presumptuous. This one sometimes forgets her place.' Another spank. 'She forgets that with me, she's not the boss. Now eat that pussy like a good pet.'

It was stunning, watching these three people having sex—in real life. Stunning even more that one of them was my wife. I nearly came, just like that, jerking my cock off just around the corner. Somehow, I held out.

Somehow, I contented myself to slowly stroke myself as Dana took a man's cock harder and harder in her ass whilst engaged in lesbian sex with her best friend.

Dana couldn't keep up her end of the bargain. Not after Jackson started to really give it to her, hands holding her hips as he lunged forward. She rested her head on Sarah's thigh, breathing hard, mouth open as she gasped.

Sarah slipped down into the space between Dana and the couch, cradling her face and whispering something that I couldn't hear, but seemed to drive Dana's delirium higher.

With that, Sarah dropped to the floor, flipped onto her back, and slid between Dana's thighs. Jackson pushed her into a squat over Sarah's face, and suddenly she was in heaven. She sounded as though she could hardly cope with the power of the pleasure flowing through her exquisite body.

I was so buzzed, watching her experiencing this—how could a husband not allow his wife an experience like this, if the opportunity ever presented itself? I was so hard, watching the threesome and the power Dana gave up to Jackson and Sarah. I got it. I loved giving up that same power.

But she wasn't going to last forever.

It was so very physical. All three of them, naked, and glistening all over, sweat making their bodies shine worked like a machine. Jackson pushed Dana down between Sarah's legs as their climax approached, completing the sixty-nine. Dana went for it, just as before, all hesitancy to play with her friend gone.

I could detect the scent of sex in the air, now—even from outside.

Did people really have sex like this?

It felt to me like pornography had normalized some fairly extreme behavior.

But, hey, they were all consenting adults. And I was a secretly consenting husband watching my wife cheating on me with this fit guy and her very attractive, female friend.

The threesome built to an orgasm, fucking harder, moving faster. Sarah crested first, pushed over the edge by Dana's expert tongue. She tightened her thighs around Dana's head, exploding in an arc of girl-cum all over Dana's face.

The suffocation must have done Dana in, too. She ripped her face away, screaming through her orgasm. Jackson rode her, spanking her, fucking her ass just as hard as he would her pussy. She didn't back down.

'Yes! Yes! Please fuck my... fuck my ass, baby!' SPANK! 'Sir, I mean. Sir, please... f-fill my... fill my ass, sir!'

Jackson drove one last time into her, deep, grabbing her by the hips and holding her balls deep. Sarah, still between their legs, shifting, swallowing Jackson's balls as he emptied them deep into Dana's ass.

She went off again, screaming and thrashing, hands in her sweat-matted hair. It was the most beautiful thing I'd ever seen. That was my wife coming. I knew her moans—not just from recent experience, but from before, from the hazy memories that were still swirling. Hearing her cry out, seeing her shudder, started to clear the past.

I came with her, my come boiling over my wrist as Jackson pulled her against him and filled her ass, as her best friend splayed her voluptuous landscape of a body out before her and lapped at her bare cunt. I came with them, apart, yet in unity.

I looked away, trying to stop myself from passing out at the intensity. I saw the darkened hills. I saw the life we lead and *remembered*.

When I looked back, the threesome was disentangling, but the night was far from over. Sarah kissed Dana, slow and sweet, but by no means only friendly. Jackson rose, too, his powerful body already recovering. They were moving to the bedroom. They were moving beyond my ability to observe. And I was fine with that.

But first... 'I need to cool off. I'll be right behind you,' Dana said.

Jackson looked about to protest, but Sarah said to him, ‘Come on, take a shower with me. I think I saw a dildo in that bag with a suction cup on the other end.’

And then they were leaving, Sarah’s hand in Jackson’s, and Dana was heading outside. Towards me!

I should have moved, gotten a better hiding place, but I couldn’t take my eyes off of her, her body covered in the sweat of sex. She was so beautiful, her chest rising and falling as she breathed the cool evening air. Her nipples stiffened as she stopped at the edge of the pool. I waited for her to dive.

She didn’t.

Instead, she turned slowly around and stared in my direction, right at me. My stomach lurched. My muscles froze.

‘Hey, honey,’ she said.

My heart skipped.

She stood there on the edge of the terrace, gazing down at me with her hands on her hips as I looked up like a mortal gazing up at the sudden manifestation of a goddess on this Earth.

‘Uh... hey, sweetie.’

I felt like the world was swallowing me up.

But then Dana smiled, ever so sweetly, and I saw that actually, she wasn’t angry at all.

‘Did you enjoy the show?’

DISCOVERED?

‘**Y**ou... you knew I was there?’ I felt the world bend.
‘You mean now? Yes.’
She took a few steps down the stairs.

‘You mean that night with Russell?’ She added. ‘Uh huh.’

My jaw fell open.

She wasn’t done. ‘And all those times you watched me work out? It was so cute. Sweetheart, I’ve known from before you got sick.’

She laughed at my shock, but it was a loving laugh. It felt inclusive, like I’d finally been let in.

‘Before I got sick?’ My mouth felt dry.

‘I knew you set me up with Russ.’ As she stepped up before me, I could smell the sex on her, the astringent bite of come and the musk of her own excitement. ‘I know how much you like to watch.’

She reached out, running her hand along my erection, which still hung out of my open trousers. ‘Before I was sick, did we...’

‘Do this? No.’ She sank to her knees, keeping her eyes on me. ‘Things were not good, before...’

‘You were cheating on me.’

‘I’ve always slept with other men, but you knew this when we got married.’ She started stroking my cock as she filled in the gaps in my mind.

For the first time, I felt things returning. A memory, vague and foggy, but... but real?

Me coming home early from a work trip only to find her in our bed, face down, ass up, taking it doggy style by some fit stranger. Her hands were bound behind her back and a ball gag was stuffed in her mouth. We weren't married yet, just living together.

I remembered thinking she was being forced. Then I remembered the fight that came after, the pleas for forgiveness, the counseling, the final admission about how much Dana struggled to stay faithful.

'You always knew,' she said. 'And I always just thought you cared more about work than you did about me.'

'Did I?'

'Maybe.' She smiled. 'But not anymore.'

'No, not anymore.' I groaned as she leaned in, as if taking me into her mouth, only to rub my shaft instead along her cheek. 'I'm going to quit,' I murmured.

'Russell told me.' She finally wrapped her lips around it, sucking the come off. 'Is this a dream, Damien? It feels like a dream.'

I crouched down beside her, taking her hands in mine. 'You're asking the wrong guy. Everything feels like a dream.' I looked around at the estate, the rolling hills sweeping away into the valley around us. 'All I know is that you feel like a fantasy come true.'

'Most men would not feel that way when they discover that their wife is a serial cheater.'

'What can I say? I'm pretty exceptional.'

She laughed, touching my face. 'You are.' Then, as she considered everything, she repeated it. 'You are. And always have been. I didn't marry you for your money, you know, despite what everyone thinks.'

'Do they?'

She fixed me with a serious look. 'I did well, but not as well as you were doing when we got together.'

'Plus, you fucked every stud who looked at you twice.'

'I wasn't *that* easy. And I was discreet...'

I looked at her skeptically. She laughed, pushing me lightly. 'A lot more discreet than lately. I wanted you to catch me, silly. I wanted you to watch.'

'It was pretty intense.'

Pushing me onto my back, she straddled me. This time, rather than push her bikini bottom to the side, she tugged on the loopy bow and untied it. Her pussy was wet, and I could see how her pussy and ass were stretched out. When she sank onto me, I could *feel* how stretched out she was, too.

'You liked it,' she said.

'So much.'

She tucked a strand of hair over her ear, beaming down at me. 'I love that you watch me.'

'You do?'

'Oh, yes...' She sighed, grinding her hips slowly over mine. 'I never knew it could be like that.' She rose and fell quietly. 'We weren't in a great place... before... but when you got sick...' Her smile was sad. 'I was so afraid that I'd lose you.'

'And when I got better, you ran back to your lover.'

She winced. 'Would you believe that I did it to test you?'

'I'm not upset.' I wasn't. 'I can't explain it, but I'm... it turns me on that you do that. I... I think that maybe it always has.'

'We are quite a pair, aren't we?' She pressed her hips into me, riding me out.

'I'm never going to give you what you need—'

'Damien—'

'Maybe the old me struggled with that. I won't.'

'You mean you don't want to,' she said with a half-smile.

‘I want you to go inside and join them.’ I reached up, filling my hands with her bouncing breasts. ‘I want you to do whatever they tell you to do.’

‘You won’t get to see.’

She held her. ‘I’ll get to imagine, which in some ways is even hotter.’

She sighed, touching my face. ‘He’s going to make me and Sarah have sex again.’

‘Make you?’

Dana blushed. ‘Order us. It’s his way. But... it’s not like he’ll have to twist either of our arms.’

‘Have you two ever—?’

‘Not until just now,’ Dana said. ‘She’s always swung both ways, but I’ve only recently... satisfied *that* curiosity.’

‘It was crazy to watch.’

‘Even crazier to experience.’

She bounced harder, faster, reaching behind herself to grab my ankles. Her body stretched out before me, a glistening landscape of sweat and come. I thumbed her clit, driving her right up to the edge.

‘They’re going to use you. I *want* them to use you. And you will make them want more.’

She whimpered at the onslaught of my words. I may not fuck her the way Jackson fucks her, but I could still push her buttons.

‘And when you are all used up and have nothing left to give, I’ll be there, waiting.’

We crested together, coming together, in harmony, lost in our shared fantasy. I pulled her to me and kissed her. I could taste Sarah’s come on her. I didn’t care.

‘You know what?’ I asked.

‘What?’

‘We do make quite a pair. Now go and be my unfaithful, slutty wife.’

‘Such a sweet talker.’ She was already rising. ‘Are you going to watch?’

‘Always.’

EPILOGUE

Three months later...

The sun was setting on the rolling hills of the vineyard all around us. The vines are mostly bare, but next year at this time, these hills will be filled with ripe grapes and harvest time will be in full effect. I can already see it. I can already imagine it.

Dana was standing at the windows, her back to me, watching the sun set. The sky was fiery and violent. In here, in our hearts, that emotion has finally calmed. I carried a glass of red wine over to her and took my place at her side.

‘I’m so glad we moved out here,’ she said. Her gaze remained outside. ‘It’s so peaceful.’

‘The house in the city was too much for us, anyway.’

She chuckled. ‘I thought your memories had returned. It still doesn’t sound like you.’

‘Most of the memories, yes, but I’ll never fully be that Damien again. I don’t need status symbols anymore. I don’t need a giant mansion to show my worth.’

‘You never did.’ The sun had set enough that we could see our reflections in the window. She was looking at me. Maybe she’d been

looking at me all along.

I'd quit my job and sold off all the shares in the company that another man with my same name had started, so many years ago. That man was no longer me, and I no longer had any interest in burying myself in work. Between the sale of the house and company, we were set up for life, but that also didn't mean I didn't want to work at all.

'This is good,' Dana said, holding up the wine.

'It's my favorite that Piero's developed so far.' Piero was our enologist, who had been working with the small crop of grapes that did grow on the estate to develop next year's batch. We were entering the wine business.

'Mmm, Piero...' Dana's approval was deeper than that of the wine.

I just laughed. 'I almost feel sorry for that young man.'

'Almost?'

I kissed softly. 'I hope, for your sake, he's got a big cock.'

'And how do you know I haven't found out already?'

My heart beat ratcheted up as my breath caught. The game had continued. It would never end. I knew about most of her infidelities, because she gave me enough clues to figure out and follow.

I knew that last week, she'd met up with Jackson Ross in the city and fucked him all afternoon. I knew because I'd been just outside, hoping to catch a glimpse through his apartment window.

I knew that a month ago, when Sarah Mallory had visited us out here in Napa and spent the night, she and Dana had gotten very little sleep. Turned out, Sarah enjoyed dominating women as much as she did men, and while I wasn't allowed to participate, I got to watch it all unfold while hiding in the closet. Whatever hesitancy the two best friends had for fooling around was gone.

And I knew that there were other times. Times when Dana went into Sacramento or San Francisco for a single meeting and didn't come home until late at night. She took a business trip down to LA for a few days, and I

was certain she wasn't faithful there, either, despite not saying a word one way or the other.

It was hot beyond my wildest dreams. I didn't want it any other way.

I pulled a scrap of cloth from my inner pocket, my hand already shaking. She caught the movement in our reflection and raised a brow. 'What's this?'

I grinned as I held up the blindfold—the same blindfold she gave to me so many months ago on that disastrous night, just after I woke up. I may have been still assembling the pieces of my broken memory from before COVID-19, but I had no trouble remembering all that came after. I even remember the words.

'It's simple. I put this on you, and then you do whatever I want you to do.' Her words from my mouth, almost exactly. She was already smiling as I lifted the blindfold and set it over her eyes.

'And what do you want me to do?'

I took her by the hand. 'Come this way. Trust me.'

Tentatively, I led her over to the sofa. As I did so, I glanced towards the stairs, where Russell had come out of hiding, and nodded. Moving into place behind her, I slowly unzipped her dress, letting it pool at her ankles around me. Beneath, she looked wicked in her black lingerie—black satin bra, black thong, black lace-topped stockings.

Russell looked at her with a hunger that I understood, rubbing his upper lip. Gently, as was expected of me, I pushed her forward until she was on all fours over the sofa, her hands braced on the back, her knees resting on the cushioned seat, her ass up.

'What are you—'

Slap! Russell's hand, not mine, glanced off her toned ass, applying just enough sting to make her gasp and break her concentration.

'Damien?'

I took a seat beside her, reaching up to caress her face. 'I'm here, honey.'

Russell spanked her again, this time drawing a moan. 'Who... who else?'

'Someone special.' I smiled at my best friend. 'Someone who knows *exactly* what a naughty woman like you needs.'

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Bull's Eye Series (5 books)



Paul Sharpe, self-avowed bachelor, works hard and plays harder—always looking for a new conquest. Blondes, brunettes, redheads, he enjoys them all as long as the pursuit is fun and they're up for a good time. He's fine being disposable. Life is simpler that way.

Until he meets a woman who opens his eyes to a whole new world—the world of hotwives and cuckolds and the games that they play. After that, he sees it everywhere. At bars, at clubs, at his company's gala, he sees men furtively watching other men hit on their wives.

Can he be the other man? Can he be the bull?

Follow Paul's epic journey over five books as he evolves from the bull to so much more.

[Bull's Eye 1: Discovering the Hotwife Fantasy](#)

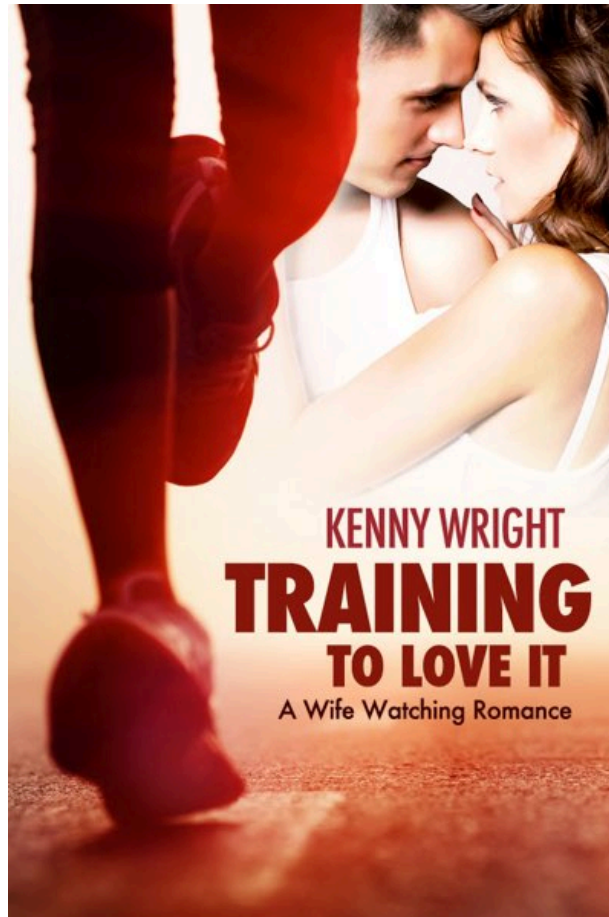
[Bull's Eye 2: Exploring the Hotwife Fantasy](#)

[Bull's Eye 3: Enjoying the Hotwife Fantasy](#)

[Bull's Eye 4: Consequences of a Hotwife Fantasy](#)

[Bull's Eye 5: Beyond the Hotwife Fantasy](#)

Training to Love It Series (3 books)



Can a wife-watching fantasy be trained?

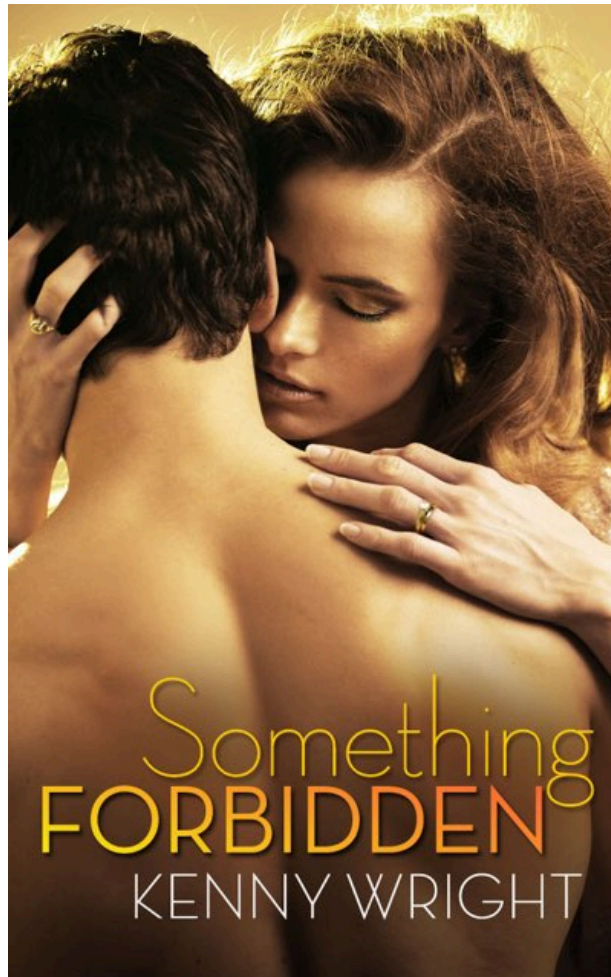
When Erin comes home from the gym and lets slip that her new personal trainer is a man, Tom doesn't know how to react. When he overhears Erin admitting that she's attracted to AJ, her trainer, he becomes even more confused. He wants to be supportive, but he feels jealous. He wants to be understanding, but he doesn't even understand his own feelings. Every time he thinks of Erin with AJ, his heart begins to race. Every time she says his name, his breath catches in his chest.

AJ ends up pushing more than just his wife's physical limits. As Tom watches this newer, stronger, more assertive woman emerge with each training session, he realizes that this other man is pushing the limits of their marriage and their happy life. How far would they go for a fantasy? And whose fantasy is it? And what happens when things go too far?

Training to Love It

Training to Love It 2

Forbidden Series (2 books)



Wife-watching. Swinging. Consensual infidelity. These are not concepts that Maxwell Callahan understands, let alone fantasizes about. Max has a great life: husband, father, successful bar owner.

He has no plans to shake it up.

And then he witnesses a couple play a dangerous game of pick-up in his bar: the wife gets picked up, the husband watches. A seed takes root and starts to grow. What would it be like to watch his beautiful wife, Katie, in the same situation?

Smart, successful, yet a little conservative, he never thought Katie would entertain such an idea... until she does. This suburban couple is about to take a wild ride as they turn fantasy into reality. Don't miss this marital adventure as Katie and Max try something forbidden.

Something Forbidden

Nothing Forbidden

Annie's Affair



She cheated, and it turned him on.

Travis never thought his wife would cheat on him. Never considered it once in nineteen long years of marriage...until Rick entered their lives.

Travis never thought an affair would turn him on...until he found Annie's diary and started reading about his wife's attraction to her new, younger editor. Confident and attractive, Rick made his intentions clear. He wanted Annie, and she responded. She was tempted. She was attracted. She was conflicted.

Suddenly, Travis is able to see Annie the way Rick does—the way he used to before his perception was dulled by the long years of marriage. Annie is an attractive, smart, fun woman, with an adventurous side ready to be unleashed.

Travis never thought he'd want to watch his wife sleep with another man...until he did. And then it became his obsession.

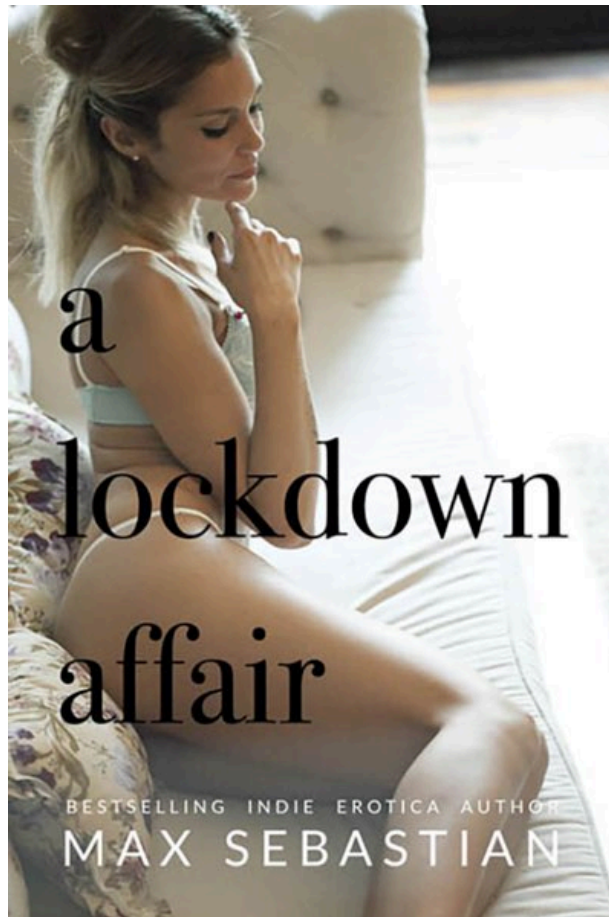
Annie's Affair follows Travis as he witnesses his wife fall into the arms of another man, and becomes just as complicit in the betrayal as his wife.

[Find *Annie's Affair* online](#)

ALSO BY MAX SEBASTIAN

Want to read more books that tackle lust in the time of coronavirus? Max has you covered.

A Lockdown Affair



3 nights a week, she stays in the city

and she doesn't sleep alone

Cam is shocked when he discovers evidence that suggests his wife might be cheating on him — and during the lockdown, of all times.

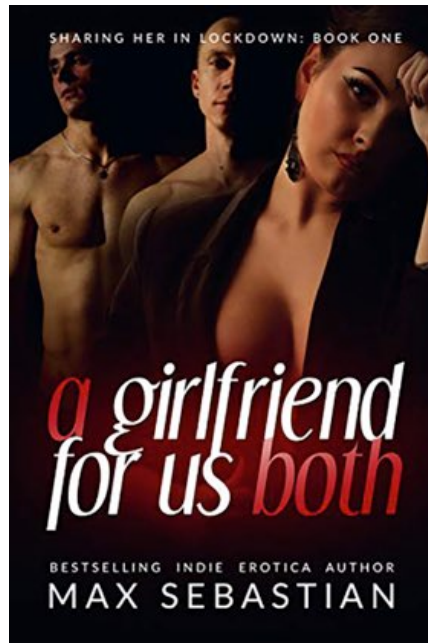
Feeling the need to properly confirm his suspicions before he should confront Marcie about her affair, Cam begins discreet inquiries. But as he does so, not only does he begin to understand her

reasons for being unfaithful, he also finds his desire for her growing exponentially — precisely because she has been cheating on him.

Amazon bestselling erotica author Max Sebastian presents a full-length novel full of sizzling suspense, as a stay-at-home dad discovers the strange attraction of an unfaithful wife, and how challenging the boundaries of a conventional marriage could lead to a powerful and passionate reforging of the bond between himself and his soulmate.

[Find your book retailer of choice here.](#)

A Girlfriend For Both of Us



June 2020: Roommates Ryan and Jacob have gone without any physical contact with another person for nearly three whole months before lockdown restrictions are finally eased.

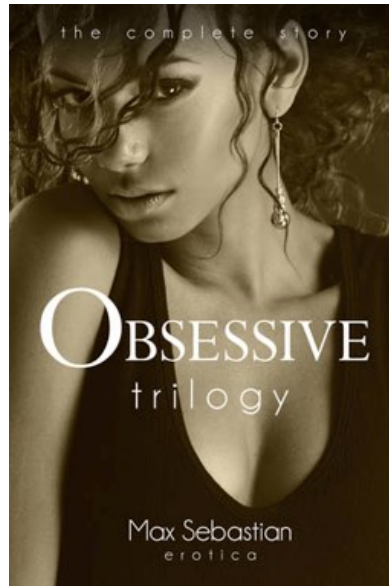
But under the new rules, only one of their girlfriends will be able to visit.

The desperate twenty-somethings are faced with a difficult dilemma -- either one, or the other will get to have sex, but not both. Unless, that is, they were to share one of their girlfriends...

A sexy, raunchy and highly explicit novel from Amazon-bestselling erotica author Max Sebastian, marking the start of the Sharing Her In Lockdown series charting the sexual adventures of a group of twenty-somethings during these unprecedented times.

First book in this series available now! [Find more details here.](#)

Obsessive Trilogy (3 books)



Knowing she is having an affair makes Effie irresistible to her husband.

From the start of their unusual relationship, Jens Nielsen was always open about his inability to satisfy a woman. His lovely wife, Effie, was always perfectly understanding, given his condition. Nevertheless he made her an offer: if she was ever tempted by another man, she could have an affair without fear of damaging their marriage. A woman has needs, after all.

Now, for the first time ever, Jens suspects that Effie is taking up his offer—and surprisingly, it awakens his desire for his beautiful wife in a most unexpected way...

From bestselling erotica author Max Sebastian comes the complete trilogy, *Obsessive*, in one volume. A red-hot, erotic saga will thrill readers like no other...

[Available online here.](#)